



The
**Coaching
Room**

Change minds, change lives.



NLP Practitioner Certification Program Manual



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Disclaimer:

This Training Manual is designed for training and education and should not be used as a substitute for psychotherapy or psychiatry. The Coaching Room recommends that if psychological and psychiatric assistance is needed, that it should be sought by those professionally certified to give it and that this manual should not be considered a substitute.



Welcome to your NLP Training

"NLP is an attitude, backed up by a methodology that leaves behind it a trail of techniques."

- Richard Bandler; co-founder of NLP

Our view at The Coaching Room is that NLP is a (psycho-active) developmental model; which means that by learning it, you cannot not develop. NLP is a developmental accelerator.

Welcome to this NLP adventure. This adventure involves discovering how to truly run your own brain. When you can do that, you can achieve something that's truly magical within yourself and among others. You can manage your own mind-body-emotional states in any situation or context. Imagine that! Wouldn't that be wonderful?

By entering into this training, you are about to take the first step in the exploration of how you have mapped out your sense of reality. As you self-explore, we will put into your hands all of the necessary tools to refine and transform your experience of reality so that it enhances your life in ways that will revolutionise you. A big promise? Yes, it is!

The revolutionary unfolding is part of the magic and wonder of this new technology that we call NLP and specifically META-NLP. This exploration will also provide something else. It will richly inform you about others, i.e. how to read them, how to figure them out, how to influence them, and - ultimately - how to enrich relationships with them.



As your trainers, it is our privilege to share in your discoveries of NLP during this intensive and accelerated format. As you undoubtedly know, NLP (like any other field) has developed a specialised vocabulary (or jargon). Are you still wondering why that is necessary? It's necessary to talk precisely and accurately about the stuff inside the "black box." Even today, psychological language for human subjectivity is still pretty vague and indefinite. In NLP, we have a much more precise way to talk about the mental-and- emotional phenomena that we experience.

At its heart, NLP and Neuro-Semantics is highly experiential. For that reason, the focus of this training will be on running the patterns, on getting actual hands-on practice with the processes, the models, the techniques, etc. Though, at first, we will need to start by sharing lots of new information. So, in order for you to get the most from this, we ask that you adopt as playful, explorative, and curious a state as possible. This too will accelerate your learning and mastery.

I (Michael Hall) have designed this training, in correlation with Bob Bodenhamer, using a great many of the Accelerated Learning Principles, so that every learning experience leads naturally to the next and every skill or model will build upon the former experiences. I have also put this training manual together in such a way that there are many presupposed and pre-framed installation processes, which you may or may not catch consciously, at least not at first.

The most unique factor in this training is that you will also learn the Meta-States model. This is the newest and most revolutionary model to appear in NLP in the past 20 years. As such, Meta-States will accelerate your learning and enable you to access the higher levels of your mind so as to facilitate your understanding and mastery. It will enable you to see the whole picture of NLP and recognise the mechanisms that make it work which is why we call it META-NLP.

NLP is itself a model for succeeding in whatever you do. At the heart of NLP, is a general pattern for succeeding in anything that you deem important. The formula is simple, but don't let it fool you.

There's wisdom incorporated into this process:

- Know what you want - identify your desired outcome.
- Take informed action steps toward that outcome.
- Use your sensory acuity to notice the responses you get from those actions.
- Using behavioural flexibility - keep adjusting your actions to the feedback.
- Focus attention on accessing and operating from your best states.
- Persist until you reach your outcomes.

L. Michael Hall and the team at The Coaching Room



Opening Frames for the Training



As you study META-NLP, consider yourself a "coach in training." This study is about the art of running your own brain and managing your states. To invite you into this cognitive- behavioural approach and to this art, we have a set of questions that we invite you to consider as your part and responsibility for getting all that you can from this training.

- Will you agree to take full ownership for your own brain and state as you engage in this study?
- Will you agree to enter this study for the single focus of learning, discovering, and applying these processes and principles for your own growth and personal development?
- Will you set yourself to look for and get as much value from the training for yourself?
- Will you seek to support and contribute value to others in the training?
- Will you focus on learning the patterns and processes to gain competency and therefore certification as an NLP Practitioner?
- Will you agree to be on time for the sessions and to be time-conscious of the breaks, beginning and ending times?
- Will you open yourself to feedback and shaping so that you can tune up your personal knowledge and skills to become much more resourceful than you have ever been before?
- Will you monitor yourself, so that if something comes up as you process the patterns and experiences, you will let us know, so that we can support you and enable you to apply these powerful principles to those memories or meanings?
- Will you embrace ambiguity, confusion, and even disorientation as you move through the training? In NLP we say that "confusion is the gateway to new learnings." So, if you get confused or overwhelmed, just welcome it in and let it be. As you trust the process, you will find new resources and empowerment.
- Will you agree to not introduce patterns and ideas from other disciplines and fields in this training? This is about NLP and while each person brings rich resources from other fields, for the training, we know that it's best to keep or attention on NLP and not everything that you can bring. This doesn't discount the other learning's you have, it just keeps us focused on what we are doing here.
- Will you agree to be appropriately professional while you are here in terms of your ethics and morality? While we will be making a list of participants available to you, this is not the time to sell your products and services or to get new business.
- Will you follow the direction and guidance of your trainer(s) and participate as a good team member so that your learning's and skills as well as others can be enriched as much as possible?

Neuro-Linguistic Programming (NLP)



- NLP is first and foremost a communication model.
- It is a model of how we operate, and function given our mind-body-emotion system.
- It is a model of how we map or model "information."
- It is a model of the structure of resourcefulness so we "run our own brain" and manage our own states.
- It is a model of the structure of excellence, so we can replicate genius.

NLP began, not with the sensory systems or sub-modalities, but with the language patterns that two therapeutic wizards used to perform their magic. Richard Bandler and John Grinder happened upon the marvellous language patterning of Fritz Perls (Gestalt Therapy) and Virginia Satir (Family Systems) and began studying how the words and language patterns performed their "magic." They put the results of their study in the books, *The Structure of Magic I and II*¹

Also, a description of human functioning, NLP focuses on experience, experiencing, and experimenting rather than theory. Via the tools, models, techniques, and patterns, NLP gives us a way to talk about our subjective experiences. By focusing on description rather than prescription, we focus on how the processes and mechanisms work, how to replicate such (modelling), and how to intervene, transform, and improve human functioning.

¹ Bandler, Richard., and Grinder, John. (1975) *The structure of magic*. Palo Alto, Calif: Science and Behavior Books.. Bandler, Richard., and Grinder, John. (1976). *The structure of magic II*. Palo Alto. CA: Science and Behavior Books.



What is NLP?



Neuro

The voluntary and autonomic nervous system through which our experiences are processed, by means of our five senses: visual, auditory, kinaesthetic, olfactory and gustatory. Neurology, the nervous system, the physical foundations for the "abstracting" of the nervous system that begins our "mapping" of the world out there. In our neurological mapping, we map the world using the non- linguistic maps of the sensory systems:

- Visual - sights Auditory - sounds
- Kinaesthetic – feelings/sensations Olfactory - smell
- Gustatory - taste

Linguistic

The symbolic mapping (in here) that we create about the territory (out there). It involves the higher cortical functions in the brain, which enable us to use symbols to create language, and to map things out linguistically. This enables us to encode order and give meaning to our sensory representations using much more abstract categories. This includes:

- Language - words, sentences, syntax, grammar, etc. Mathematics
- Music
- Non-propositional language: poetry, stories, narrative, etc.

Programming

The actual processes or patterns that we use to order and sequence our mapping. Such "programming" generates our strategies for functioning, and results in our skills, abilities, habits, etc. We develop "programs" for communicating, leading parenting, working, relating, etc.



NLP as a Model

We use the word model in numerous ways. Often, we say that something is a model when we only mean that it is a format or pattern. A fully-fledged model is in entirely different thing. It involves four things: a theory, variables, guiding principles, and processes. The following identifies these four facets of the NLP Model.

The necessary and sufficient pieces that comprise a model

1. A Theory

A theoretical background, foundation, hypothesis, etc. that offers an explanatory model for how the system works, including the governing ideas and how to test and refine the ideas in order to create new applications. Ideas that can be tested and falsified – this is the 'Why' (epistemology).

2. Variables and Elements

The pieces and parts that make up the components of the model. Which elements are absolutely necessary and sufficient to make the model work? Which processes are critical? - This is the 'What' (content).

3. The Guiding and Operational Principles

The "laws" or principles (presuppositions) that define and articulate the mechanisms, that make it work and how to use them in a methodological, systematic, and systemic way.

This gives one the ability to keep refining the model. How does the model work? What processes, mechanisms govern it? This is the 'How' (process)

4. The Technologies or Patterns

The specific tools that allow immediate application of the Model or System to achieve something. How do you reframe meaning? This is the 'how to' (steps and stages).

This includes:

- Alfred Korzybski's map/territory distinction
- Gestalt psychology & gestalt therapy
- Bateson's constructionism
- Cybernetics - Korzybski family systems
- NLP VAKAd representational systems
- NLP sub-modalities
- Meta-levels (meta states model)
- Meta-programs
- Adaptation of NLP presuppositions
- TOTE model for strategies
- More than 150 NLP patterns
- The NLP presuppositions



The NLP Presuppositions



NLP's hidden theories

There are 18 core premises or presuppositions that guide the NLP communication model. These presuppositions originated primarily from the professional communicators that Bandler and Grinder modelled; Fritz Perls, Virginia Satir, and Milton Erickson. These are governing principles for communicating with yourself and with others.

Our offer is to integrate these fully as your everyday frames of mind; or general attitude (way of seeing).

1. Our map is not the territory; it is but a symbolic representation of the territory.
2. We all respond according to our map of reality, not reality.
3. The meaning of communication is the response you get.
4. There is no "failure," only feedback of information.
5. The element in any system with the most flexibility will exercise the greatest influence (Law of Requisite Variety).
6. Mind and body are both part of the same system (the neuro-linguistic system) and influence each other in a circular way.
7. People are not broken; they work perfectly well. It's the person's frames that don't work contextually.
8. People have all the resources they need; they just need to access, strengthen, and sequence them.
9. We can model excellence, and even genius, if we break the tasks and skills into small enough chunks. If someone can do something, then it's a human possibility.
10. It's always better to have choice than a lack of choice.
11. We add choices in NLP, we don't take choices away; people tend to make the best choices available to them at the time.
12. When calibrating to a person's reality when there's incongruity, the highest quality information will be behavioural.
13. Since memory and imagination use the same neurological circuits as external sensory awareness, they can powerfully influence our development.
14. People are more than their actions, words, emotions, roles, etc.
15. Behind every behaviour is a positive intention.
16. Resistance indicates the lack of rapport, and yet is necessary.
17. There's an abundance of personal resources, plenty for all.
18. It's never too late to have a happy childhood.



The Neuro-semantic Presuppositions

NS hidden theories

In Neuro-Semantics or Meta-NLP, we have also been adding some of our premises to the list of presuppositions.

1. Energy flows where attention goes as directed by intention.
2. If you get serious, you get stupid.
3. Because each of us creates our own meanings about things, we are the meaning- makers who construct our own unique Matrix.
4. Indexing and referencing of class and a member of class level is vital in avoiding meta-confusions that bind us to create double binds.
5. Questioning activates the Matrix and so is a most powerful communication skill of all.
6. Personal power and congruency come from "applying to self" first.
7. Being gloriously fallible is the meta-state that inoculates from fear of failure, vulnerability and mistakes.
8. There's no sameness in the world, only change and processes.
9. To get the results we want, we have to take action.
10. Productivity comes through closing the knowing-doing gap so that we know in our mind can become part of muscle memory.
11. Only sensory specific feedback is clean enough to be useful and only then if it requested.
12. The sanity line is drawn between responsibility to and responsibility for.
13. There are frames-by-inference in everything we think and say.
14. Where there is a frame, there's a game. Where there's a game, there's a frame.
It's about the inner game of our frames.
15. When you win the inner game, the outer game is a cinch.
16. Someone is always setting the frames; whoever sets the frame controls the game.
17. The name of the game is to name the game.



Embody a Presupposition



Exercise – Activity

Activity: select a presupposition

1. Identify a presupposition that would create empowerment for you as a professional communicator and, or as a coach.

2. What do you need to fully integrate that presupposition into your way of seeing and being?

Activity: developing a robust attitude

1. Commission your chosen NLP presupposition by linguistically stating it repeatedly...

Keep saying the presupposition to refine it, until you find a way to express it, which feels succinct, memorable and compelling. Exquisitely state it, so that the thought puts you into a resourceful state (state management).

2. Find the corresponding neurology.

Gesture; move your body and translate the presupposition into your desired state and experience it in the present, as a way of being.

3. Continue to hold this presupposition now and as you go and grow through this training!

Rate your Skill Level in the Basic Coaching Skills



Exercise – Activity

Where do you think you are today?

Rate your competency level on these skills from 0 (poor) to 10 (excellent), given what you currently understand about and can apply the skills listed below. As you do, notice how much more potential for growth and development you sense in yourself.

BASIC COACHING COMPETENCIES	Now	Day 8
Calibrating: Noticing changes in a person (when listening)		
Pacing: Matching a person's behaviour, breathing, posture, gestures, tones, and words		
Supporting: Being completely present to another person, creating a context for rapport		
Rapport: Creating a connection and familiarity with another, inducing comfort (supporting)		
Questioning: Asking precise questions for specific responses		
Eliciting States: Ability to intentionally positively influence another person's moods and emotions		
Anchoring: Triggering a specific response (state induction)		
Detecting patterns: Recognising structures of a person's mental processing		

Notes:

The NLP Communication Model

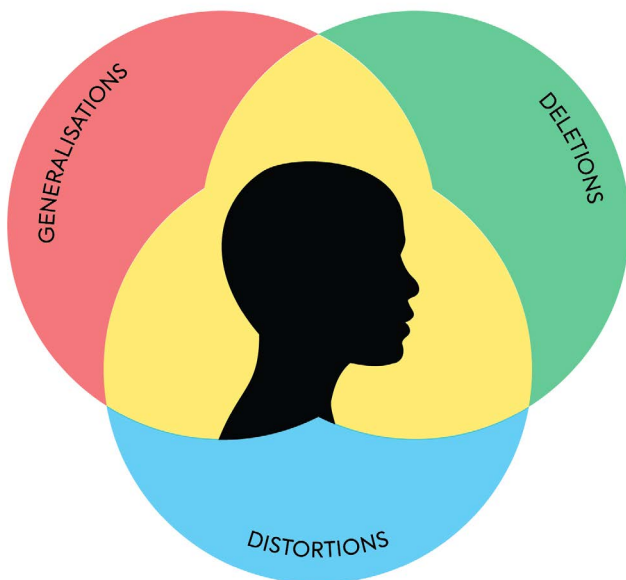
First and foremost, Neuro-Linguistic Programming is a communication model. It was modelled from three world-class communicators and created by a linguist (Grinder) and a young computer and psychology student (Bandler). The NLP model was developed as they used the tools of transformational grammar and computer science to model how we communicate within ourselves.

1) Communication is at the essence of a mapping-process

We humans are "mappers". We take the events and happenings in the world "out here" beyond our nervous systems and bring them "inside" via neurological and mental mapping. Yet as we map things from out here to inside, we Delete, Distort & Generalise certain parts of information.

We communicate to ourselves by re-presenting in the theatre of our mind, what we have seen, heard, and felt out there. This gives us the languages of the mind. This is the control knob for what plays inside our minds involves the sensory languages of visual sights, auditory sounds, and kinaesthetic sensations. We "make sense" of things with our senses by internally processing information and representing this as movies in our mind.

We communicate using these languages of the mind, the languages that we use to create our cinemas that we play out in the theatre of our mind. So, the languages of the mind are our



- Sights (visual)
- Sounds (auditory)
- Sensations (kinaesthetic)
- Smells (olfactory)
- Tastes (gustatory)
- Language (words, linguistics, symbols)

There is a tremendous difference in the speed of speaking and thinking. Most people talk between 100 and 150 words a minute, but how fast can thought go? Some can read at 3,500 words a minute. There are some who can read at 10,000 words a minute. That means the mind can go hundreds, even thousands of times faster than the tongue! That gives a lot of time for us to be thinking about a conversation even while we are in the midst of it.





2) Communication occurs verbally and non-verbally

We 'cannot not communicate'. That is to say, we are always communicating. Even silence is a communication. Every gesture, movement, breath, etc. is a communication. Communication is the union of two people (co-) that results when messages sent, and messages received are shared. That is, the communion of two or more people sharing an experience or awareness through the exchange of verbal and non-verbal signals. The state of connecting and relating (with understanding).

Communicating is more than talking. We can talk and not communicate. It is also more than understanding one another. We can understand and not communicate. In communicating we send and receive messages from another. **We take the symbolic signals of another and process them within our mind to "make sense" of them.** We then respond in a way that seeks further clarification so that we come to understand another as we represent in our mind a close approximation of what the other has in his or her mind.

Linguistics begins with the sensory languages and then moves to the self-reflexive-representation system that we call language. To communicate effectively we have to be able to listen to the representations and mental processing of another person by listening to how they language reality to themselves. The tool of our trade as communicators is what we say (our words, concepts, ideas) and how we say them (all the non-verbal dimensions).

3) Communication creates states and we communicate from state-to-state

The movies and language we use form part of our internal movies and send messages to our neurology and nervous system to create our mind-body states. Given that we are always in a state, we are always communicating to ourselves, consciously and unconsciously to create our states.

What and how we communicate to ourselves creates our states and state management (or emotional intelligence).

Our processing of information induces us into mind-body-emotion states, neuro-linguistic states.

We communicate from the state we are in, to the states that others are in. So, the quality of our life is the quality of our states. We have two royal roads: mind and body; we can change our states through our thoughts, and through changing our physiology.

As we communicate to others, we are simultaneously communicating to ourselves because we are playing and replaying our own mental movies. And as we communicate, we are inducing states within ourselves and within others.

4) All communication is filtered

If we communicate from our states to the states of others, all communication is filtered. We never "hear" or "see" each other naively and simply. We hear what we hear depending on all of the things in the back of our minds and our states. It is filtered by our:

- Values and beliefs
- Understandings and knowledge
- History and memories
- Imaginations and anticipations
- Meanings and frames
- Cognitive intentional filters and self-reflexive-states
- Sense of self and capabilities

That's why we never know what another person has heard and therefore, what it is that we have actually communicated. Therefore, the meaning of our communication is the response we get. In other words, what we meant to communicate isn't as important as what was received by the other person, since this is what was interpreted by them. Meaning is made by the receiver of our communication, based on their cognitive intentions, identity, values, beliefs etc.



5) Communication is layered with multi-dimensions

We do not just communicate at one level, but at multiple levels. This is true for our own self-communication, as well as when we attempt to communicate to each other. Behind the overt messages there are layers of communication in the back of our mind. We have frames within frames of ideas, meanings, and emotions.

When self-reflexivity enters the picture, we have layers and layers of communication going on in our minds. Intention - as one of the frames in the back of the mind, is one of the most powerful drivers of communication. Our intentions set our motives, agendas, and objectives.

6) We communicate through listening and seeing

To enter into the communication experience, we have to open our senses to see and hear all that's going on. That is, to recognise the responses we are getting from others, we have to "lose our mind, come to our senses" (Fritz Perls) and come into sensory awareness. Only then can we learn to calibrate to another's responses in real time.

Listening, seeing, and supporting makes communication receivable. Without receptiveness, communication can become highly filtered and misinterpreted. One question that we all have in the back of our minds is "Do I feel comfortable and open enough to communicate with this person?". So, to become more effective as a communicator, we need to create rapport. To create rapport, we match the other's words, values, physiology, beliefs, understanding and model (map) of the world.

7) High quality communication involves the information loops

As a 2-way process, communication works in loops. These loops of communication include feedback (reflecting back what we received to check in) and feedforward (sharing our interpretation). Feedback is objective, a mirror, in that it is based upon facts. Feedforward is subjective; opinions feelings, experiences etc.

If communication is a dynamic and fluid process of exchanging messages, it involves listening for feedback by questioning for clarification, supporting, inducing states, questioning, etc. in order to be able to effectively feed-forward.

8) Via communication we structure and pattern our experiences

As we speak and construct our sense of reality, our mapping creates our experiences. Our communicating to ourselves and to others formulates our know-how (knowledge), as we map skills and strategies for excellence. As we describe things, we formulate and express our understandings about things.

Language calls our reality into being. We begin to make things real by saying and expressing our understandings and beliefs.

9) Communication is about evoking responses and states

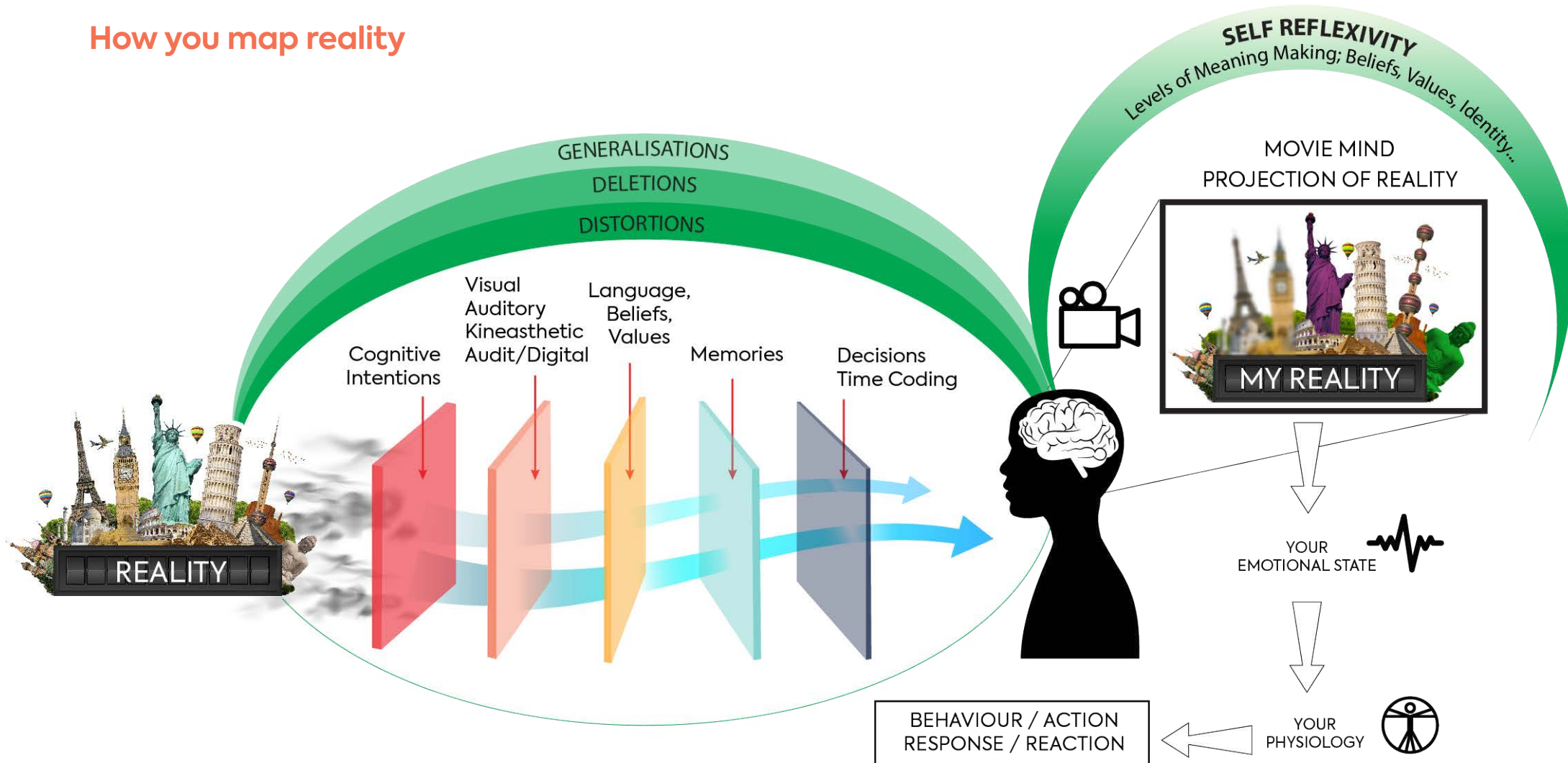
In all of this, communicating is how we evoke responses and states in others and within ourselves and others. This makes state induction very important. We induce states of rapport and curiosity, states of learning and openness, states of motivation and decision, states of creation and integration.

If you do not evoke states in others, you will only have intellectual conversations (and not life changing or transformative encounters). Evoking responses also lies at the heart of trance (hypnotic induction) and in the generation of new resources and potential.



The NLP Communication Model

How you map reality



META PROGRAMS



The Meta-Programs Model



Design

To begin to learn and understand the meta-programs model and to begin to detect the thinking patterns or perceptual filters that govern our thinking, emotions, skills, and sense of reality.

Outcomes

- To learn the template of meta-programs which create our perceptual filters.
- To develop some basic skill in recognition and use of the meta-Programs.
- To develop an appreciation of their value and importance and how to use them in communicating more effectively and persuasively.

Defining meta-programs

What are meta-programs and where do they come from?

We not only process information in our minds by representing things as a movie in our mind- framing that movie layer upon layer, but we create perceptual filters that then influence what and how we see. We call these perceptual filters meta-programs.

We create meta-programs by meta-stating them into existence. We generalise the state to our basic style of thinking or perceiving. Habituation is what gives rise to the solidification of these ways of thinking so that they become our structured ways of perceiving things. At this stage they govern our everyday thinking-and-feeling as perceptual filters.

- For example, a gestalt thinker who sorts for the big picture will frame most other states with global thoughts-and-feelings.
- Someone who sorts for "necessity" thereby brings a state of compulsion to bear on every other thought-and-feeling state.

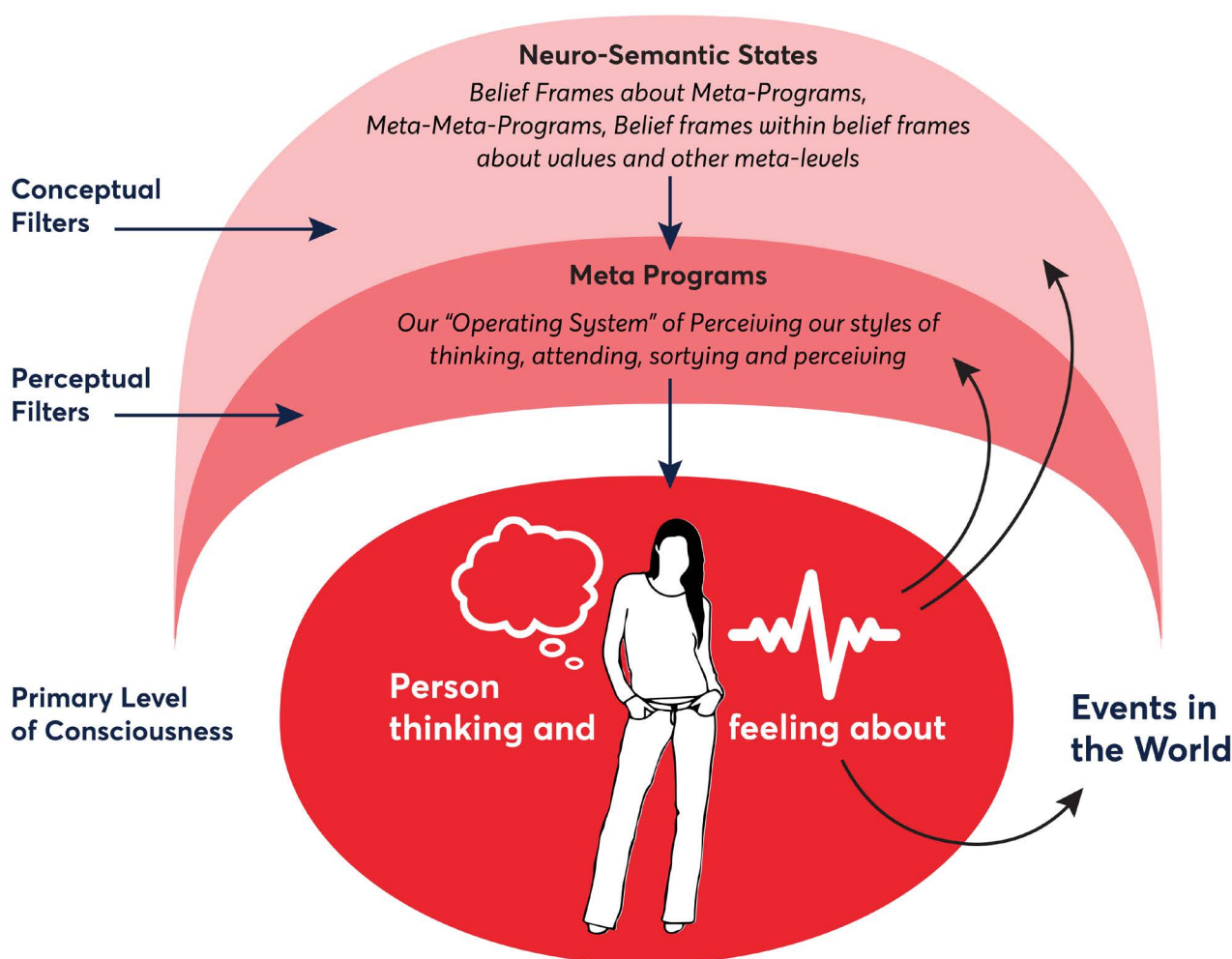


Originating as meta-level thoughts or feelings, we first create fluid meta-states, then as they coalesce, they get into "our eyes" and muscles to become our meta-programs. So, meta- programs arise from Meta-states that have been repeated and habituated, to such an extent that they have coalesced to create what we feel as a primary state giving us our perceptual lens for how we see the world. As such, they comprise a key element in the communication process.

We can think of meta-programs as a range of perceptual choices along a continuum. When we over-value or over-use a meta-program lens, it typically becomes a driving perceptual style or meta-program. We then lose flexibility of perception and consciousness and so this creates a leashing of our potentials.

We coach to meta-programs as well as communicate to meta-programs because they offer tremendous leverage points for change, influence, and effective communication. In coaching mastery, the third module of the Meta-Coach Training System (MCTS), you will learn how to coach to meta-programs as part of the self-actualisation process for unleashing new potentials.

Learning and using meta-programs is also key to the skill of detecting patterns; the theme of the Professional Certified Meta-Coach programme (PCMC – Level-4 MCTS).



Meta States as Meta Programs



Where do meta-programs come from?

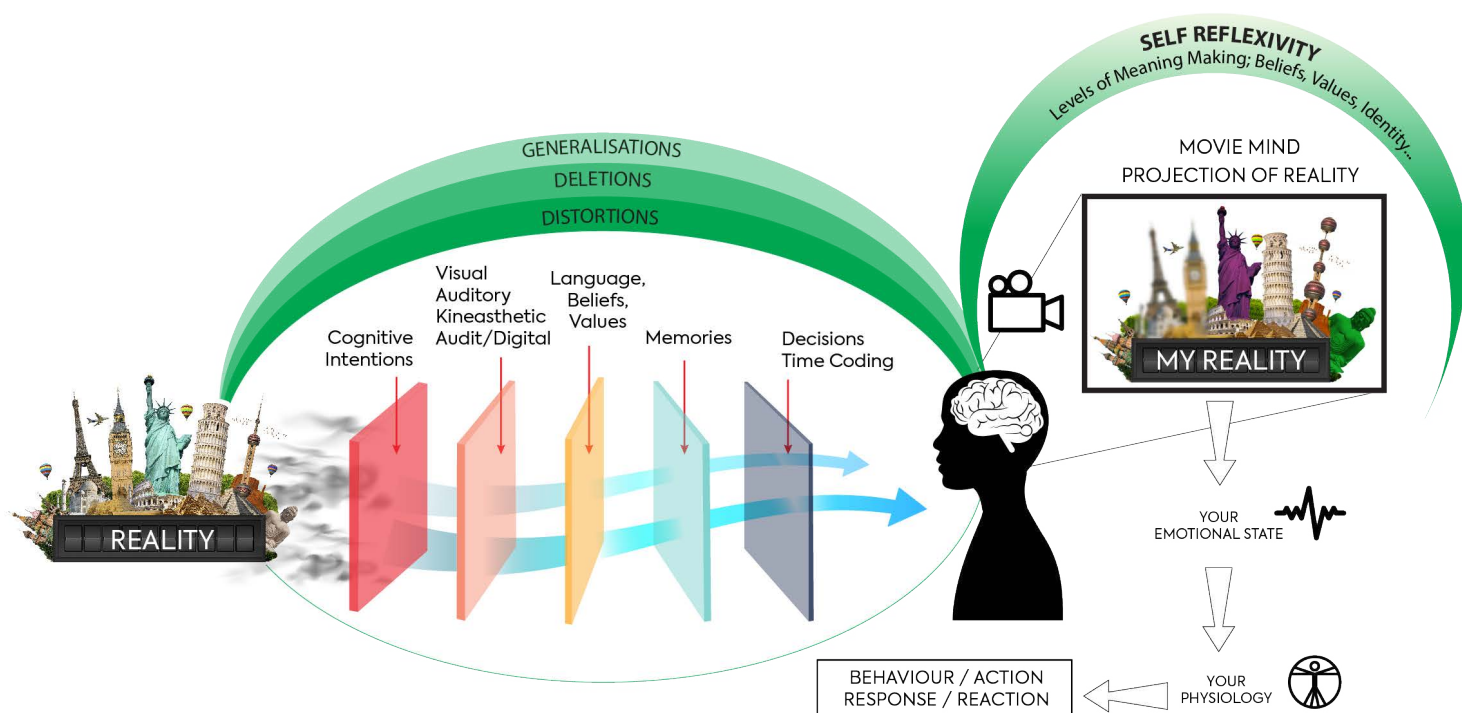
How do we create Meta-programs?

As thinking, sorting and paying attention filters our experience, meta-programs are solidified ways of using our awareness; and so are solidified meta-states.

- We learn to apply global thinking to our thoughts
- We learn to apply detail thinking to our thoughts
- We learn to think in terms of matching or mismatching and then use that as our template for all our thinking

How do we install meta-programs?

- Via habitual use and repetition
- We come to believe in and value them
- We come to identify with them and assume we are our habits, our past.



Meta-program Template



COGNITIVE Thinking	EMOTIONAL Feeling	COGNITIVE Choosing	SEMANTIC Meta meta- programs
1. Representation: visual (V), auditory (A), kinaesthetic (K), language (Ad)	19. Convincer Representation: looks right (V), sounds right (A), feels right (K), makes sense (Ad)	34. Convincer Demonstration: number of times, length of time it takes to be convinced	48. Self-Experience: mind, emotions, will, body, roles or dis- identified
2. Epistemological: Sensor <--> intuitor	20. Movie Position: Inside <-- > outside, step in <- -> step out, associated (feeling) <--> dissociated (thinking)	35. Motivation: direction of intent: toward <--> away from	49. Self-Instruction: compliant – balanced - strong-willed
3. Scope: General, (global) <--> Detail (specifics), inductive <--> deductive	21. Exuberance: desurgency <--> surgency, timid <--> bold	36. Organisational Style: options <--> procedures	50. Self-Confidence: low - in between - high self confidence in ability or capacity
4. Relationship Comparison: matching (sameness) <--> mismatching (difference)	22. Stress Coping: passive – assertive - aggressive	37. Adaptation: judging <--> perceiving	51. Self-Esteem (Self Value): conditional <--> unconditional
5. Information Staging: foregrounding & counting, backgrounding & discounting	23. Authority Source: internal <--> external	38. Modus Operandi: necessity <--> desire possibility --> choice --> impossibility	52. Self-Integrity: conflicted incongruity <--> congruently integrated
6. Scenario Type: pessimistic <--> optimistic. worst-case <--> best case	24. Attention: self <--> other	39. Preference: people, place, things, activity, information	53. Responsibility: under-responsible -- > healthy responsibility --> over-responsible
7. Classification Scale: black - white, either-or <--> continuum or multi- dimensionality	25. Emotional Containment: uni-directional <--> multi-directional	40. Goal Striving: sceptic - optimisation - perfectionism	54. Ego Strength: unstable & weak <--> strong & stable
8. Nature (Aristotelian): static <--> process	26. Rejuvenation: introvert – ambivert - extrovert	41. Buying: cost, quality, quantity, time, convenience	55. Morality: overly strong super-ego - strong super-ego - weak super-ego
9. Focus: screening <--> non-screening	27. Somatic Response: reflective - active - inactive	42. Social Conviner: distrusting & suspicious <--> trusting <--> naïve (over-trusting)	56. Self-Monitoring: low, external <--> high, internal



COGNITIVE Thinking	EMOTIONAL Feeling	COGNITIVE Choosing	SEMANTIC Meta meta- programs
10. Philosophical: why (origins, purpose), how (process)	28. Social Presentation: shrewdly artful <--> artlessly genuine	43. Interactive: competitive <--> cooperative. win/lose <--> win/win/win	57. Time Processing: past – present – future
11. Communication: verbal <--> non-verbal – digital <--> analogue	29. Dominance: power, achievement, affiliation	44. Directness: inferential <--> direct high <--> low	58. Time Experience: in time <--> through time <-- > random sequential
12. Durability of Intent: permeable <--> impermeable	30. Work Style: independent, team player, manager, bureaucrat, follower	45. Management: control – delegate – collaborate	59. Quality of Life: be –do – have
13. Causation: causeless, linear, complex, personal, external, magical, correlation	31. Change Adopter: closed <--> open late – medium – early	46. Risk Taking: aversive <--> embracer fearful <--> excitement	60. Values: List of values – nominalisations of what we believe to be important to us
14. Completion Sort: closure <--> non-closure	32. Attitude Sort: serious <--> playful	47. Decision Making: cautious <--> bold	
15. Information Kind: quantitative <--> qualitative	33. Persistence Sort: impatient <--> patient		
16. Stream of Consciousness: focused <--> diffused <--> in- between			
17. Altitude (stage): pre- conformist – conformist – post conformist			
18. Speed: deliberate and slow <--> witty and quick			

This chart is edited from Hall, L. M., Bodenhamer, B., & Min, D. (2005). Figuring out people²².

²² Hall, L. M., Bodenhamer, B., & Min, D. (2005). Figuring out people.



Meta Program Categories



Cognitive Thinking

- 1. Representation:**
visual (V), auditory (A), kinaesthetic (K), language (Ad)
- 2. Epistemological:**
Sensor <--> intuitor
- 3. Scope:**
General, (global) <--> detail (specifics),
inductive <--> deductive
- 4. Relationship Comparison:**
Matching – (sameness) <--> mismatching
(difference)
- 5. Information Staging:**
Foregrounding & counting, backgrounding
& discounting
- 6. Scenario Type:**
Pessimistic <--> optimistic. worst-case <-->
best case
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Black - white, either-or <--> continuum or
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- 8. Nature (Aristotelian):** static <--> process
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Screening <--> non-screening
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Why (origins, purpose), how (process)
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Pre- conformist – conformist – post
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- 18. Speed:**
Deliberate and slow <--> witty and quick

Notes:

Meta Program Categories



Emotional Feeling

19. **Convincer Representation:**
looks right (V), sounds right (A),
feels right (K), makes sense (Ad)
20. **Movie Position:**
inside <--> outside, step in <--> step out,
associated (feeling) <--> dissociated
(thinking)
21. **Exuberance:**
desurgency <--> surgency, timid <--> bold
22. **Stress Coping:**
passive – assertive -aggressive
23. **Authority Source:**
internal <--> external
24. **Attention:**
self <--> other
25. **Emotional Containment:**
uni-directional <--> multi-directional
26. **Rejuvenation:**
introvert – ambivert - extrovert
27. **Somatic Response:**
reflective - active - inactive
28. **Social Presentation:**
shrewdly artful <--> artlessly genuine
29. **Dominance:**
power, achievement, affiliation
30. **Work Style:**
independent, team player, manager,
bureaucrat, follower
31. **Change Adopter:**
closed <--> open late - medium - early
32. **Attitude Sort:**
serious <--> playful
33. **Persistence Sort:**
impatient <--> patient

Notes:

Meta Program Categories



Cognitive Choosing

- 34. Convincer Demonstration:
Number of times, length of time
- 35. Motivation:
Direction of intent:
toward <--> away from
- 36. Organisational Style:
Options <--> procedures
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People, place, things, activity, information
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Sceptic - optimisation - perfectionism
- 41. Buying:
Cost, quality, quantity, time, convenience
- 42. Social Convincer:
Distrusting & suspicious <--> trusting <-->
naïve (over-trusting)
- 43. Interactive:
Competitive <--> cooperative. win/lose
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- 44. Directness:
Inferential <--> direct high <--> low
- 45. Management:
Control – delegate - collaborate
- 46. Risk Taking:
Aversive <--> embracer fearful <-->
excitement
- 47. Decision Making:
Cautious <--> bold

Notes:



Meta Program Categories



Semantic Meta Meta Programs

- | | |
|---|--|
| 48. Self-Experience:
Mind, emotions, will, body, roles or dis-identified | 55. Morality:
Overly strong super-ego - strong super-ego
- weak super-ego |
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Unstable & weak <--> strong & stable | |

Notes:



Detecting Meta-Programs

Exercise – Activity

Personal Preparation

What are the best states to operate from so that we can communicate?
Make a list of your best communication states.

What are your best states for detecting and responding to meta-programs?
Make a list of your best detection states.

Learning to Detect Patterns of Perception

If meta-programs typically operate outside of our conscious awareness,
how do we bring these programs into awareness?

How can we become even more aware of them?

How can we learn to see the effect they have on the way we process information and interact with others?





Your Self-Preparation:

1. Turn up your reasons (why) for paying attention

If you had a way to detect, sort out, and pay attention to these meta-level patterns. If you could consciously detect and track how any given person attends the world, you will have a way to more effectively understand and even predict that person's style of hearing and responding to things. This will give you an awareness of that person's model of reality.

2. Access your best sensory awareness state

Move into uptime with all your sensory awareness to become fully present.

3. Access your best flexibility state

Knowing another's model of the world and having the flexibility to alter your own behaviours and communications, empowers you to meet that person where they are at. This way of connecting and matching creates rapport, which reduces resistance, conflict, and misunderstandings.

Your Practitioner Preparation

1. Assist the person into a more fully associated state

The more one is in an experience, the cleaner the information we'll gather. Amplify that state when necessary and appropriate.

2. Switch references

Use the temporary employment frame:
"If I were you for a day how would I have to do that?"
"Teach me how to do that."

3. Anchor the experience

Do it without using the touch or kinaesthetic system, focus on using your voice and gestures to anchor the experience.

4. Slow the experience down and keep recycling

Most subjective experiences go by too fast to catch all of the embedded patterns within it the first time. We see and hear much more when we see a fast-paced movie the second and third times. Recycle through the experience with the person to gather more information.

5. Invite the person to step into and out of the experience

Watch the difference between when the person is associating into the experience and feeling it and when the person is not.



Meta-program Mastery

Exercise – Activity

How can we develop mastery in detecting and using meta-programs?

- 1. Take each meta-program, one at a time and practice each one until you develop proficiency in recognising and using it when speaking**
 - *Refuse to overwhelm yourself with them.*
- 2. Give yourself permission to hear structure and move out of content**
 - *Go meta to listen for processing patterns. Does this make you self-conscious?*
- 3. Use open-ended questions to elicit meta-programs**
 - *"Would you tell me about one of your favourite holiday experiences?"*
 - *"What do you think about developing more effectiveness in communication skills?"*
- 4. Some close-ended questions will also work**
 - *"Do you see this glass as half empty or half full?" This can work well.*

5. Use downtime questions to elicit meta-programs

Any questions that require a person to "go inside" to access the information they need in order to respond. If they don't have the information (on the tip of their tongue), they will typically begin to demonstrate their meta-program. They act it out in various ways. So, to elicit meta-programs simply ask a person to fully and completely recall something and have them then step into that experience and feel it fully as if there.

6. Remember

All meta-programs do not all carry the same or equal weight of importance. They differ according to how a person uses and values them in a given task or area. Identify context, and then prioritise them in terms of importance to that person

- *"Which MP is most important and impactful for this person?"*
- *"What MP exercises the most significance in this person's experiencing?"*

7. Use the sorting grid to track the meta-programs (see Figuring Out People for the Grids)

This will help you organise them in your own thinking and memory. Use it as a tool for profiling yourself first, then those you know well.

8. Practice writing pacing statements

Use the information as soon as you can. Practice writing matching statements. This will greatly increase your communication skills.

If a person operates as a strong "self" sorter (self-referencing) who mismatches with counter-examples (or with polarity responses), they will tend to feel inclined to challenge people with "prove it to me!" statements. This can spiral into a pointless matching of wits if you don't watch out. Yet knowing this, we can now counter this internal formatting with a pacing statement like:

"You seem so good at knowing your needs, that only you can truly decide what you deem as ultimately right. No question about that. And I don't know if what I have to say will make any difference anyway. But anyway, here it is."



Meta Program Activities



Exercise – Activity

1. Positive experience.

1. Elicit a positive experience from experiencer.
2. In groups of 3, invite the experiencer to talk about a positive event... Talk about the experience when the person felt enthused, successful, brilliant, creative, decisive, a winner, etc.). Make sure the experience is a positive one.
3. Practitioners to coach the experiencer in order to elicit more and more of the experience with questions.
4. After 5 minutes, have practitioners present the experiencer a summary of their "reading" of his or her meta-programs. Check with experiencer to determine the accuracy.

2. The sales encounter

1. Groups of 4, one person begins to identify something that he or she would **"never ever buy."**
2. Person B will then attempt to sell that very item to Person A.
As B attempts this "sell," the first person should essentially consistently respond with a gentle refusal, just saying "no, I'm not interested."
3. Person B should forge ahead regardless of A's verbal and non-verbal resistance.
4. During this, the two Meta-persons will be writing down all of the meta-programs they can detect in both persons. Pay special attention in detecting the linguistic markers within the language patterns of the persons.



3. The ideal evening game (or, the dating game)

1. In pairs, ask open-ended questions of your partner (the experiencer) inquiring about what makes for a great night out.
 - "What would you want to know about a person before you ask him or her out?"
 - "What would you need to know to have an evening out with a good friend?"
 - "What would you evaluate as a delightful evening out with someone?"
2. Create a list of all meta-programs that you detect in the other person's responses.

4. Asking for a favour

1. Set a frame or context so that the practitioner will aim to persuade the experiencer to do him or her a favour.
2. Ask an employee to do something... Part of their job or something extra.
Ask someone you're in business with for a favour.
3. The practitioner (or coach) begins by asking ten questions of the experiencer to identify his or her basic meta-programs. Ask general, conversational question to gather this information.
4. After gathering MP information, practitioner will then frame their request (evoking the desired outcome) in words that will reflect the experiencer's most compelling meta-programs.
5. Feedback for refining.
Afterwards, invite the experiencer to gauge the effectiveness of the request and to offer feedback about how it could be made even more personally compelling for him or her.

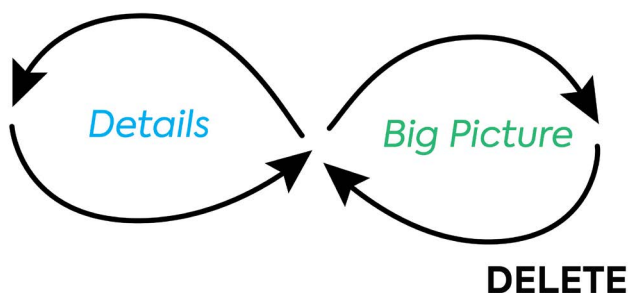


Expanding Meta-programs

Exercise – Activity

Meta-programs inform our brain regarding what to delete.

SORT FOR



If we move toward values, we delete awareness about what we move away from. If we sort for the details, we delete the big picture.

Re-direct awareness to what you normally delete, value that information, practice looking for it.

The beginning place for changing a Meta-program is to consciously decide to do so.

Awareness of Meta program

1. Become aware of the meta-program

- What meta program do you suspect you run, where, when and with whom?

2. Identify contexts where you want to use a different meta-program filter

- Then check the ecology and value of the meta program in those contexts. Ask yourself;
- "Does it functionally fit for me to lean onto a different meta programs?"

3. Give yourself permission to try it on for a day

- Do you have permission to shift it?

4. Shift your consciousness to the other side of the continuum as you try on the other meta programs

5. Set multiple frames that will support using the preferred meta program

- What ideas or beliefs would support this filter?





Expand the meta-program

1. Identify and check the ecology of the meta-program filter

- *When, where, and how do you use this meta-program that does not serve you well?*
 - *How does it undermine your effectiveness in some way?*
-

2. Describe the preferred Meta-program filter

- *What Meta-level processing would you prefer to run your perceiving and valuing?*
 - *When, where, and how do you want this meta-program to govern your consciousness?*
-

3. Try it out

Imaginatively adopt the new meta program, pretend to use it in sorting, perceiving, attending, etc. Notice how it seems, feels, works, etc. in some contexts where you think it would serve you better. Even if it seems a little "weird" and strange due to your unfamiliarity with looking at the world with that particular perceptual filter, notice what other feelings, beside discomfort, may arise with it.

4. Model it

- *Do you know someone who uses this meta program?*
-

If so, then explore with that person his or her experience until you can fully step into that position. When you can, then step into 2nd position, so that you can see the world out of that person's Meta-program eyes, hearing what he or she hears, self-talking as he or she engages in self-dialogue and feeling what that person feels.

- *What's that like?*
-

5. Run a systems-check on the meta-program filter

Go Meta to an even higher level and consider what this meta program will do to you and for you in terms of perception, valuing, believing, behaving, etc.

- *What kind of a person would it begin to make you?*
 - *What effect would it have on various aspects of your life?*
-





6. Give yourself permission to install it for a period of time

- *Do you have permission to shift to this meta-program filter?*
- *What happens when you give yourself permission to use it for a time? Are there any objections?*

Answer by reframing and then future pace.

If you have typically operated using the 'other-referencing' meta-program and you give yourself permission to shift to 'self-referencing'. Yet when you do, you hear an internal voice that sounds like your mother's voice in tone and tempo, "It's selfish to think about yourself. Don't be so selfish, you will lose all of your friends."

This voice objects on two accounts: selfishness and disapproval that leads to loneliness. So, rephrase your permission to take these objections into account. "I give myself permission to see the world referencing centrally from myself, my values, beliefs, wants, etc., knowing that my values including loving, caring, and respecting others will keep me balanced by considering the effect of my choices on others."

7. Future pace using the meta-program in specific contexts

Practice, in your imagination, using the meta program and do so until it begins to feel comfortable and familiar.

"If you knew when you originally made the choice to operate from the other referent (name the Meta-program you want to change), would that have been, before, after, or during birth?" Use one of the time-line processes to neutralise the old emotions, thoughts, beliefs, decisions e.g. The visual-kinaesthetic dissociation technique, decision destroyer pattern. Once you have cleared out the old pattern, you can install the new meta-program.

Notes:





Changing Meta-Programs In And With “Time”

Meta-programs refer to our strategies for filtering the information, our strategies for seeing. Therefore, it makes sense to update any strategy that's sluggish, inappropriate, and mal-adjusted.

Why is it that time affects our meta program filters?

How does time have such an effect on our meta programs?

As events come and go over a period of months or years, these ever-changing events create new learning contexts; contexts within which we learn to pay attention to, sort for, and perceive in different ways.

So, when we do pseudo-time orientation using various time-line patterns, we use a meta- level structure that alters our thinking contexts. Additionally, we use an inherently hypnotic process when we “go inside” and access our time-line and then float above it back to our “past.” This enables us to access a highly receptive and suggestible state, which in turn, amplifies our responsiveness to the change patterns.

Notes:



LISTENING

(Skill #1)



The Art of Being Present to Another



Listening

Listening is attending to a person and paying attention to the key elements in the person's communicating.

Listening actively and effectively involves:

Sensory awareness	To notice and detect the person's state of mind. We call this calibrating to the person's experience and mental- emotional state.
Representational system understanding	To detect, recognise and record the sensory representational and meta-representational systems that a person uses to make sense of things.
Eye accessing cue awareness and acuity	To be able to see in and experience how a person is processing information and the states that are being accessed.
Linguistic awareness	To detect the kind of language patterns a person is using.

We have so many things we can listen for, pay attention to, and be present to.

These include:

1. Calibrating to the person's present state and their desired state.
2. Noticing the physiology of their state in terms of breathing, muscle tension, posture, eye scanning, face, tone of voice, etc. (sensory acuity).
3. The editorial features of how a person frames the movies in the mind (structure).
4. The representational language of a person.

Yet this is just the beginning. There will be many more things that we can notice if we have the sensory awareness to be present when we are communicating.



Benchmarks for Listening

Being actively present to a client, collecting and synthesising the sensory information (visual, auditory, and kinaesthetic) as well as non-sensory specific terms, so as to accurately reflect back the content presented as well as process information.

Level 3.75 – Quietly attending

Speaking 5% to 10% of the time perhaps 15%. Turning body to client to be fully physically present to the client. Acknowledging the communication by maintaining eye contact, using soft "sparkling eyes," head nodding, and other encouragers. Asking about what is not being said. Asking questions that invite client to co-create more questions or awareness (awareness questions) of mental and emotional structures and resources, client talking extensively and then saying thing like, "I never thought of any of this before."

Level 3.5 – Talking 10 to 30% quietly probing

Asking questions that probe for more details about client's view of things, inviting client to self-listen ("Did you hear what you just said?") to increase awareness of what's "in the back of the mind," giving space and time for person to be with those thoughts and feelings, being silent as the client speaks 60% or more of the time, supporting client (see supporting). Ask lots of awareness questions about patterns, "How aware are you that you have said lots of things about X, but nothing about Y?"

Level 3 – Repeating precise words, 40% talking

Actively exploring the structure and content by; inquiring about form, using more body language, head nodding to encourage the client to speak, using "encouragers" such as sounds - "hmmm," "ahhh," "yes, go ahead," "say more." Using extended silences and pauses so the client speaks at least 60% of the time and using the client's precise words.

Level 2 – Less parrot-phrasing, more repeating, 60 to 70 % talking

Regular eye contact, repeating back specific words and some paraphrasing that matches client's content, speaking 60% (still high) or more of the time and quiet only 40% of time, giving little time for client to speak.

Level 1 – Some eye contact/ body contact 70 % talking

Distracting, making some eye contact, paraphrasing the client's sentences, only partially keeping general track of the content. "Where are we?" Taking notes on things other than the client's statements with eyes internally processing while client speaks. [If eye contact means something other than listening and respect in a given culture, then turning body toward client or equivalent]. Some telling, interrupting and mindreading.

Level 0 – Telling and interrupting

No evidence of being present to client as indicated by no eye contract, no tracking of content, of what is being said, talking over, telling, teaching, making evaluations, and interrupting.



Sensory Acuity Skills



“The meaning of your communication is the response you get.”

- NLP Presupposition #3

We never know what we communicate to another person, since we never know what they hear, sense or perceive. So, it is in the exploring of their response that you can get an idea of what must have been communicated (otherwise you are mindreading their meanings and intentions).

Communication involves a lot more than talking; it also involves sensory acuity and awareness (attentive listening). Successful communicators accept and then utilise all responses offered them.

This refers to the art and skill of calibrating to a person while accessing a state or experiencing something. In calibrating, we pay attention to numerous aspects of the person's behaviours and non-verbal output.

Things we can listen for:

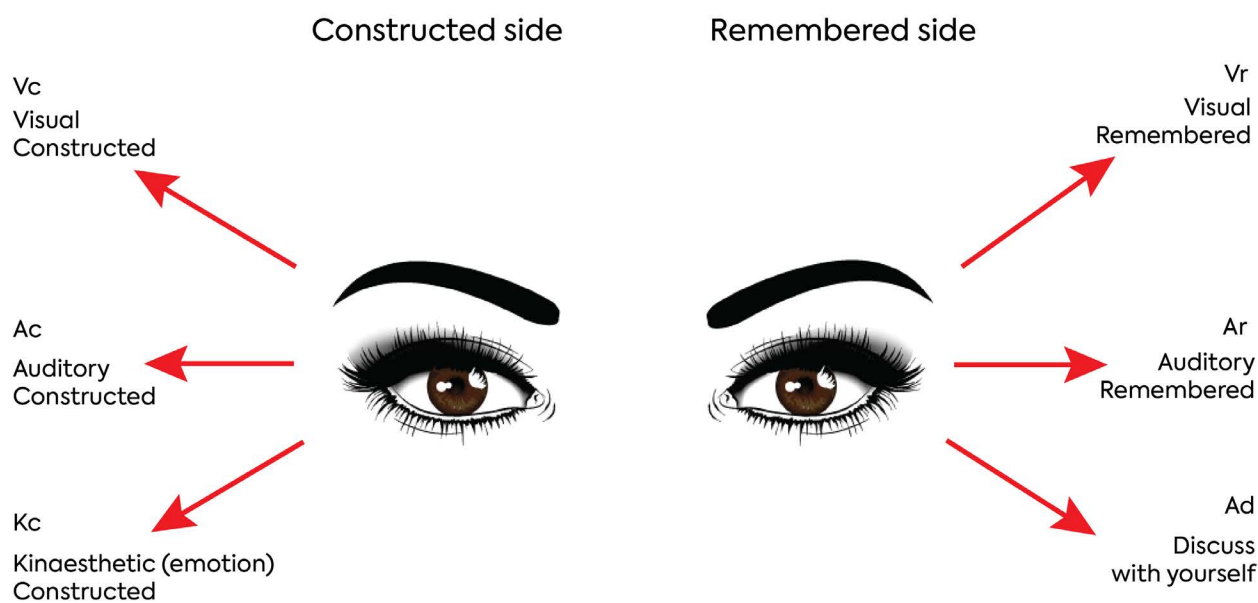
Voice	Inclination (of the spine, general posture and gesture)	Breathing	Eyes	Skin
• Tone • Volume • Quality • Pitch • Speed • Pace • Timbre • Modulation • Type of words used	• Slumped or straight • Leaning forwards, upright or back • Range and speed of gestures • Symmetrical / Asymmetrical	• Rate (Fast / Slow) • Depth • Location in body (High / Low)	• Focus: Focused / Defocused • Movements • Pupil dilation (Dilated / Undilated) • Redness • Watering • Direction	• Colour (Light / Dark) • Muscle tone • Size of areas (eg Lips) • Shiny / dull • Goose-pimples

Eye Accessing Cues Diagram



We generally all move our eyes in a recognisable and patterned way. This patterning gives some indication about what a person is processing on the inside, as he or she is thinking. If we face a person and watch the way his or her eyes move, then the following diagram gives us a way to make sense of what's happening for most people (this is however, only map, and can be different for differently wired people).

Note: This is a mirror image. For example, when referencing upper left, it appears as upper right to the observer.



Note: Some of us are reverse-wired.





Questions that Cause Eye Chatter

Exercise – Activity

In pairs, face each other and using the following questions to create eye movement, mark down as you observe another person closely.

Notice what happens on the outside in terms of their eye patterns when you ask these questions. You will need to stay in sensory awareness, or you may miss it !

Then switch partners and experience the inner moves for yourself

Vr: Visual Remembered. Recalling an image or picture.

1. What was your favourite colour as a child? Go ahead and see it now.

2. What colour was your bedroom in your childhood home of 12?

3. What did you wear yesterday?

Vc: Visual Constructed. Making up pictures you have never seen.

4. What is it like when you imagine your car as green with yellow dots on it?

5. What if you had bright flaming red hair? What would you look like?

6. What if a traffic light had the green light at the top and the red light at the bottom?





Ar: Auditory Remembered. Remembering sounds or voices previously heard.

7. What does your favourite song sound like?

8. Are you able to listen again, in your head, to the very last statement I made?

9. What is the sound of ocean waves lapping on the shore?

Ac: Auditory Constructed. Creating and inventing new sounds.

10. What would I sound like if I sounded like Mickey Mouse?

11. What would I sound like if I spoke 4 times slower or faster?

K: Kinaesthetic. Feelings, sensations, emotions.

12. What does it feel to rub your hand over a cat or dog?

13. What is the feel of the warm sun shining on your skin like?

14. Have you ever dived into a cold stream or an icy sea?





Ad: Auditory Digital. Internal talk, dialogue, self-conversation.

15. What did you say to yourself the last time you made a major decision?

16. Can you recite the words of your favourite song or poem to yourself... now?

17. What do you say to yourself about what you really want out of life?

The power of listening for eye chatter, is that it enables us to listen for what is not being said. Maybe someone is sharing something that seems emotional for them, yet they do not access the lower right of feelings. We can hear that, and maybe even ask about it. Purposely watching for eye movement is also a great way to stay present to the other.

Notes:

Basic Calibration of Sensory Acuity in NLP



Exercise – Activity

A. Basic Calibration

Form groups of 3 – The coach, the coachee and the meta-person (or observer)

1. Elicit from one person the story of his or her pathway to personal development or coaching for 4 minutes
2. The coach observes and tracks the client's eye accessing cues, breathing, colour, etc.

3. The meta-person (observer) listens for predicates and watches the entire process.

4. Debrief for 2 minutes

- How much did you manage to stay out of content?
- To what extent were you able to identify the structures?

5. Return to the group for a debrief.





B. Calibrating to like and dislike

Form groups of 2 – The coach, the coachee

1. Calibrate for differences

Pair up and ask your partner to think of someone they like (don't say who). Watch for small changes in breathing, posture, muscle tone, skin colour, etc.

2. Next, think of someone they dislike (don't say who)

Watch for changes.

3. Invite the person to go back and forth between thinking of the liked and disliked people they chose

Do so until you can clearly see the differences between expressions.

4. Ask a series of comparative questions

This is to test your sensory awareness. Without telling, the questioner is to access his or her inner knowing of the answer, not to hide the answer, but just to know it without saying it. Watch the person's response and indicate which one you think it is.

Any comparative question will work, for example:

Which one is taller? Which one has nicer clothes? Which one have you seen most recently? Met first? Which one has darker hair? More athletic? Which one is heavier? Brightest teeth? Which one lives nearer to you? Wears earrings? Which one makes more money? Reads more?

5. Calibrating

When your partner goes inside to process the question and get an answer, they may first consider the person they like then the one they do not.

You may initially see some back and forth responses. The person's answer will typically be the response you see just before he or she comes back and looks at you, or nods head to indicate that he or she has determined the answer.

When you've guessed correctly four times in a row, switch roles.

6. Return to group and debrief.



C. Calibrating states

Form groups of 3 – The coach, the coachee and the meta-person (or observer)

1. Story telling time

For five minutes recall four learning experiences and tell them to the others.

- *Tell about three experiences that are completely true and positive.*
- *Tell a fourth story that is in no part, true at all; in fact, a complete lie.*
- *The false story can come in any sequence with your presenting your four stories.*

Calibrate to the person's style of communicating.

2. Guess

After the telling, each person guesses which one is the false one.

3. Debrief

Using your sensory acuity skills, which one do you believe to be the false one?

4. Rotate by moving around in the chairs and start with a new LIAR



Representational Listening

Witnessing the inside from out here!

We "make sense" of things in the world by reproducing or representing what we have seen, heard, felt, smelled and tasted onto the inner screen of our mind. As we do that, we create some kind of sensory representation, which we experience as a movie in our mind. This movie may be just a snapshot of a picture, or of a sound, or of a sensation, but it is the beginnings of how we create our mental movies. Each movie has various representations, e.g. visual (pictures, images, sights), auditory (sounds, noise, music, words) and kinaesthetic (sensations, feelings), etc. These representational systems make up the most basic components of the languages of our mind. From these we create the movies in our mind.

VISUAL:	AUDITORY:	KINAESTHETIC:	LANGUAGE (Auditory Digital):
Those who have a preference and over-specialise in the visual system, tend to:	Those who have a preference and over-specialise in the Auditory system, tend to	Those who have a preference and over-specialise in the kinaesthetic system, tend to:	Those who have a preference and over-specialise in language systems, tend to:
• Memorises by seeing pictures and is less distracted by noise. • Often has trouble remembering, and become bored by, long verbal instructions. • More interested in how something looks, value appearances. • Will often stand or sit with their hands/bodies erect and with their eyes upward. • Breathes high, from the top of the lungs. • Sits forward in a chair, be organised, neat, well groomed, orderly. • Often thin, slender, and even wiry. • Moves eyes up to access visual images, looks around noticing lots of things. • Uses a higher pitch, talk quickly - in spurts. • Uses gestures that are high, wide, expansive, sometimes will point.	• Pays attention to sounds, tones, volumes, and finds noises more distracting. • Easily repeat things back what they hear and learns best by listening. • Likes music and enjoys talking on the phone. • Highly values tone of voice and the use of specific words. • Often moves their eyes laterally (sideways). • Breathes from the middle of the chest, talks to themselves, sub-vocalises, memorises sequences, and hold their body to aim their ear towards the sound (of someone talking for example). • Thinks in more linear, word-by-word ordering, logical. • Uses gestures around the mid-section, adopt a "telephone position," tilt head.	• Uses their body to think, remember, and communicate. • May talk slowly and in a breathy way. • May respond to physical touch and rewards. • Gestures closer to the body, hand over heart. • Memorises by doing something or walking around. • Most interested that something feels right or evokes the right feelings. • Typically breathes deeply from the bottom of their lungs. • Moves eyes downward to access feelings. • Tonality will tend to be slower, lower pitch, with hesitations.	• Wants to "make sense" of things by using words. • Talks in more abstract terms, generalise, theories, etc. • May even have little awareness of the sensory-based systems. • Much less use of body, gestures, more in a "computer" mode



Listening for the Movies



Qualities of our inner movies

Not only do we have the basic representational systems, but also within each of these domains, we can make many further distinctions. These are qualities of the sense modalities and they make up the cinematic features of our mental movies.

If you read classic NLP literature, you will find that these are falsely labelled, "sub-modalities." They are not "sub" or smaller at all but are actually editorial frames and so are our meta- modalities. By these, we can edit the movies of our mind and communicate to ourselves in such a way to change the movie completely.

VISUAL	AUDITORY	KINAESTHETIC
Brightness (from dull to bright)	Pitch (low/high)	Pressure
Focus	Location of sounds	What sensations
Colour (degree)	Continuous/interrupted	Location
Colour (black and white/colour)	Tone	Extent
Size	Number of sources	Moisture
Distance	Associated/dissociated	Shape
Contrast	Tempo	Texture
Movement	Volume	Temperature
Direction	Rhythm	Movement
Foreground/background	Duration	Duration (still/moving)
Location	Distance	Duration
Snapshot – movie (still/moving)	Clarity	Intensity
Number of images	Whose voice	Frequency
Bordered/Panoramic	Music, noise, voice	Rhythm
Shape, form	Clarity, intelligibility	
Horizontal/vertical perspective	Melody	
Associated/dissociated		
3D or flat (2D)		

LANGUAGE (OR THE AUDITORY DIGITAL) SYSTEM	OTHER SYSTEMS
Location of words	Smells
Sensory based/evaluative	Tastes
Simple/complex	Balance (vestibular: dizzy, disoriented, etc.)
Self/others	
Current/dated	



Listening for Representations in Speech

Representational System Predicates

What are the cues that a person is using in any given system of representation to create the movies in their mind? There are linguistic cues for each system. Learning to listen for these enables us to detect the way the person is processing information.

Visually:

If I could show you an attractive and very clear way so that you could X (some value), I wonder if you would like to look at that and see if it does fit with what you're wanting.

Auditorily:

If I could effectively describe to you some of the benefits that you really want to obtain, would you like to hear about them now or discuss them more fully?

Kinaesthetically:

If I could help you get a hold of this value that you want in a concrete way, and in a way that really embraces the value fully, would you like to try it on, just to get a feel for it?



Listening for the Movies

Exercise – Activity

What are your preferred representations that you hold in mind to create the movies of your mind with?

Pair up and ask your partner about their experience of this training so far (ask the question – “what is your experience of this training so far?”), Listen and write down, using the VAK space below your client’s preferences.

I heard these specific words:

My client’s preference therefore probably is:

Visually:

admire	appear	foresee	scan	attractive	form
see	blurred	gaze	shine	bright	glance
show	clear	glare	sight	cloudy	gleam
sight	see	colourful	glow	sparkle	conceal
graphic	dark	hazy	staring	dawn	illuminate
strobe	disappear	imagine	surface	display	obscure
twinkle	envision	observe	vanish	exhibit	look
veil	expose	peer	view	eyed	perspective
visualise	faced	picture	view	flash	preview
vivid	focus	reflect	watch		

Phrases:

seeing eye to eye	catch a glimpse of	appears to me	mental picture	paint a picture	got an eyeful
beyond a shadow of a doubt	clear cut	mind’s eye	bird’s eye view	a sight for sore eyes	naked eye
get a perspective	staring off in to space	tunnel vision	snap shot	make a scene	take a peek
pretty as a picture	showing off	crystal clear	plainly seen	dim view	under your nose
in view of	see to it	photographic	flashed on	short sighted	hazy idea



Kinaesthetically:

angle	grapple	skip	beat	grasps	slip
bends	grinds	smooth	bounce	hard	soft
break	hold	solid	brush	hug	spike
burdened	hurt	stuffed	carry	impression	thick
clumsy	irritate	sweep	comfortable	mushy	concrete
movement	touch	crouching	pinch	trample	crumble
plush	tremble	exciting	pressure	twist	feel
pull	budge	firm	rub	unfeeling	fits
run	warm	flop	scramble	wash	force
scrape	weigh	grab	shaky	work	forceful

Phrases:

all washed up	hot-head	be felt	keep your shirt on
boils down to	know-how	catch on	lay the cards out
chip off the old block	come to grips with	control yourself	get a handle on
make contact	connect with	moment of panic	the pressure's on
pain-in-the-neck	cool/calm	pull some strings	hold it, hold on
firm foundations	sharp as a tack	floating on thin air	under handed
slip through	get a hold of	slipped my mind	topsy turvy
get a handle on	smooth operator	get a load of this	heated argument
start from scratch	stiff upper lip	light headed	get in touch with
get the drift of	throw out	hand in hand	tap into
hands on	turn around	cropped up	step up
stiff upper lip	hang in there		

Auditorily:

announce	harmony	request	answer	harsh	resonance
argue	hear	sang	asked	hum	shout
attune	inquire	shriek	call	insult	shrill
chatter	lecture	sighs	cheer	listen	silences
complain	loud	silent	crescendo	melodious	sound(s)
cry	mention	stammer	deaf	mumble	talk
discuss	noisy	tell	echo	outspoken	translate
explain	overtones	question	utter	expression	growl

Phrases:

be all ears, blabber mouth, clearly expressed, express yourself, tattle tale	make music, pay attention to purrs like a kitten rap session	state your purpose, give me your ear describe in detail	be heard, clear as a bell, call on, ear full	manner of speaking, power of speech, outspoken	give an account of, grant me an audience
describe in detail	state your purpose, give me your ear	give an account of, grant me an audience	tongue-tied utterly, voice an opinion, word- for-word	heard voices, hold your tongue inquire into loud and clear	tune in/tune out, hidden messages, unheard of, idle talk, key note speaker





OLFACTORY / GUSTATORY					
bitter	smell	fragrant	smokey	fresh	sour
odour	spicy	pungent	stale	salty	sweet
savour	taste	tang	bite	tongue	after-taste
essence	inhale	breath	flavour	lick	fume
sip	palate	scent	whiff	reek	a nose for

UNSPECIFIED PREDICATES					
conscious	know	learn	aware	light	believe
motivate	change	nice	clear	notice	conceive
perceive	consider	process	decide	question	experience
sense	feel	think	sense	sensitive	understand

LANGUAGE (AD)					
meaning	evaluation	significance	compute	count	account
factors	factor in	the bottom line			

Notes:



Representational System Practice



Exercise – Activity

Genie Laborde (Influencing with Integrity) uses a handy instrument for determining one's preferred representation system. Use it to determine which system you most prefer, prefer secondarily, and which one you do not consciously use very much. The system that gives you the most difficulty to translate and match probably reflects your least used system.

1. My future looks hazy

Match – Visual: When I look to the future, it doesn't seem clear

Translate:

Auditory: I can't tune in to my future

Kinaesthetic: I can't get a feel for what seems to be going to happen

2. Sarah doesn't listen to me

Match – Auditory: Sarah goes deaf when I talk

Translate:

Visual: Sarah never sees me, even when I'm present

Kinaesthetic: I get the feeling Sarah doesn't know I'm alive

3. Mary gets churned up on Mondays when the boss expects the report

Match – Kinaesthetic: Mary gets agitated and nervous on Mondays

Translate:

Visual: Mary can't focus on Mondays when the report comes due

Auditory: Mary hears lots of static on Mondays when the report comes due



Increase your awareness of the representational systems. This will offer you good practice for future use. This exercise will wire your mind to match predicates when you next hear one of these.

4. My boss walks over me like I'm a doormat

Match:

.....

Translate into two other representational systems:

.....

.....

5. I get the feeling I'm unappreciated

Match:

.....

Translate into two other representational systems:

.....

.....

6. I have trouble looking back to that problem

Match:

.....

Translate into two other representational systems:

.....

.....

7. I guide this project by the seat of my pants

Match:

.....

Translate into two other representational systems:

.....

.....





8. She seems like such a sweet girl

Match:

.....

Translate into two other representational systems:

.....
.....

9. I ask myself, "How did I ever get into this?"

Match:

.....

Translate into two other representational systems:

.....
.....

10. I can imagine what she's like

Match:

.....

Translate into two other representational systems:

.....
.....

11. Something tells me I'm making a mistake

Match:

.....

Translate into two other representational systems:

.....
.....

12. I've tried to get a handle on what my boss means

Match:

.....

Translate into two other representational systems:

.....
.....





13. I keep stubbing my toe on unexpected obstacles.

Match:

Translate into two other representational systems:

14. Joe paints a clear picture of disaster ahead.

Match:

Translate into two other representational systems:

15. Smells like a dead fish to me.

Match:

Translate into two other representational systems:

What carries the most impact in communication? Verbal or Non-Verbal channels?

Notes:



SUPPORTING (Skill #2)



From Listening to Supporting



The Second Core Coaching Skill is that of Supporting the Client.

In essence, supporting is to facilitate a sense of safety so another human being feels supported in opening up, disclosing, and experiencing his or her own authentic experience.

Supporting also means relating in such a way that we create a relational and physical context for communicating and dialoguing that provides a sense of safety, validity, care, and respect.

How do we create a space and a feel of safety for a client, a sense that we are there in a supportive role? There are numerous things we can do.

1. We can begin by paying lots of attention and actively listening (skill #1 listening)

We can reflect that we have listened by reflecting back precisely what we have heard using the person's own words, metaphors, even tone and gestures.

2. We can match what and how the person has communicated to us.

We call this "pacing." It is the key skill for getting "initial rapport" with a person.

3. We can access a state of empathy, concern, and care for the person (skill #3, state induction).

This allows us to be a real person in relationship to another real person. Apparently, the danger and temptation of NLP around the world has been that people become so enamoured with the "techniques" and "technology" that they forget the person. This has had the effect of de-personalising and de-humanising the experience.

4. We can focus on fully entering the client's world and space for the purpose of understanding.

"Seek first to understand" was one of the seven habits of highly effective people that Stephen Covey identified. This speaks of an attitude much more than a technique.



Pacing

To create this kind and quality of support, the skill of pacing offers us a truly magical way to enter into another's world with support. Pacing is all about matching the client by entering into the person's world to be there with him or her. In this we can pace many things and at many different levels.

1. Physiological pacing:

Matching the physiological outputs of the client so the person feels that we are together, like each other, and dancing in harmony in energy levels, movements, and voice qualities.

2. Verbal pacing:

Saying words that fit and match the person's internal world.

3. Meta or conceptual pacing:

Identifying and mirroring back to the person concepts, ideas, beliefs, values, Meta-Programs, Meta-states, etc. that reflect his or her internal world. Meta-level pacing is a higher level of pacing. Such rapport leads to a person feeling understood.

As we become more professional in our listening, communicating and supporting, we discover more about how to come into sensory awareness, notice what's going on, and then mirror back the speaker's the verbal and non-verbal responses. This reflection acknowledges the speaker's world as it reflects it back. The result is that it stimulates a feeling of similarity, familiarity, and commonality.



Benchmarks for Supporting



Providing a sense of safety to your client through; questioning, listening and celebrating, expression affirmations of belief and trust in the client. This is done through managing the environment, and the conversation.

Level 3.75 – At level of “person”

Stating one’s own concerns and emotions of support with a client, expressing a willingness to invest in the other’s well-being and resourcefulness in support of the client’s outcomes and agendas, “I’m here for you,” “Use the coaching call between sessions when you need to”.

Level 3.5 – Invite client to apply own resources

Responding to the client’s emotion, respectfully exploring, inviting the client to access and apply own resources to situation, offering statements of affirmation that conveys belief in the person’s potentials, celebrating and cheer-leading client’s successes, pacing Meta-Programs, Meta-states, concepts, and values. Gentle confrontation where appropriate.

Level 3 – Actively Present, asking about emotions

Actively and intently listening, asking about emotions, investing energy into conversation and managing the environment so that it enables the client to stay focused. Use of acknowledgements such as, “that must have been challenging for you.” Matching & mirroring; pacing posture, breath, gesture, etc. Uses and confirms; words, sounds that encourage client to continue: “Ok, yes, and then?” “Hmmm,” “ahhhh!”. Sets frames.

Level 2 – Only partial match and mirroring

Matching client’s words, posture, breathing, etc., listening for facts, details, ideas, failure to fully match output of other’s gestures and non-verbal expressions.

Level 1 – Fiddling

Listening with no or little eye contact, fiddling with other things, failing to follow up statements expressing emotion, seemingly preoccupied with other things. Little or no attention to context and atmosphere to deal with noises, distractions, etc.

Level 0 – Impatience

Indicates of little interest: failing to track the content, repeatedly asking “What did you just say?”, firing off questions without time to respond. Interrupting, making statements of judgment, evaluation, blame and interpretations.



Supporting through pacing

We listen for all of the expressions of the speaker in order to use them as we match them and so enter his or her world.

What is physiological pacing?

Pacing is matching our behaviours and voice to the responses of our client. In the on- going process of matching or pacing, we literally take on the movements, neurology, words, understandings, etc. of the other person (their behavioural outputs) and match them with our own. Because we are typically not aware of these facets of our ongoing experience, they tend to lie outside conscious awareness, therefore pacing communicates unconsciously. It says, "I know your world, I can sense and feel and think in terms of your world of experience."

Matching is the process of adjusting aspects of our external behaviour to approximate those in the other person's behaviour. For example, when a person tilts his or her head to the left, we do the same to match that movement.

How does physiological pacing create rapport?

By pacing or matching another's words and non-verbal expressions (i.e. breathing, standing, gestures, etc.) we create the magic of rapport. That's primary level pacing. We build rapport then by matching aspects of another's experiences.

What behavioural outputs can we match?

The following are the key variables in behaviour to pace. Mastering this art of pacing will develop our ability to establish rapport with people quickly and proficiently.

- Matching heads and shoulder angle; matching the characteristic poses that another offers with his or her head.
- Matching facial expressions; seeing the ways that another uses their face (wrinkles nose, puckers lips, raises eyebrows) and match it without mimicking.
- Matching gestures; moving in a way that takes on the hand and body gestures of another and to do so gracefully and respectfully. This is not mimicking.
- Matching breathing; adjusting your breathing patterns to match the others.
- Matching vocal or qualities of speech; matching another's shifts in tonality, tempo, volume, timbre, intonation patterns, etc.

What degree of physiological matching can we do?

- Whole body matching; adjusting our body to appropriate the other person's posture shifts.
- Part body matching; pacing any consistent or stylistic use of body movements, e.g. eye blinks.
- Half body matching; matching the upper or lower portion of the other person's body.
- Crossover mirroring; using one aspect of your behaviour to match a different aspect in the other person's behaviour. If you adjust the tempo of your voice to match the other person's rate of breathing or pace the other's eye blinks with your finger or head nods.





What does it take to pace?

It takes lots of sensory awareness, flexibility in our own responses, and respect for the person. This explains why active listening and sensory acuity is so critical. Pacing is only difficult to the extent that it necessitates lots of uptime experience as we engage another person. It's difficult to the extent that we are not skilled in listening with a third ear to another's depths and entering into his or her world. It's difficult if we do not understand its value or do not care about the person. It's also difficult to the extent that our ego is in the way. Otherwise, it is easy, fun, and profoundly transformative.

Indicators of rapport:	Voice qualities to pace:	
Colour change in face	Tone	Rhythm
Following you	Volume	Emphasis
Language like: "That's a really good question"	Speed	
Kinaesthetic mirroring	Timbre (quality of voice)	

What is verbal pacing?

We verbally pace by making descriptions that accord with that person's world to convey a sense of having heard the other. This "empathy" means we are putting ourselves into the other's position to see and feel the world as he or she does. We can't do this directly, so we have to do it indirectly which takes attending and listening.

Effective communicators develop this ability of entering into another's reality. This makes for true understanding because it takes the other at their word and tries to imagine how their words reflect a perception or map of the world. Entering his or her reality doesn't mean we have to make it ours or even agree with it. We can maintain our own reality while flexibly imagining and appreciating the other's world as a map.

In verbally pacing someone we momentarily join the other's concept of reality. By going to her model of the world, we can then find bridges to cross over and connect with her. To adopt this strategy, first, recognise the person's reality model.

- What does this word, phrase, metaphor, style of expression imply about this person's model?
- What is this person's orientation to reality?
- What must it be like on this person's inside?
- What could be the source of this understanding or emotion?
- What meanings are at work within this person?
- What must be true for what this person says to make sense to me?

All of these questions invite us to take the other's perceptual position ("second position"). As map listening, pacing enables us to get to the other person's reality language so that we can more effectively communicate with each other. Matching our words to the other's internal state and making statements that are in agreement with, and congruent with, the person's internal, ongoing experience so that the other person begins to feel deeply heard.





We can even purposefully break pace in order to engage the other person. We do this by over-stating or over-guessing about the other's reality and then ask for feedback and correction. Because we all want to be understood, this will evoke us to help the other person to understand us. By over-stating or under-stating our guesses, we create an opportunity to receive more information and to listen more attentively.

When we verbally pace, our words and non-verbals serve as a feedback mechanism to the other person. This skill is so powerful that when done with appreciation and respect will amplify his or her experience, engage it, and elicit it even more. All of this describes a hypnotic process.

While pacing is simple to understand, at times it can be very difficult to achieve. It demands that we get out of ourselves and enter the other's world (second positioning). It necessitates running our own brain, so we don't rush into problem solving, advice-giving and judgments.

Matching verbal predicates; hearing the sensory system predicates that predominate in a person's unconscious processing of information and utilising it as you match it in your verbal responses.

- Matching repetitive phrases; utilising the person's characteristic phrases and metaphors.
- Matching the exact words metaphors, vocabulary, and thought patterns.

What is the difference between matching and mirroring?

To build rapport, we match and mirror physiology, and tonality. What differs then between matching and mirroring?

In mirroring, we take on the person's mirror image. If they have crossed their right leg over their left leg, we cross our left leg over our right leg. Since we stand opposite them (as we face the person), we mirror them by crossing opposite legs.

In matching physiology with someone who has crossed right leg over left leg, you would match him or her if you crossed your right leg over your left leg. This works similar to crossover mirroring.

What is meta or conceptual pacing?

At this level we are pacing a person's beliefs, values, meanings, ideas, concepts, etc. This enables us to gain rapport and enlist support as a basis for communicating. Conceptually pace by temporarily assuming his or her words are correct, and then imagine how they can be correct.

Pacing reduces repetition in conversation. When we feel heard we don't have to keep repeating ourselves. Pacing can sometimes take some time. After all, it is connecting with the other person and so make call up us to exercise patience, calmness, and respect to make contact with the other's reality.





Body moulding as a mirroring activity

Form into groups of three.

1. Person 1 will face opposite person 2, and a 3rd person is sitting (or standing) behind the 2nd person's line of peripheral vision so that only the 1st person can see them
2. Person 3 will create an expression

The third person should place him/herself in an unusual posture with unusual facial expressions. Don't overdo it; you will need to hold this position for a few minutes.

3. 1st person to replicate that expression while in general conversation with the 2nd person

The first person's job is to direct the second person to take on the same posture and facial expressions as the third person. This will force you to come into sensory awareness and to give good sensory directions.



Action steps for learning and practicing the art of pacing:

Make a decision to actualise your rapport mirroring skills into your life! Establish rapport consciously with as many people as you can this coming week. Practice, practice, practice.

1. When eating out

Match and mirror someone near you in a restaurant. Notice the skills that establish rapport.

2. When shopping

When you go up to a counter to purchase something, practice establishing instant rapport with the person at the counter.

3. Set up a focused practice schedule

Train yourself to closely observe different facets of non-verbal communication. On Monday watch for colour changes in faces. Tuesday watch for pupil dilation. Wednesday observe people's breathing patterns. Thursday notice the variety of body builds and their relationship to the representational systems. Friday listen for voice tonality and quality. Saturday and Sunday, look for eye accessing patterns.

4. When watching TV

Use your television time to develop your sensory acuity.
Tune into a talk show with your eye-accessing chart before you.





Supporting via perceptual flexibility

There are multiple positions in perceiving things. We numerate the them- first, second, third, and fourth.

1st Position – Self (I)

The position of seeing, hearing, and feeling from out of oneself. We take this position to speak authentically, to present ourselves, our thoughts, feelings, and responses congruently, to disclose, listen, inquire, and be present with another. When we become stuck in this position, we take on the meta-program of self-referent.

- *Language cues: I, me, my, I'm, this is that, mine, etc.*
-

2nd Position – Other (we)

The empathy position of understanding, feeling with, and seeing things from another's point of view. Here we feel in accord with the other and develop a strong sense of his or her perceptive. When we are stuck here, we can lose our sense of self and become co- dependent to the person. Doing this means that we take on the Meta-program of other-referent.

- *Language cues: We, us, our, ours, them, etc.*
-

3rd Position Meta (it)

The position of stepping back to gain a sense of distance, observe, witness, feel neutral, and appreciate other positions. When we are stuck here, we can come across as uninvolved, over-rational, and in analytical mode.

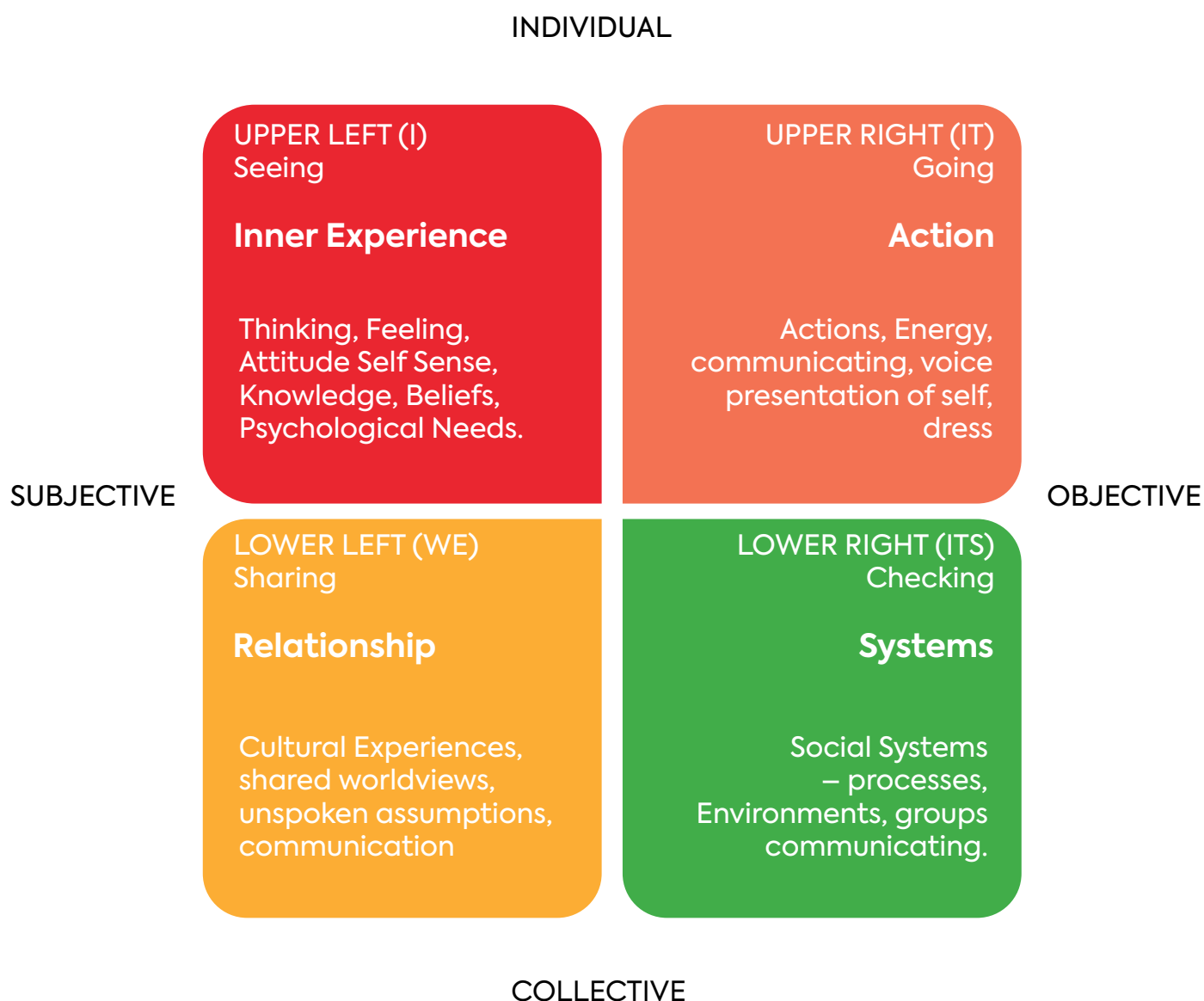
- *Language cues: It, that, there, then, they, etc.*
-

4th Position Meta Systems (its)

The position for understanding the contexts (social, linguistic, business, family organisational, etc.) that influence all of the larger systems and contexts of our world. When we are stuck here, we can become "the Company man."

- *Language cues: Its, causes, structure, all, everyone etc.*
-

The Quadrants



Native Perspective Test



Exercise – Activity

Click [HERE](#) for an online automated version of the test.

Of these 8 Scenarios – pick the response that fits the closest to your FIRST response (based on past or present)

NOTE: These scenarios and sample responses have been tested and iterated multiple times. They are intentionally not leadership-specific, as we suspect that a person's "real" native perspective might not be reliably expressed (and therefore harder to self-assess) in a particular role.

Scenario 1:	I am experiencing challenging financial times and want to make more money.
Response A	I'd talk to successful friends and colleagues about it and get advice from them.
Response B	I would determine how much money I need to make, consider my work experience, explore market opportunities, and come up with a plan
Response C	I would write down a list of things that I could possibly do to make money.
Response D	I would consider the types of things that I'm passionate about and think about how I could make money doing them.
Answer: (A, B, C or D)	
Scenario 2:	I wake up on a Sunday, with no plans, and consider how to spend my day.
Response A	I'd start to envision what my ideal day would look like that day: playful, lazy, active, being outdoors, with family and friends, etc
Response B	I would consider different things that I could do and pick something that is appropriate to the energy level that I feel or want to feel.
Response C	I would think about what other things I needed to get done that week (emails, work, errands, etc.) and figure out a workable balance of what to do that day.
Response D	I would check with my family and friends to see if we could find something to do together.
Answer: (A, B, C or D)	
Scenario 3:	I decide to go out to dinner with a friend and he/she asks where I'd like to go.
Response A	I'd make a suggestion based on the type of food that I was craving at the time.
Response B	I'd say, "I pretty flexible, where would you like to go?"
Response C	I would imagine the type of food and atmosphere that would feel best to me, based on the mood I was in.
Response D	I would consider a lot of variables, like what kind of food we both like, how much money we'd want to spend, the atmosphere that would best suit the occasion, and location of the restaurant relative to where we were
Answer: (A, B, C or D)	



Scenario 4:	I want to connect more with what my purpose or unique contribution to the world is.
-------------	---

- | | |
|------------|---|
| Response A | I would consider my current sense of it and work to refine it by going to a workshop, working with a coach, or reading a book in hopes of discovering how me and my purpose fit in the world. |
| Response B | I would keep this intention in mind and pay attention to moments in my life when I feel a sense of clarity, passion and purpose. |
| Response C | I would share what I think my purpose is with people close to me and get their perspective on it. |
| Response D | I would do something that gets me open & inspired (like being in nature, meditate, practicing yoga or other types of exercise) and notice what comes up. |

Answer: (A, B, C or D)

Scenario 5:	I want to lose 3 kgs over the next 3 months.
-------------	--

- | | |
|------------|--|
| Response A | I would explore my motivation for doing this, and only set the goal if it felt meaningful enough for me. |
| Response B | I'd try to get one of my friends to do it with me, so we could support each other to reach our goals. |
| Response C | I would exercise more and eat less. |
| Response D | I would create a plan of how to achieve this goal - including my exercise schedule, what my diet would be and some milestones along the way. |

Answer: (A, B, C or D)

Scenario 6:	I would like my partner and I to improve our communication skills.
-------------	--

- | | |
|------------|---|
| Response A | I would practice active listening, making eye contact and being present (or some other practices) when communicating with my partner. |
| Response B | I would suggest that we create consistent regular time together to work on this and also do something to gain more knowledge on the topic, like reading a book or going to a workshop together. |
| Response C | I would reflect upon my current experience of how we communicate and think about the areas I feel good about and where I think we could improve. |
| Response D | I would talk to my partner about some ideas about how to do this, and hope that we could agree on something that felt right for both of us |

Answer: (A, B, C or D)

Scenario 7:	I discover that I have a serious health condition that needs to be attended to.
-------------	---

- | | |
|------------|--|
| Response A | I speak to some friends and family that I trust, to share what's going on with me and get their support. |
| Response B | I consider the types of things that I can do to heal myself – from changing my behaviors, to seeing a health care professional, to taking some herbs or supplements. |
| Response C | I'd first research the symptoms that I have to see what the possible conditions might be and what the possible range of treatments are. |
| Response D | I consider how this health condition impacts my view of myself and my life and decide whether it is an opportunity for greater self-growth and awareness |

Answer: (A, B, C or D)



Scenario 8: I finish an important project meeting at work and feel that it was a good meeting if:

Response A	We decided upon a comprehensive plan of action for the project (who does what by when) and it was clear how this particular project fits with the other initiatives in the company.
Response B	The most important issues, as I saw them, were discussed and resolved in a way that felt right to me.
Response C	We all got to share how we were feeling about the project so far and came to a mutual understanding of what's important to focus on going forward.
Response D	I know exactly what I need to do for my part of the project and how to get it done.

Answer: (A, B, C or D)

Scoring Chart

For each scenario, highlight the letter that you selected as the most similar to your response. Then enter the total count of letters you highlighted in each column

	Your Answers	UL	UR	LL	LR
Scenario 1		D	C	A	B
Scenario 2		A	B	D	C
Scenario 3		C	A	B	D
Scenario 4		B	D	C	A
Scenario 5		A	C	B	D
Scenario 6		C	A	D	B
Scenario 7		D	B	A	C
Scenario 8		B	D	C	A
TOTALS					

If you scored three or more in any one column that is likely your native perspective. If two columns tied, select the native perspective that fits best.

notes:

Perceptual Flexibility



Exercise – Activity

(Map the quadrants out on the floor)

In pairs, discuss a time/event when you were not very resourceful in responding to a criticism or challenge from another person.

1. Recall the time when you were most un-resourceful in handling a challenge with another (upper left)

Step back into that memory so that you recall it as if inside it again, seeing, hearing and feeling what you saw, heard and felt then. Answer the following questions from first position; use "I" statements.

- "What did you experience that was un-resourceful to you?"

2. Step out of that memory and into the position of the person you were interacting with at the time (lower left)

From the other person's point of view, look back at yourself in that memory and look as the other. From this expanded perspective, express what you see, hear and feel as the other person. Speak as them (as you imagine they would) and use your own name as you do (as they would). Describe the situation from their perspective as it unfolded. What do you (as them) see, hear, feel etc.?

3. Step aside from this memory and the first two positions to an "invisible observer" to the whole experience (upper right)

From the position of an uninvolved witness, what do you see, hear, or feel about that interaction? Ask:

- "What do you think about that unresourceful interaction from this position?"
- What advice would you give yourself as a neutral observer?

4. Step out yet another time to a position out beyond the whole system of interactions (lower right)

What additional awareness do you have, understand, feel, etc. as you look at all of that from a larger system (environment, others present, context, weather, time, day, etc.) point of view?"

5. Step back into position 1 (UL), what are you now more aware of?

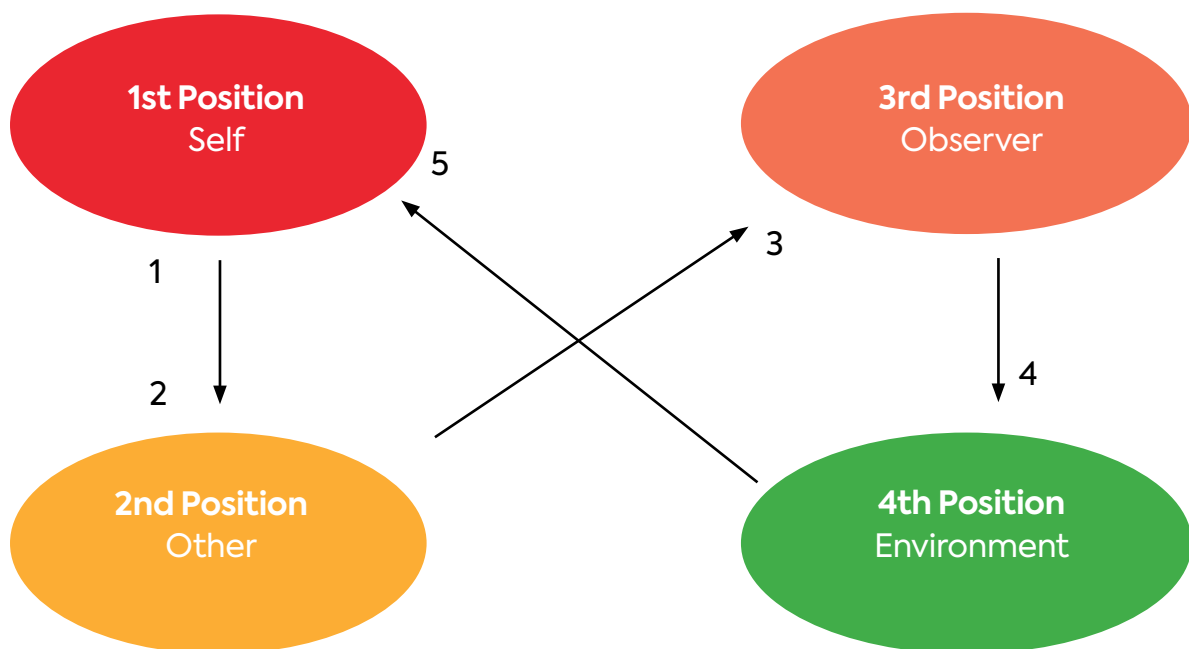
What might you have originally missed? What's changed, now that you can see the situation, person or event from multiple perspectives?



6. Write down at least one new realisation or awareness:

• *Note: Within the 4 quadrants, people generally have the following;*

1. Primary preference
2. Secondary preference
3. Longing quadrant
4. Missing quadrant



STATES

(Skill #3)



Inducing States

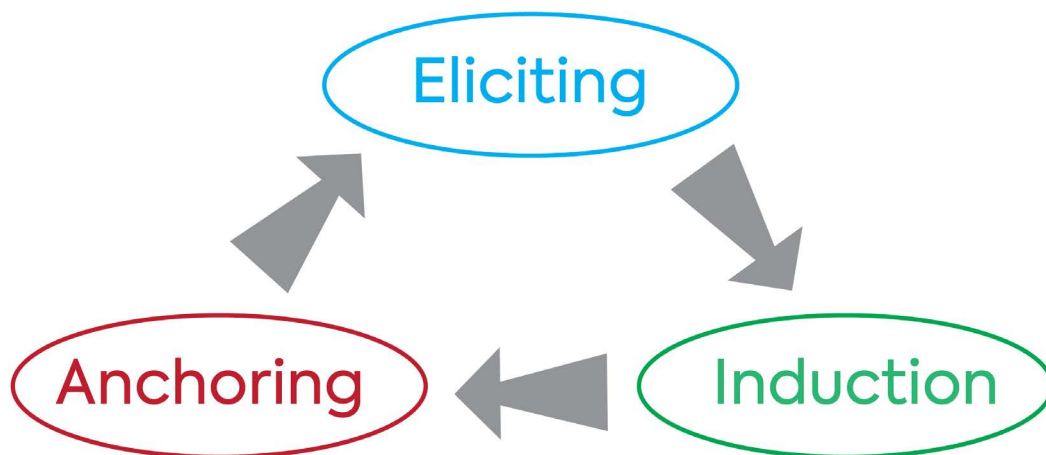


In communication, we communicate from one state to another state. This makes states critical in communication. Our ability to recognise and manage our states is essential. Also, every communication is filtered and contaminated by our states.

Earlier, we worked with two primary states, which we will revisit today by accessing, amplifying, and anchoring them so that we have full access to them as professional communicators. These were:

1. The listening or sensory aware state
2. The supporting or rapport state

There are three core skills in communication competence of inducing mind-body states.





What is a “State”?

A state is a mind-body-emotional energy field; a dynamic mind-body state of experience or being that operates as an experiential field of energy experienced mentally, emotionally and physically. We experience reality through these mental, emotional and physical states.

Our state of mind, state of body and state of emotion are all so inter-related that we cannot separate them. When we do, we only do so linguistically, so we can communicate about them more effectively. As we think, so we feel in our body and move and act and this entire configuration (or gestalt) is what we mean by the word “experience”.

As we map things, so we become. It begins with our neurology, how we use our nervous system and sense receptors. It also involves our linguistics, how we use symbols, words, metaphors, and classifications to create mental and emotional programs.

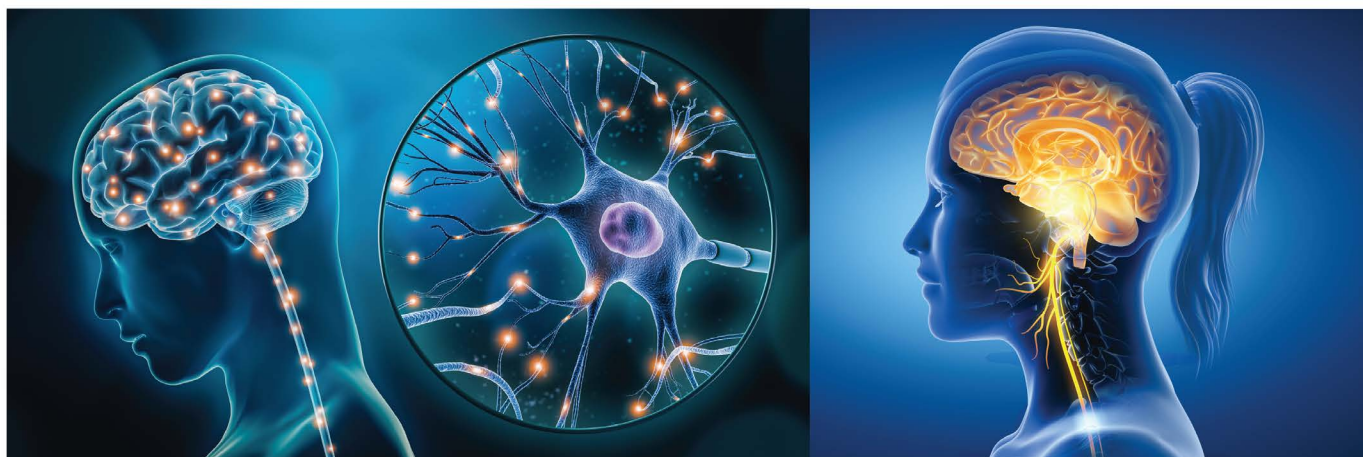
In this way, we discover how to take charge of these processes and run our own brains.

NLP provides the models and technology for doing this in a precise way.

Taking charge of our “reality constructions” empowers us in managing our neurology, building ever more accurate and enhancing models of the world, increasing our resourcefulness. This is the foundation for effective communication - excellent state management.

State Components

If we create our states from our mental-emotional-somatic mapping, this gives us two royal roads to state creation, two avenues that we can use to evoke or induce a state.





1. Mind and linguistics (language) enables us to think our way into state of mind and these internal representations specify our state of "mind". "These are the things that we internally map out; Visually, Auditorily, Kinaesthetically and self-talk (Auditory digital) (VAK-Ad), as well as the things that we say to ourselves (language), our "understandings, learnings, beliefs, values," etc. that make up the representations in "the theatre of the mind."

Because we always have a choice about what to represent and how to code that representation, we humans have real 'representational power'.

The languages of the mind enable this; how the mind "thinks" and encodes information. In Neuro Semantics we call the result; the representational screen or internal cinema or movie of the mind.

The sensory representation systems

Visual: Pictures, scenes, images

Auditory: Sounds, noises, music

Kinaesthetic: Sensations, touches, tactile, proprioceptive, motor movements
Auditory Digital: the language representation system includes words, sentences and linguistic structures. These include: Mathematics, music symbols, metaphors, stories, symbols etc.

Olfactory (smell), **Gustatory** (taste), & **Vestibular** (balance)

2. Body and neurology which enables us to act our way into a state.

Physiology and/or neurology describe the physical state or state of "body". That is, the things that we experience in our body involving health, posture, breathing, biochemistry, etc. The functioning of our nervous system as it interacts within our body and physiology of our central, peripheral, and autonomic nervous systems.

State eliciting / induction

This refers to the art of identifying, detecting, and providing the required stimulus, so that another person elicits a state of mind-and-emotion.

Obviously, to be able to do that effectively, we need to become comfortable with our emotions and those of another. We have to be aware of emotional states and alert to them, that is, we need to be able to calibrate. That means we have to have the flexibility in offering a wide range of triggers to call forth appropriate states that match the contexts we are facing. State induction refers to the systematic ability to provide an "induction" by means of a story, an anchor, a menu list, and a wide range of options so that we can invite others into more resourceful states.





Benchmarks for inducing states

To say words, ask questions, use metaphors, tell stories etc. in such a way that invites another to recall or imagine a mind-body-emotional experience. To use voice and gestures in such a way that a client begins to think-and-feel as if in that way of thinking and feeling.

Level 3.75 – Amplification

Asking the client questions to enable the amplification of a resourceful state. Inviting the client to fully experience that state in; breathing, walking, moving, gesturing, speaking, etc. Teasing and testing to see how much of the state the client is experiencing "how do you know to call this state X?". Amplifying it and anchoring the state for further use.

Level 3.5 – Leading

Speaking in; metaphors or stories. Using indirect methods to induce the state to layer multiple suggestions for the state. Use of menu list. Asking client to be with the emotions of the state and to manifest them more fully in the body (coach the body). Using a menu list of suggestive experiences that are likely to elicit the state.

Level 3 – Going first and pacing

Speaking with a voice and using words that suggest and invite the desired state. Going into (leading) the state first and using it to invite the client into it, expressing it in one's voice, gesture, face, breathing, etc. Use of client's voice, (tonality etc.) and gestures.

Level 2 – Some matching and mirroring

Asking about the state, suggesting it. Some matching and mirroring to pace the person's current state and then mentioning the desired state. Incongruence.

Level 1 – Facts without pacing, different state to client

Mentioning state with a monotone, or with a tone of voice that does not correspond to desired state. The coach is not in the state, or in a different state (i.e. Impatient when wanting to evoke patience, tired and fatigued when evoking motivation). Perhaps mentioning the state and demanding the client experience it. "Don't feel afraid, feel courage."

Level 0 – Ignoring state, incongruence

No mention of one's state, let alone of the desired state, monotone use of voice, no use of tone, tempo, or story that corresponds to the state or outcome of the client.



State Management #101



State object

With primary states, the state-object refers to something outside you and "beyond" your nervous system... What do your thoughts-and-feelings refer to?

- J - Joy
- A - Anger
- R - Relaxation
- F - Fear
- L - Love

With meta-states, the object of our state is another (previous) state, so that we are now in reference to our previous thoughts, feeling or physiological experience; "I feel joy about what I'm learning about."

State assessing/inducing

1. Memory: Remembering a state. "Recall a time when..."
2. Imagination: Creating a state. "What would it look, sound, and feel like if..."
3. Modelling: Observing a state. "Do you know anyone who..."

State intensity and amplification

Gauge each state in terms of intensity. How much do you experience the state? What level of strength or weakness does the state convey? How do you know to call this feeling X? How much does it dominate your consciousness? Would you like to feel it more fully? Crank it up by increasing or intensifying the inner movie and you will experience more of the state.

All states do not have the same level of intensity, so gauge for intensity level. Do you need more "juice?" What processes do you rely on for amplifying your states? How can you crank them up?

State interrupts

Stop any and every mind-body-emotion state by jarring, interfering, sabotaging (positively), or preventing, etc. State interrupts refer to ways for stopping or preventing a state from functioning to toward un-resourcefulness, despite the positive intention running.



State dependency

States govern our learning, memory, perception, behaviour, communication, etc. This is what we call state-dependency. In psychology, state dependency is also called "emotional expectation sets" or "conceptual expectation sets" determining what we see and hear.

State contrasts

Comparing one state with another in order to gain insightful understanding about "the difference that makes a difference" (Gregory Bateson). So, what explains the difference? Does it occur at a primary or meta-level? It depends... All states are not the same. State configurations come in all sizes and shapes. Just because you have accessed a state of thoughts-and-emotions and physiology, you may not be necessarily accessing a similar state to someone else doing the same.

State anchoring

Anchoring refers to being able to establish a trigger or link to a state, and to do so consciously and to be able to replicate it at will. Once we can do that, then we can develop the skill of calling forth the state that we anchored, "firing it off" by replicating the linkage.

We set up a trigger (sight, sound, sensation, movement, gesture, word, etc.) and link it to the state.

"Anchors" operate as "Pavlovian conditioning tools" for state management and depend on uniqueness, intensity, timing, and purity. You wait until you or another person has reached the peak of an experience (state), and then link some unique trigger to it. We then test to see if the trigger then "fires off" the state. If so, you have an "anchor." Examples include smells, tastes, sounds and physical experiences that take us back in time and elicit a specific memory and therefore state experience. That's why thinking about a sad memory makes us sad...

State utilisation

Detecting opportunities to utilise resourceful ways of thinking-feeling, perceiving, communicating, etc. to our personal developmental gain. We ask ourselves, "Where would I like to use this state?" "What would it look, sound, feel like to have this state in this or that situation?"

State strategy

The pieces of information (VAK), neurology, responses, etc. that comprise the sequential composition of a state. We can track this sequence and model the pieces of the strategy that creates the state.

State as "emotion" (k-meta)

An emotion is a combination of sensations and evaluations (in the form of language) about the Kinaesthetics; a meta-level phenomenon, "emotions" consisting of evaluative judgments, beliefs, meanings and values. As "states" (neuro-linguistic states) emotions register our body's (or soma) sense of the meaning or evaluation to help us feel the energy of the meaning.

An emotion is the difference between our model of the world (which includes all of our mappings about expectations, beliefs, values, identity, memory, understandings, evaluations etc.) - and our experience of the world (what actually happens at the contact point of our skills and actions). The difference between the two is our e-motion. That is our energy-in-motion.





State extending/state containment

We can both extend and contain states. These properties of neuro-linguistic states enable us to take the thoughts/feelings and all of the mind-body correlations and then contaminate other experiences with this state.

We can also build boundaries and barriers around a state so as to disconnect from other things. In various contexts, both phenomena provide new empowering resources, if used appropriately.

State expressions versus state frames

We have 4 central expressions of state: Thinking, Feeling, Speaking and Behaving.

- T - What you think? Your movie making and self-talk.
- F - What you feel? Your emotional experience.
- S - What you say? Your verbal and non-verbal communicating.
- B - What do you do? Your actions and behaviours.

Checklist for state elicitation

- Get rapport (match and mirror, pace and lead)
- Use memory (remembering in 1st person)
- Use your imagination (construction)
- Use your voice: verbal expressions
- Offer a menu list
- Go first (lead)

State elicitation skills – state induction explained

To be able to effectively elicit responses, states, and experiences it is crucial to be a professional communicator and/or coach. The skill of elicitation enables us to discover the structure of subjective experience; whether in ourselves or in others. The skill of eliciting enables us to learn how to effectively transform experiences. It's crucial for effective communicating, influencing, motivating and coaching.

Eliciting resourceful states, helps the person you're working or talking with, to become conscious of factors that are normally outside of their conscious awareness. This means that your own patience, positive influence, and acceptance will make it easier (and safer) for the other person to access resources.



The Process of Inducing States



Exercise – Activity

1. First, move to an uptime state. (VAK External)

Get yourself in the right state of being present to the person.

Open all of your sense receptors to input sights, sounds, sensations, so that you are operating from a place of uptime (lose your mind and come to your senses).

2. Invite a past memory, or imagine a time when, or model (person you know) the state

Make it real in the body. Elicit clean information about a person's experience; you need to get the person into the desired state. If you don't get the person in state, you will only be talking about the experience.

Ask - Think about a time when you were thinking or feeling X ... What would it be like if you were fully experiencing this right now...?

3. Aim for referents that are small, pure and simple

The aim is to elicit as pure and discreet a state as possible. So, ask the person to think about a referent event or experience that is clear, small, and simple: "Remember a single, one- time event when you experienced X...".

4. Speak and act congruently

In eliciting a state, remember that the tools of your trade are what you say and how you say it (your tones, tempo and gestures). So be evocative. You will need to look and sound like what you are trying to elicit in the other. Make your expressions look and sound congruent to what you are eliciting (go first).

5. Take your time to allow people sufficient time to process things

We all do not process information or emotions at the same rate. When a person "goes inside", grant them the space and room to do that by being quiet. Allow them to process.

6. Begin with unspecified terms and then shift to more predicate specific terms

Begin with unspecific words that allow the person to search for the experience in his or her own way, then shift to VAK-Ad specific language to align with your client's processing preferences.

As you notice your client accessing certain representational systems, (eye chatter, predicates, and physiology) help the person by using sensory-specific (matching) words. If you hear a visual term then say, "Notice how you see that...?" Good trance-style questions will assist the person in locating and identifying (recall) their experience. To do that, you will need just enough content by asking high quality questions. In fact, that's the primary value of knowing content.

7. Focus on the form and structure of your elicitation

Throughout the person's accessing and experiencing, focus on the form and structure of the experience, by paying attention to the modalities and the cinematic features of those modes.



State Anchoring

(guidelines explained)

In communicating, we are working with mind-body-emotional states. Once a state has been accessed and amplified, you can anchor it, so that you can utilise these empowering states to more effectively deal with difficult or challenging situations.

In the process of anchoring, we help ourselves or another person to recall a discreet experience by asking for specifics of it. In doing this, we are invited to choose a resourceful experience and ground it in specifics.

Anchoring in coaching:

1. Gauge and induce intensity

- *How intense is the state?*
- *As you gauge it from 0 to 10, where are you on that scale? What increases the intensity of your state?*
- *How quickly can you change states? Calibrate to the speed of someone going into state. Capture the state at the peak of its intensity and anchor it when the person goes into the desired state. If you are touching, increase the firmness of your touch as their state increases and then release just after the peak of the experience.*

2. Check purity

- *How pure and discreet is the state? How mixed? How focused is the person's attention?*
- *Is he or she thinking about one referent or a group of them?*

3. Facilitate uniqueness

- *How unique is the new stimulus of the anchor?*
- *When kinaesthetically anchoring, where will you touch? How much pressure, for what length of time?*
- *Do you have a location you can easily return to?*

Avoid setting a touch anchor in an area that's regularly accessed. Touch a precise place on the skin, not the clothing, as that will shift.

4. Get the timing right

In replicating an anchor, you "fire it off" by returning to the precise location with the same stimulus and apply the same pressure for the same amount of time. Apply a firm steady pressure, but never in a painful way, or too faintly. Then hold it. Gradually increase the pressure as the person goes more fully into the experience. It takes time for people to completely re-experience a state. When learning to anchor, have the person signal you when they're in the desired state; it'll help you calibrate.

5. Anchor across all representational systems

Access all representational systems (VAK-Ad), by using voice modulation, pace, volume, pitch etc. Invite the client to create visual representations and feedback self-talk as you hear it and anchor to. Touch or invite a kinaesthetic self-anchor.



State Accessing and Anchoring Pattern



Exercise – Activity

We communicate from a state to a state. It's inevitable and inescapable. But from what state? Is it a useful, productive, and/or resourceful state? Are we communicating to a person in a state that enables him or her to communicate effectively? If not, then we need to elicit or access a more resourceful state.

As you learn these NLP patterns, we recommend that you follow these as written to enable you to embed the learning.

Steps are numbered with an explanation of a high-level outcome. Beneath each step are the phrases or questions to use.

Avoid getting into the content and stick to the context, process and structure of the pattern.

Context = Client does the work = effective results are self-determined

Content = Coach does the work = ineffective results are the result of over-responsibility

1. Identify the desired state and its mind-body components

1. What state do you want? Describe it a little bit.
2. As you're talking about that state, are you beginning to enter into that state?
3. When would you like this new empowering state (in what context(s))?

2. Evoke it fully

1. Think of a time when you fully experienced this state...
2. Think of a time when you clearly had it in a powerful way. What thoughts really evoke this state?
3. What else do you need to do?
4. How much do you now have the feeling of this state? Be with that feeling... let it grow... now let it double...
5. What would increase the experience of this state even more?
6. What would it be like if you did fully experience this state?
(Use this if you're having any difficulty eliciting the state.)
7. How do you know to call or label this state X?...

3. Anchor the state when it is highly amplified

Set a physical touch on arm, forearm, or shoulder as the person reaches the peak of their state for 1-2 seconds with equal pressure each time, in exactly the same location (only at an 8 or above on a 0 to 10 scale). Additionally, use visual anchoring through a gesture, auditory anchoring through a particular tone or intonation.



4. Practice stepping in and out. Break state and repeatedly re-access

"In just a moment I want you to step out of that powerful state, but before you do, take a snapshot of it in all sensory systems (what you see, hear, feel, etc.). Now let's practice stepping in and out of that state so that you can quickly fly into that state at any time you choose".

5. Apply the resourceful state to a time or place in everyday life.

1. Where could you really use this state in your everyday life? What was the context again?
2. Think of that context specifically, and feel this (fire the anchor) about that...
3. Suppose you had this feeling or way of thinking as your attitude, fully and completely, in just the way that you would want it... Would you like that? -> Yes
4. Would that attitude transform things as you think about that context again? -> Yes
5. How does it transform things?... just notice inside... and enjoy. -> Yes

Collapsing anchors

As we work with states, we either build up neurological energies or we disperse those energies. Building up energies is amplifying states, eliciting sub-modalities that juice them up, bringing in resources, meta-stating, etc. Dispersing energies means tearing a neuro-linguistic (mind-body) program apart, de-framing it, meta-modelling it.

1. Access a limiting state

1. What state do you want to take the emotional charge out of?
2. Ask; How much are you accessing that state right now? Are you fully there right now? How do you know?
3. Set Anchor; As I set this as an anchor for that state, nod when you re-access that state even more, how is that?
4. How much are you experiencing that limiting state? 0/10?

2. Access a contradictory state

1. What would be a powerful and resourceful state for you given that limiting state?
[Menu: relaxation for tension, playful for serious, etc.]
2. When are/ were you most fully and completely in this state? What is that like?
How much are you experiencing it now? 0/10?
3. Set anchor; now that I've set an anchor for that state, how well does it fire it off when I do this
[fire the anchor]?

3. Fire both anchors simultaneously

1. Ask; now, are you ready to collapse the limiting state?
2. Coach says; there's no need to do anything, just experience. Just let it happen. So, notice what happens when I do this [fire both anchors simultaneously and hold them]. What is that like?
3. 'Is there any confusion or disorientation as you try to process both experiences at the same time?

4. Maintain the powerful state

1. Let go of the limiting state anchor whilst holding on to the powerful state anchor.
2. How is that?
3. As you recall that limiting state, how much do you have it back?



META STATES



The Meta-States Model



You know about states, but what are meta-states?

We have studied the component structure and variables of a neuro-linguistic state, how does this differ from a meta-state?

META-NLP would not be meta if it wasn't for the meta-states model. This model was introduced to the field of NLP in 1994 by Dr Michael Hall. He discovered the model while researching resilience and while presenting it to the NLP Conference in September 1994. For meta-states, the International Association of NLP Trainers awarded their "most significant contribution to the field of NLP" in 1995 to Michael.

State as a mind-body phenomenon

As we began modelling the structure of subjective experience, we started with neurolinguistics states, that is, states of mind, body, and emotion. These mind-body or neurolinguistics states summarise what we mean by "experience."

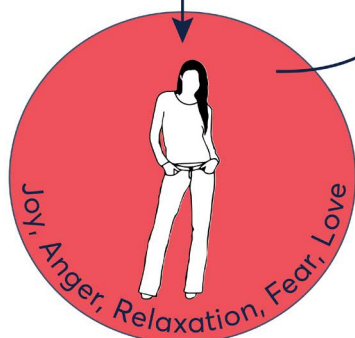
What mechanisms drive these states?

META
- Above
- Beyond
- About

Self Reflexive State

Meta Relationship to Another State

PRIMARY STATE



Our thoughts (mental representations, ideas, meanings, etc.) as processed and embodied in our nervous system, together with mind-and-physiology/neurology create our "states." When our consciousness goes out to some reference outside of us (a person, event, or thing), we experience a primary state.

Yet something new and wonderful and magical begins to happen when our thoughts-and feelings come back to reference themselves, now we have a meta-state.



What is a meta-state?

A meta-state is a model of how our awareness can and does reflect back onto itself. We also call this process self-reflexive consciousness.

Thinking-about-thinking generates thoughts-feelings at higher logical levels so that we experience states-about-states. Rather than referring to something "out there" in the world, meta-states refers to something about a previous thought, emotion, concept, understanding, etc. Alfred Korzybski (Science and Sanity; 1933) talked about meta-states as "abstractions about abstractions" or a second-order abstraction.

As a meta-class of life, we live our lives at both primary and meta levels. At meta-levels, we experience beliefs, values, domains of understandings, conceptual and semantic states, "core" or transcendental states, etc. To model human excellence, (or pathology) we have to "go meta" (Gregory Bateson) and recognise the meta-levels as they play in the systemic nature of consciousness (i.e. it operates reflexively and recursively).

By meta-stating we apply a mind-body state to another state. In this way we set a frame-of-reference that then governs all of the lower levels. It operates as an attractor in a self-organising system. Bateson noted that the higher levels organise, drive, and modulate the lower levels. In this way we create our model of the world or map which we then use as we navigate through life.

Our layered meta-states become our reference system for "making sense" of things. They frame our meanings (semantics). When we change our internal universe, we reframe our understandings, beliefs, values, and meanings. Since we give meaning according to context, our meta-states describe the structure of our mental contexts.

In our framing we make the ultimate meta-move of going above all frames to set an entirely new frame-of-reference. We can engage in meta-magic by this manoeuvre to re-set our whole reality strategy.

A primary level of experience refers to our thinking about, responding to, and giving meaning to the world outside our nervous system. A primary state describes those states that refer to the outside world. The primary emotions make up such primary states (i.e., fear/ anger, sadness/joy, relaxation/tension; aversion/attraction, etc.).

Meta-states refer to our internal states, which we experience about previous states, either the processes or the products of those experiences. We create such meta-states by reflecting back onto ourselves. This recursive, reflexive, self-referential loop back means that as we jump up a "logical level", so that the thoughts-and-feelings (state) that we experience about our thoughts-and-feelings, create a higher logical-level about a lower-level of experience.

Meta-states as beliefs

All meta-states are beliefs. As we move up from the primary level of awareness and feeling and reflexively refer back to our own thoughts, emotions, physiology, and experiences, as we set a state-about-that-state, we set a frame of meaning. This validates whatever generalisation we have made and so creates a "belief."

Every meta-state involves a belief in something. For example, "I find joy in learning" This implies that there is value and therefore belief in joyful learning.



The Basic Meta-Stating Pattern



Exercise – Activity

Meta-stating is very simple. Access a state and apply it to another state, thought, emotion, or physiology. That's the short and quick approach. The 5-A is the longer version. We have simplified and arranged these 5-As so that they are easier to remember. Colin Cox then identified two more as*: Awareness and Accelerate. This then became the 7-As of meta-stating.

* Awareness	Become aware of your state and what resource you want to apply to it
Access a resource state	What resource state do you want to bring to bear on or apply to the primary state? A "resource" can be a thought, feeling, idea, belief, value, memory, and imagination
Amplify fully and Anchor	Juice up the resource state and establish an anchor for it by touch, sight, sound, word, etc.
Apply to the primary state	Bring the resource to bear on the primary state (this creates meta-level anchoring) or embed the primary state inside a resource state.
Analyse the quality, health, balance (ecology) of the system	Imagine having this layered consciousness in your mind as your frame as you move out into your future
Appropriate to your life by putting into your future (future pacing)	Would it enhance your life to set this resource as your frame-of-reference for the primary state experience? Would every facet of your mind- and-body align with this?
* Accelerate	Put it into action and accelerate your resourceful empowerment in real life

Dance of the 7 A's



1



Awareness

Become aware of your state and what resource you want to apply to it.

Access a resource state.

What resource state do you want to bring to bear on or apply to the primary state? A "resource" can be a thought, feeling, idea, belief, value, memory, imagination.

3



Amplify fully and Anchor.

Juice up the resource state and establish an anchor for it by touch, sight, sound, word, etc.

Apply to the primary state.

Bring the resource to bear on the primary state (this creates self-reflexive-level anchoring) or embed the primary state inside a resource state.

5



Appropriate to your life by putting into your future

Also known as Future Pacing. Imagine having this layered consciousness in your mind as your frame as you move out into your future.

Analyse the quality, health, balance (ecology) of the system.

Would it enhance your life to set this resource as your frame-of-reference for the primary state experience?

Would every facet of your mind-and-body align with this?

7



Accelerate

Put it into action and accelerate your resourceful empowerment in real life!



2



4



6



Meta-states as sub-modalities

When we begin to be aware of our representations, this meta-state (awareness of representation) expands our perceptions. When we step back (a meta-stating process) and notice the qualities and features of our sensory representations, we begin to learn how to edit and re-edit our mental movies. Doing this puts us at a meta-state level and is itself a meta-state. In other words what classic NLP calls "sub-modalities" are not sub at all, but indeed meta.

This gives us meta-NLP. NLP enriched by meta-states re-models some of the mistakes of traditional NLP. This is especially true of the false-to-fact metaphor of the cinematic features of our movies being "sub" or lower than the representations themselves. 5

Richard Bandler introduced the term "sub-modalities" to refer to the sensory representation distinctions. Prior to that Todd Epstein called them pragma-graphics. Originally, they viewed these qualities, features, and distinctions of the modalities as existing as a lower logical level and that's why they added the prefix "sub."

So, what? The so-called "sub-modality" model mis-directed our attention from the higher levels of the frameworks that actually govern subjective experience and created a lot of patterns that are very ineffective, such as the traditional belief-change pattern, the understanding pattern, etc.

This calls into question the old sub-modality belief change pattern. Try it for yourself.

Think about something that you do not believe. Can you represent what you do not believe? Can you even turn up all of the sub-modality properties of the representation making it closer, brighter, more life-like, etc? When you do, do you suddenly "believe" it? I don't. For example, get an image that represents the awfulness of Adolf Hitler. Note the sub-modalities.

Now get an image that represents a great person like Mother Theresa. Note the sub-modalities that you use to edit your representations of Mother Theresa. Now put the sub-modalities of the image of Adolf Hitler into the sub-modalities of Mother Theresa. This may prove difficult but go ahead and do it. Do you believe that Adolf Hitler represents a person like Mother Theresa? From our experience, of course not, when you see Adolf Hitler your words, likely operate meta to the image, which, will modulate the meaning of the image.

To turn a "thought" into a "belief" or a "belief" back into a mere "thought," we have to move to a meta-level and confirm or disconfirm the thoughts. Usually, the process of merely shifting sub-modalities will not work to transform these beliefs. Sub-modality shifting that effects the saying "yes" or "no" to a thought will alter the belief.

Map and territory differentiation

All perceptions are based on a facsimile representation. Facsimile refers to any representation, which is a person's unique and systematic way of coding information about reality. It is not reality. All perceptions can be said to be accurate in as much as they are based on the internal representations from which they are derived. They are also all incomplete and may or may not accord with the represented territory (reality).

Sub-modalities as the qualities that distinguish the modalities, give our brain specific distinctions for how to feel and respond. At the meta-level of formatting, where sub-modalities work, we will find "the difference that makes the difference." By sub-modalities we sort our experiences.





Analogue and digital distinctions

Analogue refers to a quality that can be changed slowly or quickly along a continuum like a light dimmer. Small to large, soft to hard, quiet to loud, are examples of analogue distinctions.

Digital refers to distinctions that are mutually exclusive. If you are experiencing one, you are not experiencing the other. Internal or external; associated or dissociated are examples of digital distinctions. A light switch is either on or off.

Sub-modalities work symbolically

How a sub-modality works depends entirely on what meanings a given person or culture gives to a particular sensory distinction. When we find a difference that makes the difference in an experience, then we can use it to change the experience. Because every culture will use sub-modalities in a particular way symbolically, the members of that culture will tend to share that symbolic reality in the meanings that they attribute to a distinction. For most western people, for example, making something brighter intensifies feelings. Yet this isn't always true. Each and every person has his or her own unique coding system governing experiences and states.

Meta-stating "sub-modalities"

Sub-modalities refer to the qualities of our sensory modalities. Every representation system has various elements or qualities. If we listen with a profound literalness to our language, we can begin to tune our ears to hear these "sub-modality" distinctions:

- "I feel pretty dull today?"
- "I hear you loud and clear"
- "Something smells fishy about his proposal"
- "I have a bright future"

We can use these seemingly metaphorical sayings to track back to a person's mental map as we seek to understand the person's world. Until NLP, most people treated such language as "just metaphors." But no longer. We now take such metaphors as cues about our internal representing. Our cinematic frames or "sub-modalities" represent one of the most basic components of the way we mentally process information.

To note or detect the qualities in our representations, we have to rise above (or go-meta) to the internal representation.

E.g. think about a pleasant experience until you step into it so much that you fully experience it again.
Now think about that experience....

- How did you code your pictures in terms of distance, clarity, colour, etc?
- And your sound-show did you code the volume, tonality, tempo, distance, etc?

As you think about the qualities of your internal representations (the sub-modalities) do you not have to step back or go meta? Do you not have to get out of content by moving to a higher level and then notice their structure? Yes.

This suggests that when we alter the quality or properties of our internal representations, we do not do so "at the sub-modality level." But we rather do so at a meta-level of awareness. The problem with the old view about sub-modalities lies in part with the term itself. By labelling the quality and properties of the representation's "sub", the language created by presupposition is the idea that we have moved to a lower logical level. But we have not.

The qualities of our pictures do not exist at a level lower than the picture. Try to picture any visual image that does not have colour or black-and-white, closeness or farness, clarity or fuzziness. These do not represent "members" of the class, but qualities of the picture. They occur inside and exist as part of the representation.



Top 15 Basic Meta Questions.

1. Meaning / Significance Ideas that we hold in mind	What does this mean to you? What meanings are you holding in mind?
2. Belief / Believe / Confirm as real Ideas we affirm, validate, and confirm.	What do you believe about this? What do you believe about that belief?
3. Frame / Reference Ideas we set as our frame of reference and mental contexts.	What is your frame of mind about this? What's your frame of reference for this? How are you framing this experience?
4. Permission / Allow / Permit / Embrace / Approve Ideas about allowance and permission versus ideas about prohibitions and taboos	Do you have permission to experience this? Who took permission away from you? Are you ready to allow this for yourself?
5. Prohibition / Taboo / Censor / Dis-allow Ideas we do not allow and permit but prohibit and taboo.	Is this experience or idea prohibited in you? Would it enhance your experience to taboo this? Who has tabooed this for you?
6. Feeling (any feeling: love, hate, care, joy, etc.) Emotional ideas and feeling judgments we bring to other ideas.	What do you feel about this? What if you could enjoy this? What feeling would enhance this most?
7. Thought / Notion / Idea / Word Ideas or thoughts that we bring to some previous idea or thought.	What do you think about this? What thoughts come to mind regarding this? What's your notion about this?
8. Appreciate / Appreciation / Celebrate Ideas of appreciation or value used to frame other ideas.	What do you appreciate most about this? What could you appreciate about this? Do you appreciate this too much?
9. Value / Importance / Count / Honour Ideas we value and treat as important or significant, which we esteem.	What do you value about this? What's important about this that you can count? Do you honour this in yourself or others?
10. Decision / Choice / Will / Pros and Cons Ideas we "cut off" (cision) from other ideas as choices we say Yes and No to.	What's your decision about this? What choice would you like to make about this? What pros and cons are you weighing?
11. Intention / Want / Desire Ideas about motives, intentions, desire, and wants.	What's your highest intention about this? What do you want and really desire about this? What intention is driving your response?
12. Outcome / Goal / Agenda/ Hidden Agenda Ideas we have about goals, outcomes, and desired ends.	What outcome do you have about this? What goal do you have beyond this goal? What's your higher agenda behind this?
13. Expectation / Anticipation Ideas we have about what we anticipate will happen	What's your expectation about this? What do you anticipate will happen about this? What do you expect about this idea?
14. Rules / Demand / Should / Must / Shall Authorise / Injunctions / Policy / Ideas we use as rules for the games we play in our lives, modal operators that generate our modus operandi (MO).	What should you do about this? What do you have to do regarding this? Why? What is the rule that's governing your thoughts? Who or what authorises this policy for you? What injunctions are you acting out?
15. Definition / Class / Categorise / Category / Define / Label Ideas we have that set the categories in our mind for understanding things.	What definition do you use in relating to this? What class do you put this into? How do you categorise this? What other definition could you use for this?



It's Framing All The Way Up



When we mentally put a piece of behaviour or perspective in a different frame, the meaning of it is transformed. It re-frames our perspective. In this, reframing changes our frame of reference from which we perceive things and to that extent, it changes our sense of reality. As our meanings then change, so do our responses (emotions) and behaviours. All reframing models aim at primarily changing our internal response by changing the frame. You will find these patterns useful for behaviours, habits, emotions and even physical symptoms that you don't like.

By framing, we construct higher levels of meaning. We "frame" things at the primary level of representation in order to recognise and know a thing (description). We "frame" things by establishing classes, categories, and definitions which enables us to know what a thing "is," how it works, what it means, etc.

Framing in NLP – an extension of meta states

In the NLP presuppositions, we have a theoretical foundation or a meta-level set of frames. These create the necessary frame of mind that empowers one to use the NLP model. In addition to framing, which we do to format and punctuate our experiences and reality, there are several other NLP frames that are critical factors for working with this model effectively.

1. "As if" Frame:

Acting as if you are... pretending, imagining, possibilities

2. Agreement Frame:

Seeking a higher frame of reference that provides something wherein everybody can agree

3. Relevancy Frame:

Challenging how something is relevant given the context

4. Ecology Frame:

Checking on the balance, health, and resourcefulness of something

5. Perceptual Frames:

Different points of view on something (reframing)

NLP frames

There are numerous frames in NLP. If you know the following Frames and can describe them satisfactorily, check the frame with a check mark (/), those that you are skilled at using, check with a star (*), and put a minus (-) for those that you are unfamiliar with.

Evidence Frame	Backtracking Frame
As if Frame	Well Formed Outcome Frame
Agreement Frame	Relevancy Frame
Ecology Frame	Contrast Frame

The Framing Model

Exercise – Activity

1. Start with a reference

1. What event, experience, relationship, word, or anything else "out there" in the world do you want to frame or reframe?

2. Construct an internal represented reference

1. When you bring the referent inside your mind, how do you represent it?
2. What are the principal representations that you use?
3. As you turn it into a full internal movie with all the cinematic features that make it real to you, what are the key distinctions that you use?

3. Frame of reference

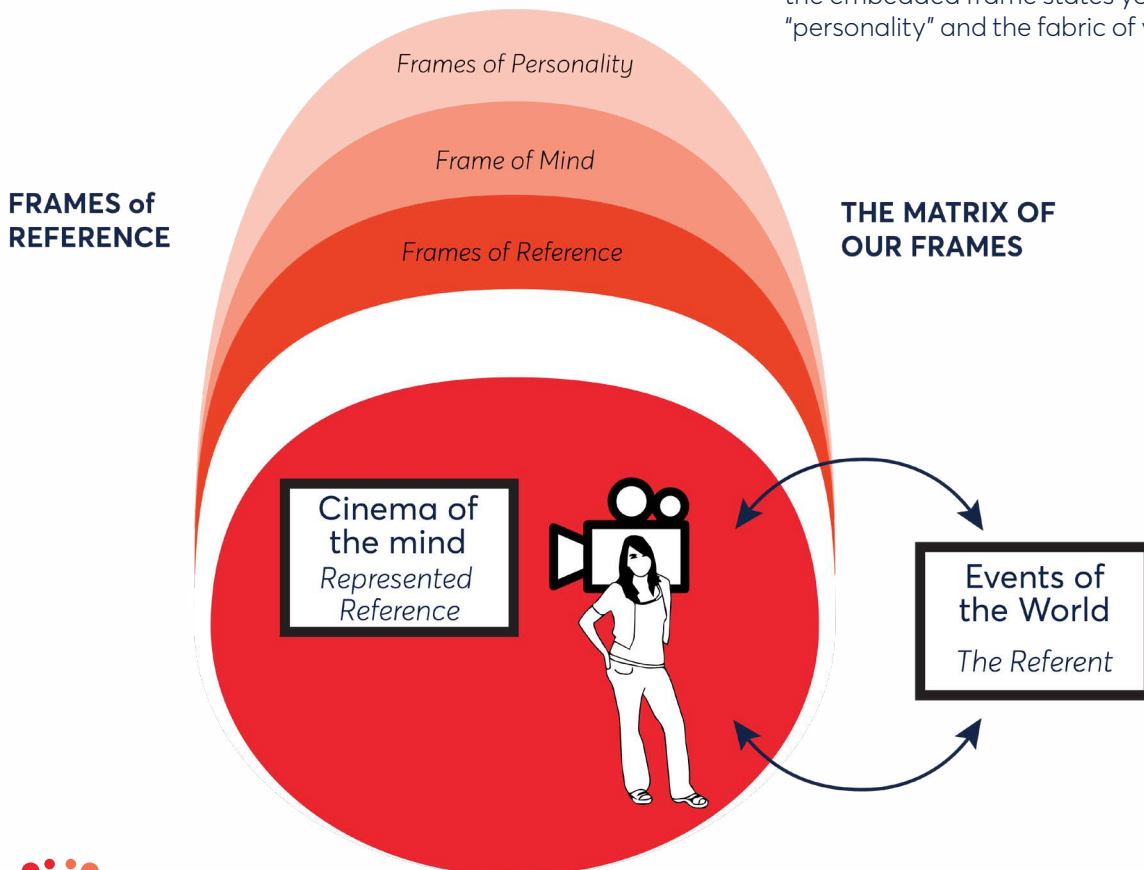
1. What do you think about that cinema?
2. What's your frame of reference about it?
3. What concept do you use to understand it?
4. What do you believe about it?

4. Frame of mind

1. As you think about the frame of reference, what frame of mind does that put you in?
2. As you move up the levels, what meta-programs do you rely on?
3. What attitude does it put you in?

5. The frameworks of your mental Matrix

Layer level upon level of frames and states and from the embedded frame states you develop your unique "personality" and the fabric of your internal realities.





Identifying frames

We process information through various frames-of-reference. These frames are mostly outside of our conscious awareness. We're so used to them as our models of reality that they filter our perspectives. These frames are comprised of our "beliefs," "understandings," "learnings" and "decisions." As such they establish our perspective.

To identify a frame-of-reference, step back or up and as you go meta to your processing content, you can then ask good meta-questions:

- What perspective am I using in processing? (from whose eyes)
- What assumptions and presuppositions are I working from?
- What frame of reference am I using to perceive this?

While the frames that we adopt and utilise are as infinite as human understanding, valuing, and believing, there are a number of common frames.

Competitive frame, "she does this so much better and quicker than I do!". The self-esteem frame, the self-identify frame, the historical frame, the relational frame, success/failure frame, masculinity/femininity frame, right/wrong frame, emotional versus intellectual frame, pleasure/pain frame, etc.

Identify statements, then practice stepping back from them and ask yourself questions about their form and structure and presuppositions. This meta-level awareness will enable you to alter the frames-of-references that you or another has put around an awareness or event.

META META META-LEVEL

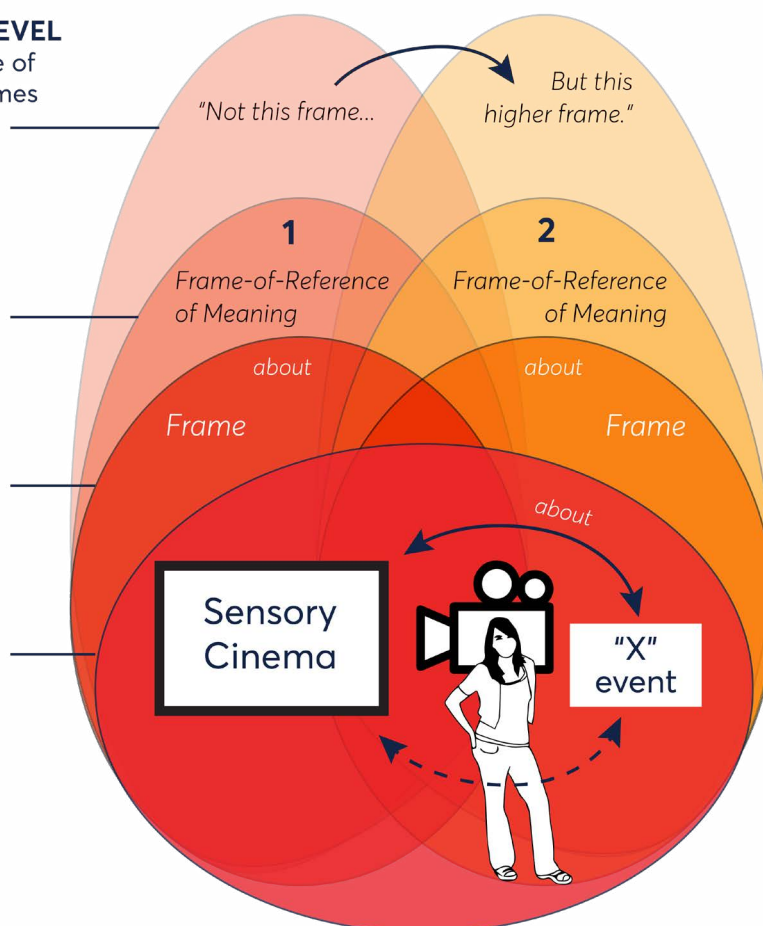
New Enhancing Frame of Reference that outframes the lower frames...

META META-LEVEL

Frame or Meaning that sets the frame on a previous frame

META-LEVEL

PRIMARY LEVEL



Reframing Criticism Activity



Exercise – Activity

Identify a map that you have about criticism. Or, you can use this process to identify a map about anything else that gives you a problem, i.e., failure, abandonment, rejection, manipulation, etc.

1. Identify the X (e.g. the criticism)

- *When you think about X, what comes to mind? How do you represent it?*
- *What does your inner movie look like, sound like, what words associated with it?*

2. Identify the meaning (Y)

- What does that mean to you?
- X means or equals or leads to... what? (the "Y") How do you know to call it that?

3. Identify the positive intention

There's a part of you that has called it "Y" for some positive intention or purpose. What is the positive intention in doing that? [Keep repeating until you get some positive intentions.]

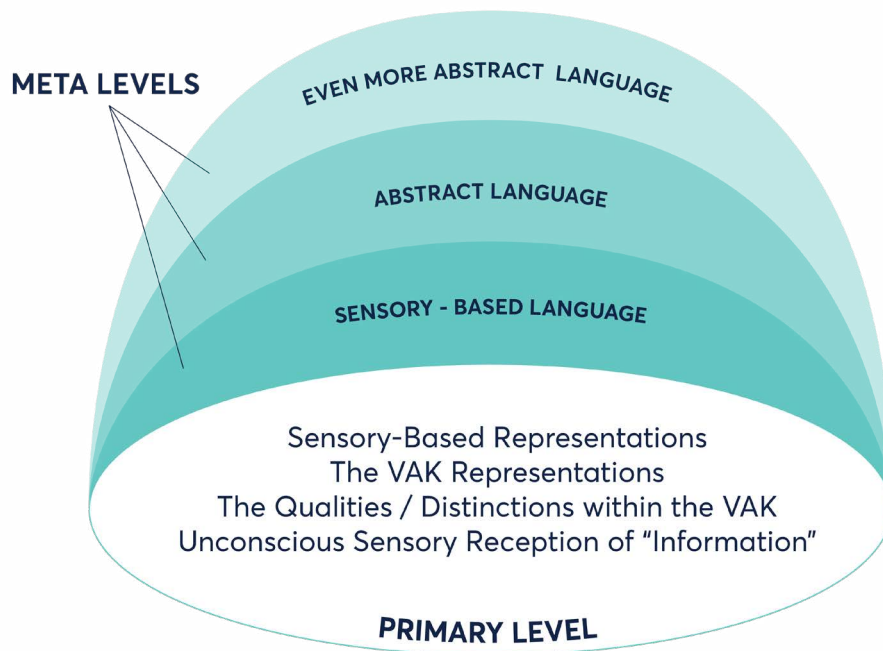
- *Does this X → Y formula really enhance your life and accomplish the positive intention in the long run and in all of your important relationships?*
- *Do you really want it to mean that? To use that as your program for understanding things?*

4. Expand the X = or leads to Y Formula

- *What else could X mean? And what else? [Find several new: X is Z structures to build up a new map about criticism.]*
- *Is there a part of you that would like to give this meaning?*
- *What is the positive intention in doing this?*
- *Step into this new way of thinking... future pace it, check the ecology.*
- *What could be a great symbol for this that you can take with you into your future?*

How reframing works

Meanings work powerfully within our mind-body system. Whenever we change the meaning of an experience, we change our responses. It's inevitable. If in framing, we create a mental context by which to think about something, then in reframing, we attach a new meaning. This leads to a new response, a new experience, and a new behaviour. The content remains the same, but another piece of meaning is put around it (a higher frame or state, hence meta-state).



Any behaviour that we find puzzling demonstrates that we don't know the person's frames. It demonstrates that the majority of a person's mental context lies internal to the person. It may indicate that we have become too locked in our own frames. It probably indicates that we have not stepped into the other's position to discover, imagine, or wonder about the positive intentions and meanings that drive it.

Context reframing involves finding a new context where the experience could be useful.

Content reframing involves giving the experience or behaviour new meanings, so that while nothing changes externally, the behaviour means or implies something new and different.

Frames critically determine our meanings and responses. The frame that we put around any behaviour strongly impacts how we think about it, consider it, and respond to it. To be professional in communicating, we will want to develop the ability to shift the frames that are put around things.

Content and context reframing

Since changed meanings lead to a new-responses, when you change the meaning (or significance) of something you alter the way you respond to it.

Content reframing:	Context reframing
How can this be viewed as valuable?	In what new or different context would this behaviour or response be useful?
What else could it mean?	Does it work/not work in this or that context?





Framing consciousness

What do we mean by “unconscious” and outside-of-consciousness?

Everything that we work within the mind-body system is not conscious. That's obvious, isn't it? There are lots and lots of things going on inside you that you are not aware of. In fact, most things! So, not only do we have a conscious mind, but also an unconscious mind. Actually, we have one mind, a part of it, which is conscious and most of it, which is not.

In the history of psychology, numerous usages and referents have arisen for the word

“unconscious” and the vague phrase, “the unconscious or sub-conscious mind.”

Given that we have one mind, we have a mind that has many facets, dimensions, levels, etc. Our entire nervous system, neurology, mind-body system, etc. operates as an information processing “mind.”

Consciously, we are very limited. Cognitive psychologist, George Miller (1956) wrote a classic paper, “The magic-number 7-plus or minus 2” and documented research on the amount of information that we can consciously hold at a time. Everything else is outside of awareness. That's why there are many facets of our mind-body system, which operate outside of our conscious awareness.

Also, outside of awareness are the processes and mechanisms for language processing, the autonomic nervous system, the immune system, habitual learning's, memories, etc. Most of what we have in our mind does not occur in awareness, but beyond immediate awareness. So, we say that it is “unconscious.”

Outside of conscious awareness, or unconsciously, we

- Store and organise our memories: establishing “dated emotions,” imprints, etc.
- Set and respond to frames: establishing all of the higher “programs” of the mind, beliefs, values, understandings, mappings, paradigms, identifications, etc.
- Encode our representations as seen in our sub-modalities, meta-programs, meta- states, frames, etc.
- Send signals to our nervous systems: thereby creating health, illness, disease, etc.

So, how do we communicate with the various dimensions of our mind, which are unconscious? What processes do we have in NLP for communicating with the frames that have become outside of our awareness? There are many. The old six-step reframing model is one such model, although it is quite obsolete for many reasons. We have included it next in this manual for historical learning purposes.





The Six-step Reframing Pattern

Exercise – Activity

This pattern works for those behaviours that you don't like and would like to stop, and which don't seem to respond to conscious reframing. The Six-Step Reframing pattern provides a way to deal with secondary-gain behaviours in a way that's ecological for you as a whole person. It does that by reframing old programs that run outside of awareness ("unconscious"). It brings about an integration of conscious and "unconscious" parts. You can use it for behaviours, habits, emotions and symptoms that do no longer serve you well.

As you learn these NLP patterns, we recommend that you follow these as written to enable you to embed the learning.

Steps are numbered with an explanation of a high-level outcome. Beneath each step are the phrases or questions to use.

Avoid getting into the content and stick to the context, process and structure of the pattern.

Context = Client does the work = effective results are self-determined

Content = Coach does the work = ineffective results are the result of over-responsibility

1. Identify the behaviour to be dealt with

Find a behaviour that fits one of these models: "I want to stop "X"-ing." "I want to "Y", but something stops me."

"There's a part of you that creates this response... be with that... what is the positive intention?"

- *"Are there any other positive intentions?"*
- *"What is the positive intention of that positive intention?"*

2. Establish communication with the part responsible for the pattern

As you go inside, ask; "will the part of me that generates this behaviour communicate with me in consciousness?"

Say: "Just pay attention to feelings, images, and sounds that occur within you in response to the question. Do you have a sense of yes or a sense of no? If this means yes, have it increase in brightness, volume or intensity. If it means No have it decrease." (We do this to give us access to communicate with that facet of ourselves.)





3. Determine its positive intention

Ask client to ask; "would you be willing to let me know in consciousness what you are trying to do for me by generating this behaviour?" [This separates behaviour from the positive intention of the part responsible for it.

If yes, then get its intention

- *Is that intention acceptable to consciousness?*
- *Do you want to have a part of you that fulfils that function?*
- *If there were ways to accomplish your positive intention that would work as well or better than this behaviour, would you be interested in trying them out?*

If no, do unconscious reframing

- *Are you willing to trust that your unconscious is well-intentioned, even though it won't tell you what it's trying to do for you by this behaviour?*
- *Do you need to apologise to this part? Have you been rough and hard with it?*
- *What happens when you apologise to this part?*

4. Access your creative part

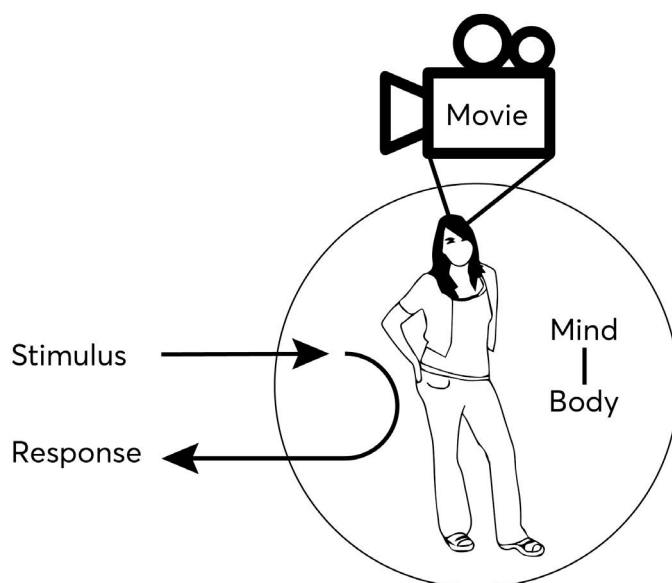
- *How aware are you of your creative side?*
- *Client to ask themselves; "will my creative part then generate new behaviours that will accomplish the positive intention?"*
- *Allow your creative part to generate more choices. Have this part that generates the behaviour select three choices that are as good as or better than it.*
- *Have it give a "yes" signal each time it selects such an alternative?*

5. Future-pace

Are you willing to take responsibility for using the three new alternatives in the appropriate context? Will your unconscious identify the sensory cues that will trigger the new choices and to experience fully what it's like to have sensory cues effortlessly and automatically bring on one of the new choices?

6. Run an ecology check

Client to ask themselves; "Is there any part of me that objects to any of the three new alternatives?"



Frames Upon Frames



Consider the role of frames upon frames in the movie-rewind pattern (also known as the phobia cure pattern). It works because we layer level upon level of resources upon the original primary state. Below is a model of how that works.

Level 1: Primary trauma thought

Begin with a "negative" thought that sets off all kinds of painful emotional reactions. Pick a "thought" or a memory that "rattles your cage" so much so that you can't even "think" it in a calm and rational way. This presents as the primary state or experience. In it you find that you have become wired (so to speak) to react semantically to an "idea." Just the idea of the trauma upsets you and your entire body and neurology becomes reactive. It is this thought, this representation that we will be dealing with.

Level 2: Calm distance

Imagine putting the "thought" that upsets you on a mental screen and stepping back from it as if in a movie theatre. When you have located the memory, turn it into a black-and-white snapshot of a scene at the beginning of the traumatic event. Freeze-frame this scene and hold it there as you take your seat in the 10th row. Here we are meta-stating the trauma thought with distance, stillness, and black-and-white coding. All of these higher ideas about (meta) to the first level thought induce messages of comfort about it.

- *Explanation: In NLP this has been called a "dissociation" step, yet it involves so much more. It certainly does have the effect of stepping back and out of a felt memory. And as a result, most people feel some relief. Yet we have not so much moved to "not feeling" as we have to "feeling calm" and "feeling distance" about the memory. We have begun to layer thoughts and feelings upon the trauma memory that gives it a new texture, a new feel. But it doesn't end there.*

Level 3: Increased distance and protect and control

Now imagine yourself and feel yourself float out of your observing self and up to the projection booth. From there you will be able to see the back of your current self, watching the old memory representation as a black-and-white snapshot on the screen. Touch the perspex that separates you from the auditorium knowing that you're safe here in the projection booth.

- *Explanation: This so-called "double dissociation" steps back two times to apply all kinds of resources to the original thought that we have not actually "thought" about yet. All this is preparation (pre-framing) for thinking. Here we have continued meta-stating our old memory with more distance and protection behind a perspex barrier. And because in the projection booth we can edit the film, we bring editing skill and power to bear upon the old memory, which gives us the sense of power and control.*



Level 4: Controlled viewing and fast rewinding

Now you can turn on the movie (intentional control) and let it play out. Just watch it in this black-and-white movie of your past. After the traumatic scene is over, let it play until you find a scene of comfort where you're okay, freeze frame that scene. Then, step into that scene of comfort and run it backward while you are inside seeing, hearing, and feeling everything run backwards. Let this happen so quickly that it only takes two seconds.

- *Explanation: Here we layer onto all of the other layers of awareness cues like the images being black-and-white that we are observing "the past," and that we're in control of editing our memory. Then, after we meta-state the memory with comfort, we add a very strange layer of consciousness as we rewind the movie. Bringing backwardness or fast reverse to our memory really layers on some weird thinking and feeling. For some this will interrupt, for others it will spread comfort backwards through the past, and for yet others it will confuse and mess up the old strategy for trauma. Talk about more layers and frames that texture the old trauma. And yet we have not finished.*

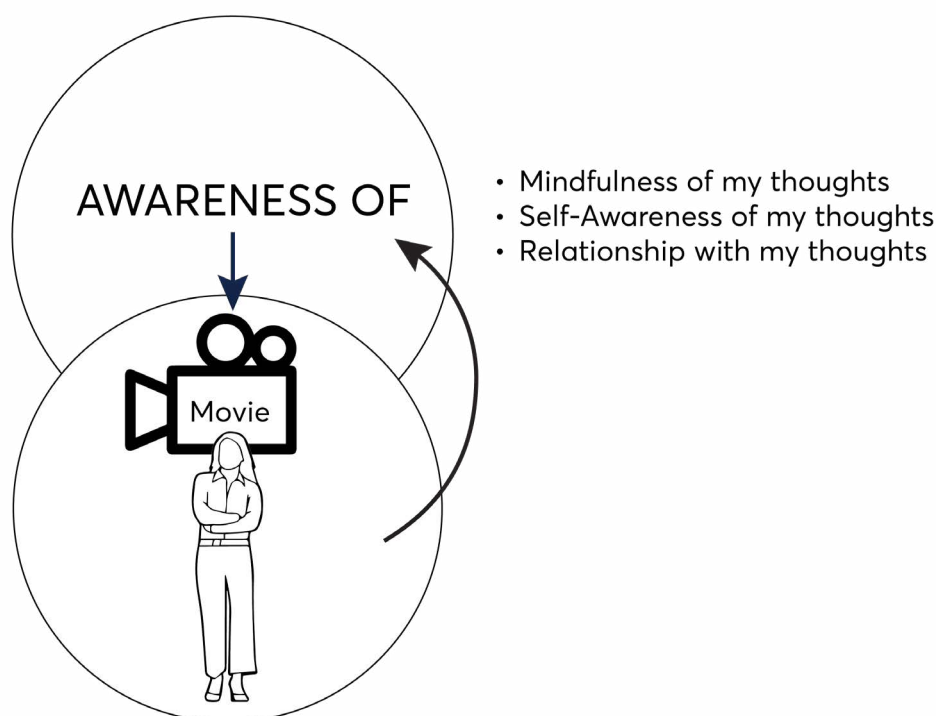
Level 5: Clean slate and directiveness

After the first backward super-rewinding process, do this 5-more times. Clear the screen of your mind, start with the scene of comfort, step in, rewind. In this step, we layer onto everything ideas of a clean slate and we bring that to bear upon the memory. This interrupts things and it directionalises our minds.

Level 6: Meta-stating with a coherent metaphor.

The whole set of the meta-level states that you have added one upon another in this process has all actually occurred inside of a metaphor of a movie. In other words, you also brought a movie show situation to bear upon the thought—which enabled the other moves (stepping back and back, altering the visual and auditory components, running it backwards, etc.) to occur without really noticing.

True enough, a negative memory doesn't stand a chance. We can't track that many levels and so the first meta-levels begin to "collapse" or coalesce into the primary state thereby texturing and qualifying the memory in new and more resourceful ways.



Reframing Motivation Pattern



Exercise – Activity

This pattern uses reframing to empower and enhance our sense of motivation.

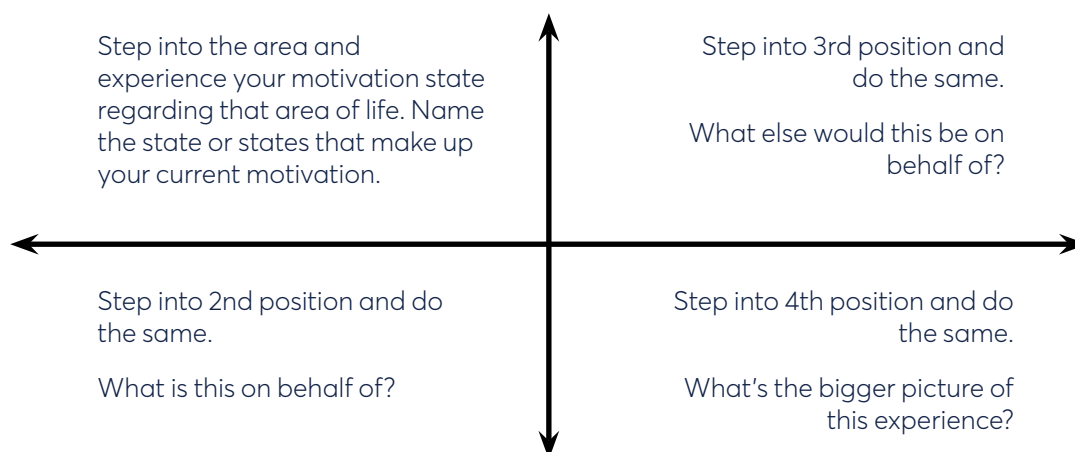
1. Identify an area of life where you would like to have a more motivation or to refine your motivation

Are you perfectly satisfied with the kind and quality of your motivation? In what area of life would you like to enhance your motivation?

What belief change or belief frame would enrich your motivation and would give you the kind and quality of motivation that you truly want?

What would you like to believe about this that would improve the motivation?

2. Explore the motivation quality of the state



What are your motives, reasons, frames, beliefs, emotions, etc. that drive this motivation state?

How much motivation do you have? – Gauge 0 to 10.

3. Tune up your representation richness

Enrich the sensory representations of your mental movie.

Fine-tune the qualities of it as you edit the features of that movie (sub-modalities).

4. Future pace

See yourself moving out into your future with the new motivation and commission this; "how much do you now really want this?"

Reframing – Belief Change



Exercise – Activity

"Behaviours are organised around some very durable things called beliefs. A belief tends to be much more universal and categorical than an understanding. Existing beliefs can even prevent a person from considering new evidence or a new belief." Richard Bandler (1985)

The power of beliefs

We are psychologically organised around our beliefs. "According to your faith, be it unto you", is true with a vengeance when it comes to human nature and behaviour. As we believe, so we experience, emote and perceive. This principle summarises a basic and crucial principle for understanding and dealing with human nature. It means that our believing determines and governs our subsequent experiences. Perhaps it is the most determining factor in all of human nature. Such believing reveals how we process data, look at (perceive) the world and ourselves, talk to ourselves, read life's events, interpret their meaning, and appraise what it means to us.

Transforming beliefs will mean several things. It will mean learning to re-code our brain about our beliefs so that they become more compelling and real. It will mean updating our maps so that we have fewer misbeliefs to interfere with effective perceiving and functioning. It will mean giving our heart to beliefs that we find meaningful.

Beliefs create what seems like a double-bind. They fate us to fulfil them; they organise our mind and body to actualise them. Yet beliefs can change. We were not born with the beliefs we now have. Wherever we got them, they came to us as mental understandings of the world. If we bought into them as a child, then we adopted them by osmosis. That means they are really someone else's map for interpreting and appraising life. If we now find those beliefs limiting and unsatisfactory for our life, then we can alter them.

NLP presupposition: "The map is not the territory"

How long does it take to change a belief? It all depends. Do you really want to change it? That's a prerequisite. If you do, and you know how to do it, you can change beliefs in a fairly short time and permanently. Of course, first we have to know what beliefs are made of and then use a reliable process to change them.

"The process of changing a belief is relatively easy, as long as you have the person's consent." (Bandler and Grinder)

Classic NLP ... the old way of doing belief change

Classic or pure NLP previously assumed that "beliefs" are simply the consistent signals that we cue our brain with. These durable understandings ("beliefs") of yourself, others, life, etc. then become your meanings. Accordingly, the old NLP patterns for transforming limiting and/or dysfunctional beliefs into life-enhancing and productive beliefs involved sending crystal clear sensory signals to our brains and to do so in the "form" of "strong beliefs" and to de-commission old beliefs by recoding them in the form of "doubts."

The following process is the traditional NLP approach to belief change. It comes from Using your brain for a change³, chapter 7. I have included it here to let you see how NLP approached belief change in the first 23 years...

³ Bandler, R., Andreas, S., & Andreas, C. (1985). Using your brain--for a change . Moab, Utah: Real People Press.



Original belief change pattern – transforming beliefs

1. First, identify a limiting belief you want to change

If you think about a belief as an understanding that has undesirable consequences to you, then write down some key beliefs. Be sure to include some that you would like to change. What limiting beliefs are you still entertaining in your head that you wish you didn't?

Finish these sentence stems:

- "What I believe about myself is ... "
- "What I believe about people is ... "
- "What I believe about the world or life is ... "
- "What I believe about God is"
- What belief/s do you have about yourself that you'd like to change?
- What belief limits you in some way?

2. Target your limiting beliefs

- *Note: The beliefs that you now evaluate as junky beliefs which interrupt your best functioning, and which sabotage your development.*

Menu:

"I can't learn quickly."	"I can't learn efficiently."
"I can't control myself."	"I can't lose weight."
"I can't relax."	"I can't be assertive."
"People are out to control you."	"People can't be trusted, etc."

3. Note internal representation

How do you represent one of your limiting beliefs in your mind?

Notice that as you think about that belief, what pictures, words, sounds, and sensations strike you?

Identify the most powerful and driving sub-modalities of that belief.

Once you have an awareness of the internal representation of the limiting belief, set it aside for a moment.

4. Identify a solid belief

What do you believe without a doubt? What is one of your solid beliefs? Do you believe the sun will rise tomorrow?

How do you represent this a solid belief in your mind? What are the key sub-modalities present in your representation?



5. Get a representation on doubt

What are you doubtful about? Think of something you doubt.

Think of something that may be true or may not be. What are you not really sure about?

How do you represent this doubt in your mind?

What are the key sub-modalities present in your representation?

Doubt is when you waver from thinking something might be true to thinking it might not be true; you just don't know.

- *How do you know you doubt something?*

6. Make a contrastive difference

How are these phenomena (belief and doubt) different?

Run a contrastive analysis between them. Find the sub-modality differences.

For example: maybe the belief is a big picture, bright, and vivid while doubt is small, dim, and fuzzy. Or the belief may be a detailed picture, straight ahead and fills up the frame while the doubt is general, off to the right and small.

What sub-modalities tell your brain that one is a solid belief and the other is a questionable doubt?

7. Test the sub-modalities

Test the differences, one at a time, to find out which is most powerful in changing beliefs to doubt for you. Make it smaller. Remove the frame from belief picture, make it fuzzy, dimmer. Move from centre of screen to right etc.

8. Elicit a new enhancing belief you want to replace the limiting belief

What would you rather believe?

- *"I can learn to effectively handle criticism."*
- *"I believe I can learn to change my eating habits and maintain a desired body weight."*

9. Check for ecology

Suppose you had this new belief, how you would act differently?

As you anticipate it, are there any ways in which this change could be a problem for you? How will this new belief affect your work? Relationships? Skills?

10. Switch content

Switch the old Belief into Doubt. If in doubt you flip your picture off and on, and then let the limiting belief flip in and out. As you recode the belief as doubt, turn down the old content completely when the belief flips out.

At that point, switch to the content of the new belief, and turn it up.

Or, you can have the picture become so bright (or so dim) that the old content disappears. At that point put the new content in and tune the picture back in.

11. Turn the doubt into belief

Take the new belief and reverse the sub-modality changes so that you encoded what you want to believe as a strong belief.

Once you do that, amplify the new belief. Then take a moment to absorb and enjoy this new belief.

12. Test

Break state for a moment.

Think about this new belief. Do you now believe it? Think about the old belief? What happens?

Where does your brain go?



Meta-yes and Meta-no - Belief Change Pattern



Exercise – Activity

Once you have discovered some limiting beliefs that you want to get out of your head and neurology so that they no longer operate as your programming, you can use this meta- state pattern for changing limiting beliefs.

It will give you a clear, quick, and effective way to de-frame the old un-enhancing beliefs and to install the empowering beliefs that support your commitment to success. It is important to prepare for this pattern since there is no ecology inside the pattern.

As you learn these NLP patterns, we recommend that you follow these as written to enable you to embed the learning.

Steps are numbered with an explanation of a high-level outcome. Beneath each step are the phrases or questions to use.

Avoid getting into the content and stick to the context, process and structure of the pattern.

Context = Client does the work = effective results are self-determined

Content = Coach does the work = ineffective results are the result of over-responsibility

1. Start by establishing what limiting and empowering belief your partner would like to have
2. What enhancing and empowering beliefs would you really like to have run in your mind and-emotions?
3. Which belief stands in your way?
4. How does this belief sabotage you or undermine your effectiveness? Have you had enough of it? Or do you need more pain?
5. Have you meta-modelled it to reality test it?
6. How specifically isn't the belief ecological?
7. What again is the empowering belief would you like to have in its place?

1. Get access to a good strong "no!"

Think of something that every fibre in your body can say "no!" to in a way that is fully congruent.

Say that "no!" again and again until you get it. Take a snapshot of it on the inside.

Anchor your "no!" with your hand gestures. Feel it. Hear your voice of "no!"

Menu:

- "Would you push a little child in front of a speeding bus just for the hell of it?"
- "Would you eat a bowl of dirty filthy worms when you have delicious food available?"



2. Meta "no!" the limiting belief

Now, feeling all of this powerful "no!", even "hell no!" feel this fully as you think about that stupid, useless, limiting belief ... and say NO, right now!

Keep on saying "no!" to that limiting belief until you begin to feel it shift and that no, no longer has any power to run your programs, that it has no power in your presence or in your mind.

How many more times and with what voice, tone and gesturing, do you need, to totally disconfirm that old belief so that you know deep inside yourself that it will no longer run your programs?

3. Next, access a strong and robust "yes!"

Think about something that every fibre of your being says "yes!" to without any question or doubt. Is there anything like that?

Notice your "yes!"

Notice the neurology and feeling of your "yes!" Notice the voice of "yes!"

Gesture the "yes!" with your hands and body. Amplify this "yes!"

4. Meta "yes!" the enhancing belief

Decide upon an empowering belief to take the place of the limiting belief (usually the reverse of the limiting belief. "If you had a new and different, more empowering belief in place of that old limiting belief, what do you think it would be?".

"And feeling that new sense of belief, will you bring this new yes to bare on that belief?" "Do you want this?" Yes! "Really?" Yes!

"How many more times do you need to say yes! right now in order to feel that you have fully welcomed it into your presence?"

5. Meta yes the "Yes!" repeatedly and put into the person's future

Now, feel that "yes!" in your mind, in your body, in your voice, in your presence, in your future.

How many more times do you need to say yes! right now in order to feel that you have fully welcomed it into your presence?

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FRAMES BY IMPLICATION

Decisions

Understandings

Reasons

Explanations



THOUGHT



More Meta-States Patterns



Exercise – Activity

Sphere of excellence

What are your best coaching or communicating states? How much access do you have to them?

How available are they to you? What are your top ten?

Pick from this list if you like:

Congruence	Ruthless compassion	Curiosity
Wonder	Care	Compassion
Love	Strength	Awe
Clarity	Openness	Flexibility
Energy, vitality	Engagement	Focus
Presence	Acceptance	Vulnerability

The sphere of excellence pattern

1. Identify an excellent state of your choosing

What state would you like to have available for your use - a state that would allow you to act from your full capabilities?

2. Imagine a circle on the floor

Visually imagine that there's a circle in front of you on the floor and make sure that it is big enough for you to step into.

3. Fill up the circle with symbolic colours of resourcefulness

What colour would you like to use to symbolise the resource?

Notice how the qualities of the circle grow and develop and become richer...

4. Take a meta-position

Think of a single one-time event when you experienced that resource? As you recall that instance, stand outside the circle, and let the circle fill up with those qualities... qualities that you want to have available now and in the future.

If needed, pretend you have these qualities or model them from someone else who does have them. What do you see? Hear? Feel? What do you say to yourself?

How are you holding your body when you are experiencing these resources fully?
Anchor this state in all sensory systems.



5. Step into the circle and make it a sphere

Seeing yourself possessing all of these qualities and resources, as you step into the circle and breathe them in – fully and completely.

Hear what you say to yourself, see what you look like and notice what you now feel.

Fire all anchors as you amplify the state or states in your circle of excellence. Experience your thoughts and feelings fully.

As you do, let the circle become a sphere, a bubble, a space, from which you live & move.

6. Future pace

As you continue to experience the circle, see, hear and feel yourself performing in the days and weeks to come ... using this state as you move through the world.

7. Break state and test

What did you eat for lunch two days ago? (State interrupt). Now step back into this circle and fire your anchors for your state of excellence and test.



The Swish Pattern



Exercise – Activity

The Swish Pattern

Communicating directs our brains so they go to specific places. We mostly do this haphazardly, but we can do so more mindlessly (without mind). We can set up a positive picture that we want to move toward and link it to a troubling trigger. In this way we can teach our brain to replace one with the other. The Swish pattern is generative, because it creates a new direction of focus. We can now move toward a self-image of the kind of person we want to become. Swishing can propel you in that direction.

As you learn these NLP patterns, we recommend that you follow these as written to enable you to embed the learning.

Steps are numbered with an explanation of a high-level outcome. Beneath each step are the phrases or questions to use.

Avoid getting into the content and stick to the context, process and structure of the pattern.

Context = Client does the work = effective results are self-determined

Content = Coach does the work = ineffective results are the result of over-responsibility

1. Identify an experience to be changed

1. What response or habit do you want to transform? For example, biting your nails...
2. Do you have any responses that you would like to re-wire? Would you like to attach a new response to an old trigger? What is the context where the trigger occurs?
3. Where are you stuck or dis-empowered in a communication? When, where, how, etc. do you do this?

2. Identify the experiencer's inner movie and its internal representation.

1. What is the resourceful behaviour or state; describe it as full as possible. What is the cue picture, sound or sensation?
2. When do you typically do this?
3. Imagine you are doing that, (e.g. you bring one of your hands up, and start to bite nail, and smoke, etc. go through the motions). The cue representation sets off the old response. It's the button that triggers your response.



3. Develop a desired outcome movie or representation

1. If you no longer (bit your nails/smoked etc.) had this response, how would you see yourself as being different? How would that be valuable to you? What will be different? How will you be different? What difference would it make to you as a person?
2. What would it mean to you?
3. What would your desired self-image look, sound and feel like? Do you like this new picture?
4. Do you find it compelling? Attractive?
5. Is it juiced up so that your brain feels that it is "real, compelling, and attractive"?

4. Link the two representations

"Begin with the cue picture of the first trigger, step into the movie and be there. Put the you for whom this is no longer a problem for, in the middle of that picture. Have you embedded that desired picture into the cue picture? Good!

5. Prepare to swish

"In just a moment the trigger cue picture will fade out and move far back into the distance and at the same time the dot that contains the desired image will very quickly get bigger and brighter and closer. As the cue picture gets smaller and darker and at more distance (use the cinematic features that drive your responses), let the new picture swish in and completely fill the screen of your mind. Do all of this very quickly, in less than a second".

6. Swish!

"Do it. Quickly fade out the images ... let them move back into the distance and quickly watch the dot explode into the centre of the screen ... watch it get very big and bright and close".

7. Swish five times

"Have you finished? Good. Now close your eyes and blank out the screen. Or, open your eyes and look around".

"Now, let's do it again. Go back to the linked pictures and repeat this process four more times. Clear your mental screen after each swish.

8. Test

Good. Now let's test this to see if it works. After all, that's the important thing.

I want you to just allow yourself to think about the triggering cue picture that used to set you off and put you into the reactive state. Got it?

Notice what happens.

As you think about that old trigger, does your brain now immediately go to the new picture? Good. That means you're done. You have successfully swished your brain so that it now has made a link. It now knows where to go.



The Movie Rewind – Phobia Cure



Exercise – Activity

As we are wired to think by playing movies forward in our mind, what if we rewind a movie? What happens then? Communicating a “reverse” and experiencing a reverse from inside a movie has the effect of de-energising or even erasing a movie and therefore the coding that goes with it. It has the effect of outframing the movie. This can become valuable for old movies that we no longer need to play, especially for those that were hurtful and ugly.

The movie rewind pattern recodes our mind-body-emotion system, so that when we simply “think” about something, it will no longer evoke or induce a phobic or un- resourceful state or elicit out-of-control semantic reactions. We can think and feel in a comfortable way. This process takes the negative emotional charge out of a memory or thought.

Sense makes nothing then and apart comes syntax the, backwards sentence a read we when. When we read a sentence backwards, the syntax comes apart and then nothing makes sense.

The Movie Rewind pattern

As you learn these NLP patterns, we recommend that you follow these as written to enable you to embed the learning.

Steps are numbered with an explanation of a high-level outcome. Beneath each step are the phrases or questions to use.

Avoid getting into the content and stick to the context, process and structure of the pattern.

Context = Client does the work = effective results are self-determined

Content = Coach does the work = ineffective results are the result of over-responsibility

1. Think about the representation or memory as if just witnessing it

“I want you to imagine yourself sitting in a movie theatre. Now upon the screen in this mental theatre, can you see a picture of a memory, about a time or event that is associated with the un-resourceful state of the younger you, in some situation just before the fearful, traumatic, or unpleasant event or events occurred”.

“Now freeze-frame this scene just prior to the event so that it appears as a snapshot. Is it a black-and-white snapshot? If not, then let the colour of the picture fade out until it is”.

“Now sit back and look at the snapshot of your event, aware that you have taken the spectator’s position to that younger you. Notice that you are outside of the picture and observing it from outside. Notice how even this starts changing how you are feeling about it, doesn’t it? And as you can, sit comfortably just watching your old freeze-framed movie”.



"As you gain this psychological distance, just be a witness to that old snapshot, delighted that you can step aside – even further. Because taking this spectator position to your old memories enables you to begin to learn from them in new and useful ways. You might notice how your younger self in the memory thought and felt from a less resourceful position than you have now, sitting here, and observing with your adult mind. And notice how this already gives you a new and different perspective, does it not?"

2. Float back to the projection booth to watch yourself watching

"As you sit there in the tenth row, just float back now, back to the projection booth that's behind you and above you. From this point-of-view, you can see yourself still sitting in the tenth row watching the black-and-white snapshot on the screen".

"From this position, put your hands on the glass or the perspex window, to remind yourself that you are not in the picture, not even in the theatre, but way back here in the projection booth, the place where you can control things. How much distance do you have between yourself and you in the tenth row and the snapshot of your movie? Notice, how safe and secure you feel in here, in the control booth?"

3. Now let the old memory play out as you watch it from the projection booth

"Now, from inside the projection booth press 'play' to start your black-and-white movie, and, as you watch this movie, notice the cinematic features. Become a good film critique and tell me about the visuals (moving, still, bright, dim) notice the size, whether it is clear or fussy, the sound track, (volume, pitch, tone of voices), etc. What words do you hear from that younger you, if any?"

"Continue watching it from the beginning until the end. If you need to, speed it up to get through it, just fast-forward it. Got it? Good. Stop the movie at the end and freeze-frame it".

"What changes would you like to make (if any) to your movie that would enable you to think comfortably about that memory, so that you can stay resourceful and thoughtful in a relaxed and comfortable way?"

4. Step into the comfort at the end of the movie and rewind

"Now I want you to float into the movie, into that final scene. Step in... at the end of the movie and be there.

"Now in just a minute we are going to rewind this memory and do so in super-fast rewind speed. You have seen movies and videos that run backwards haven't you? Well, I want you to rewind this movie at the fastest rewind speed imaginable, in just a moment or two and to do so while you are inside this movie. From your vantage point, you might see a confusion of sights and a jumbling of sounds as everything zooms back to the beginning and as you zoom backwards to that original snapshot".

"Ready? Step into the comfort scene at the end of the movie, now, push the rewind button and experience you rewinding with – everything going backwards, as you are pulled backwards with it... Zooooooooommmmm. All the way back to the beginning. There you go. It only takes a second or two to do that fast rewind, and how did that feel rewinding from inside the movie? When you experience the fast rewinding, all the people and their actions go backwards, did you notice that they walk and talk backwards? You walk and talk in reverse. Everything happens in reverse, as you're rewinding your movie".

5. Invite the client to repeat this process until they are done

"Was that strange? How about you do it again and again – just as many times as you need until you – are – done!"

6. Test the results. [Break state from this exercise for a minute.]

"How was that? You now know things come apart when you rewind them. How about that?"

"It's hard to even call up the original memory and feel the same. See if you can do it? Can you? Can you get the unpleasant un-resourceful state back? Try really hard and see if you can recall the traumatic movie".



PRECISION QUESTIONING (Skill #4)





Precision Questions

Questioning on first encounter seems like such an obvious and easy skill. It seems that way, but it is not necessarily so. That's because speaking, telling, giving advice, instructing, etc. feel more powerful and almost all of us default to some form of telling at some stage in our communicating. It takes a real level-of-mastery to ask questions and use inquiry to facilitate the self-actualisation in another. Precision questioning then is the skill and art of asking great questions that invite a listener to go inside and find and/or create the resources that facilitates their confidence to find new answers to old problems.

Why ask Questions?

1. We communicate best by questioning because as the person finds his or her own answers, those answers will be more memorable, and the person will assume more ownership and responsibility in their accessing of resources in future.
2. We facilitate change and exploration by questioning. Our own curiosity enables and empowers the listener to be even more curious about the structure of his or her own experience.
3. We coach best when we ask great questions that the person finds exciting and empowering to answer.

In Meta-Coaching and Neuro-Semantics, we use 2-core questioning models.

The meta-model of language

A way of communicating and questioning with the meta-representation system of language that allows us to expand our understanding of how language works and that empowers us to use representational tracking for a deeper and more accurate understanding of one-another.

In learning the Meta-Model, we will learn to accurately identify linguistic distinctions, and to then question those distinctions for greater communication precision. This involves the skill of meta-model detection, questioning, and induction.

Well-formed outcome questions

A set of specific questions that are designed to facilitate the creation of client outcomes or goals in a well-formed way, that empower the client to begin the journey of their personal fulfilment and development.



Benchmarks for Questioning



Asking a person to turn and reflect inwardly to respond with ideas, answers, resources and solutions, inquiring about the client's world of ideas, beliefs, frames, goals, etc.

Level 3.75 – Creating Movement

Asking that frames and explores structure, in a way that challenges personally and intimately, that creates forward movement, that the client evaluates as getting to the heart of things.

Level 3.5 – Inviting Higher Awareness

Asking (in-depth probing) that invites awareness and meta-awareness; that puts client at a choice, that produces energy for finding solutions, inviting client to be solution-focused, collaborative and playful. Asking quality control questions.

Level 3 – Open Ended Questions

Asking that invites a search or exploration toward a Well-Formed Outcome (WFO); asking for information in an open-ended way so there's no wrong answer ("how do you best like to relax?"), to elicit relevant and pertinent answers, that shifts attention to what's productive for moving toward an outcome (WFO). Coach/client get a KPI.

Level 2 – Leading Questions

Asking questions that lead to a prescribed answer ("don't you want to handle this situation using X?") so that client either feels controlled and dominated in the conversation or begins resisting the question and not playing the conversation coaching game.

Level 1 – Closed Questions

Asking un-useful closed-ended questions, rhetorical questions, and "nosy" questions about irrelevant details and content.

Level 0 – Telling and Advice-Giving

Telling and giving direction, personal judgments, no questioning.



The Meta-model

The magic in language

Do you know that there's magic in language?

Do you know that magic lies in the words we speak and the symbols that we use to convey movies for the mind and frames for those movies?

As a model, the meta-model is a set of linguistic distinctions and questions. The structural distinctions give us specific questions for exploring a person's experience.

A description about the structure of language, which enables us to think about the words, we use every day and the clarity (or lack of it) in the movies that it evokes in our minds.

The Meta-model describes the surface words and sentences that we utter, and the deeper level meanings or references that they allude to. This reveals different levels of meaning. We have the level that's on the surface, and we have the level behind or underneath that gives us a fuller map of the person's meanings.

By using the distinctions of the meta-model, we can question linguistic and semantic structures that are not well-formed. Doing this elicits more well-formed expressions giving the speaker the opportunity to create a more complete and more resourceful mental map and mental movie. This enriches his or her inner world creating new capacities and skills. This is the "magic" of language and of the NLP communication model.

What can we do with this model?

- 1) Gather high quality information; gather more precise and accurate information.
- 2) Hone in on the limits of the person's mental model of the world and identify precisely where and how a person has boxed him or herself in and how to expand that person's mapping.
- 3) Clearly identify the techniques to use to positively influence someone.
- 4) Invite the expansion of a person's mental mapping and therefore experiencing.

Language as a mapping process only "makes sense" if it connects some movie for us, or if we can use the words to create a movie in our mind. Communicating with precision refers to being able to translate our higher-level abstract words and concepts into more sensory specific referents so that the listener can create a similar picture.

Summary

The meta-model is a model about language. The model is made up of distinctions and questions. As a model, it enables us to think about the form and structure of the language we use and the clarity of the movie that the words enable us to make. We use the meta-model to question ill-formed linguistic and semantic structures, so that we can elicit from someone, more well-formed expressions.



The Basic Meta-model Questions for Precision



- How do you know?
- Says who?
- How specifically?
- When specifically?
- How does what I am doing cause you to...?
- What would happen if you did or you didn't do/say that?
- What stops you?
- Compared to who or what?
- Does X always happen, every time? What about Y event?
- What do you think that is?
- What are you assuming?
- How do you know that we should evaluate it this way?

Notes:



Representational tracking

Representational tracking is the primary tool for using the meta-model effectively. This refers to the ability to hear statements and to take only what we hear and track it into the theatre of our mind, to create our representations of the other person's mental movie. If we can track from the word directly and immediately to our own internal movie and it makes sense, then the words are well-formed. If not, then the words are vague and ambiguous, and we need to ask some questions about them in order to gather more information.

What happens when you representationally track the following statement?

“Management has recently decided that it is required that the empowerment initiative begin by May 1.”

What pictures and sound track did you create for your inner movie? Compare that with this one:

“The brown dog ran across the green grass in the backyard chasing a brown rabbit which appeared suddenly from under a bush, and then he ran across the cement that has only been set a few minutes before.”

- *Do you have pictures of that?*
- *Did the movie begin playing almost as soon as you read the words?*

Sensory-based words enable us to track them directly from the page or from a speaker's mouth to our mental screen.

Evaluative words that are non-sensory based, that invite us to either hallucinate (construct) or to ask for more precise information. If we do the later, we are meta- modelling.

As we step back, we can now explore the results of any given conversation and begin noticing if we communicate by hallucinating, assuming, jumping to conclusions, filling in the gaps, or if we ask questions to identify the speaker's messages and inner movie.

- How rich is my client's movie?
- What are the map rules for my client?
- Is there any ambiguity in the words my client uses while processing?
- What parts of their words do not allow me to create a clear representation in my mind?





Meta-model structuring and modelling of experience

As a model the meta-model identifies three central ways that we create our linguistic maps about things. We delete information, we generalise, and we distort. These are mapping or modelling processes. Accordingly, we organise the Meta-model using these three processes.

With deletions in our words and sentences, we seek out to fill in the missing details by asking questions that help us to paint a fuller picture of what the other person is saying.

With generalisations, we seek to explore the rules and conclusions to understand what they are and how they work, and how the person came to create those generalisations (references).

With distortions, we seek to identify and clarify the distortions, by asking questions that facilitate the client checking their mental maps and aligning them with reality.

The meta-levels of language

Structures

- Metaphors – a storied representation of an experience that expands and adds meaning
- Presuppositions – assumptions that must be true for the speaker for their words to make sense
- Multi-ordinality – a word when applied to itself changes the meaning of the word
- Identification – I am X (e.g. a good person)
- Distortion – distorting facts
- Mind-reading – claiming to know another's intentions
- Complex equivalences – this is that (this means that)
- Nominalisations – verbs that have been changed to become nouns (EG. failure)
- Cause-effect – this is because of that (absolute assignment of cause)
- Lost performatives – deleting the performer (they, us, we etc.)
- Personalising – assigning cause in reality toward oneself
- Static words – failing to see process view
- Generalisation – taking one experience and generalising for all experiences
- Universal quantifiers – absolute global statements (Always)
- Modal operators – modes of motivation
- Either/or phrases – framing experience in a black and white way

Evaluative Language

- Deletions - simple
- Deletions - comparative/ superlative (unspecified relations) unspecified referential indices (unspecified nouns & verbs), unspecified processes, adverbs
- Modifying verbs - unspecified processes, adjectives, modifying nouns





Understanding the magic

Questioning the assumptive structure

- Assumptive formats or frames
- Map-territory confusions

Questioning distortions

- Specifying the knowledge source
- Specifying logical level confusions
- Specifying equations
- Specifying causations, syntax, order
- Specifying referents
- Hyphenating

Questioning generalisations

- Challenging the all-ness
- Challenging the rules
- Challenging the one-valued structure
- Challenging the two-valued structure
- Challenging the specificity

Indexing deleted references

- Specifying the what, when, who, where, how, etc.
- Representationally Tracking referents
- Language Sensory-Based

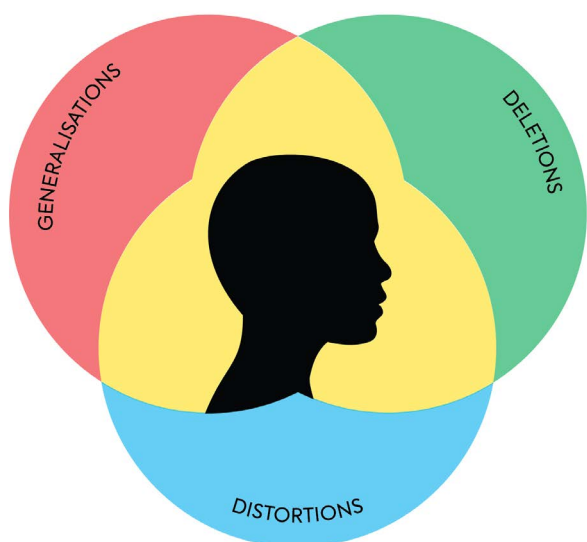
Notes:





The modelling categories of the meta-model

DELETIONS	GENERALISATIONS	DISTORTIONS
Deletion: About whom? About what?	Universal quantifiers: All? always? For everybody? Never? nobody? Is there never an exception?	Cause and effect: How does X lead to Y? Causation terms: makes, forces, Implied causation terms. Present tense verbs
Comparative deletions: Compared to whom? Greater than what?	Modal operators of possibility: Should? Could? Possible	Mind-reading: How specifically do you know X about Y?
Unspecified verbs: How specifically?	Modal operators of necessity: Have to? Must?	Complex equivalence: An external behaviour or action is equated to some internal state. EB = IS
Unspecified nouns: What specifically? Where? When?	Nominalisation: A verb is turned into a noun. Hiding the action in a static form. Can it fit into a wheelbarrow? Put back into process form.	Presuppositions: Linguistic assumptions While, as, when, how What has to be accepted as true to make sense of this? What are you assuming?
Lack of referential index: Who specifically? What specifically?	Lost performatives: Map-maker deleted Over-generalised statement or judgment about life. Says who? When? Under what circumstances?	Delusional verbal splits: How does "mind" work apart from "body?" Isn't it actually a time- space continuum?
	Either/or phrases: Is the situation really either/or? Could it be both/and?	Pseudo-words: What does X term actually refer to? Isn't this term just noise or a spell-mark?
	Over/under defined terms: What does this term mean by way of extension out into the real world? Is this term over-defined in terms of mental intentions?	Personalising/identification: How is it that you are X or Y? Are you not identifying with and personalising?
		Multi-ordinality: At what level are you using this term? What does this nominalisation mean at X level of abstraction?
		Metaphor: How does this X relate to Y? In what contexts doesn't the metaphor work? Expanding the metaphor to include alternative conclusions. Reframing the metaphor contextually



Questions and Effects



Patterns of deletion:

- Leaving features and characteristics out
- Questions are asked to recover details that have been left out
- Specifically, what, when who, how, which etc?

1. Questioning deletions

“They don’t listen to me.”

Who specifically doesn’t listen to you?

“People push me around.”

Who specifically pushes you?

Predict they mean everyone.

Recovers the deletion

Recover the referential index

2. Questioning comparing deletions

“She’s a better person.”

Better than whom?

Better at what?

Compared to whom, Compared to what?

Given what criteria?

Recover the deleted standard, criteria, or belief

3. Questioning nouns and verbs

“I am uncomfortable.”

Uncomfortable in what way?

Uncomfortable when?

Recover specific qualities of the verb

“They don’t listen to me.”

Who specifically doesn’t listen to you?

Who specifically said that?

Recover the nouns of the persons involved.

“He said that she was mean.”

Whom did he say that you call mean?

What did he mean by ‘mean’?

Recover the individual meaning of the term

“People push me around.”

Who specifically pushes you around?

Add details to the map

“I felt really manipulated.”

Manipulated in what way and how?



4. Questioning processes

**“Surprisingly,
my father lied about his drinking.”**

How did you feel surprised about that?

What surprised you about that?

Recovers the process of the person's emotional state

Enriches with details the person's referent

“She slowly started to cry.”

What indicated to you that her starting to cry
occurred in a slow manner?

Enriches with details the person's referent

5 Questioning processes

“I don't like unclear people.”

What specifically were the people unclear
about? Unclear in what way?

Recovers the projection of the speaker's sense of
feeling “unclear” “unhappy”

“The unhappy letter surprised me.”

How, and in what way, did you feel unhappy?

Recovers the projection of the speaker's sense of
feeling “unclear” “unhappy”

Notes:





Patterns of generalisation

- Grouping details together to create a 'class' or 'category' where all subsets are ruled by the same values.
- Questions are asked to challenge rules and beliefs, to discover processes and the identity of a source of information.
- You have to? What would happen if you didn't? Always? Never? Everybody?
- How do you know? Says who?

1. Questioning beliefs (from universal quantifiers)

All-ness, generalisations that exclude exceptions

“She never listens to me.”

Never? She has never so much as listened to you even a little bit?

Recovers details about the extent of a process and counter-examples

2. Questioning rules (from modal operators)

An operational mode one's modus operandi

“I have to take care of her.”

What would happen if you did?
What wouldn't happen if you didn't?

Recovers details of the process, also causes, effects, and outcomes

“I can't tell him the truth.”

What would happen if you did?
What wouldn't happen if you didn't?

Recovers details of the process, also causes, effects, and outcomes

3. Questioning the source of information (from lost performatives and mind reading)

“It's bad to be inconsistent.”

Who evaluates it as bad?
According to what standard?
How do you know to evaluate inconsistency as bad?

Recovers the source of information, specifies conclusions

“You don't like me.”

How do you know I don't like you?
What evidence leads you to believe this?

Recovers the source of information, specifies conclusions





Patterns of distortion

- Experiences that have become limited by other linked and associated meanings. Questions are asked to open new possibilities of meaning-
- How does X lead to Y? How do you equate these things? What are you assuming?
- What are you using to make this comparison? To what degree? Is there nothing in between?

1. Questioning the process (nominalisations)

Processes transformed into static "things."

"Let's improve our communication."

Whose communicating do you mean? How would you like to communicate?

What specific part of our communicating needs improvement?

Recovers the process and the characteristics left out.
Specifies the verb

"I woke up in a shocking state this morning"

How specifically did you feel, think, etc.?

Recovers the process and the characteristics left out.
Specifies the verb

2. Questioning the source of information (from cause = effect statements)

"He makes me angry"

How does his behaviour cause you to respond with angry feelings?

How specifically did you make yourself feel angry about what did/said?

Recovers understanding of a person's point of view, causation, sources, and origins

3. Questioning meanings (from complex equivalents)

"She's always yelling at me, so she can't like me"

How do you equate her yelling as meaning she does not like you?

Can you recall a time when you have yelled at somebody you liked or even loved?

Recovers how the person equates or associates one thing with another

4. Questioning assumptions (from presuppositions)

"If my husband knew how much I suffered, he would not do that"

How do you assume that his intentions would shift if he knew?

Does your husband always use your emotional states to determine his behaviours?

Recovers a person's assumptions, beliefs, and values that he or she does not question.





5. Questioning degree or extent (from either or phrases)

“If I don’t make this job work, I will never be a success”.

So, you have no other alternative except total success or failure?

Recovers the continuum, steps or stages deleted

What steps are there in between?

6. Questioning comparisons (from stories)

“That reminds me of the time when Uncle Jim...”

How does this story relate to the point you want to make?

Recovers the relationship between the story and the person's concepts

Effectiveness is simplicity

SPECIFICITY OF	FORMAL DISTINCTION	QUESTION
Details	Deletions	Specifically, what, when, who, how, which, etc.
Rules	Modal operators	What would happen if you didn't?
Beliefs	Universal quantifiers	Always? never? everybody?
Processes	Nominalisations	How does that work?
Source of Information	Mind-reading, Lost Performatives	How do you know? says who?
Causation	Cause-effect	How does X lead to Y?
Meanings	Complex equivalents and identification	How do you equate these things?
Assumptions	Presuppositions	What are you assuming? What else?
Levels	Multi-ordinality	At what level are you using this term?
Comparisons	Metaphors	What are you using to make this comparison?
Degree/ Extent	Either/or	Is there nothing in between?







Finding and Exposing Psychological “Can’t’s”

Exercise – Activity

1. Complete the following sentence stems with a list of 6 to 12 responses

- “I can’t stand...”
- “What really gets me and rattles my cage is...”
- “I feel most un-resourceful when...”

2. Take turns reading the responses

For example, “I can’t stand it when someone talks to me with a harsh tonality.”

3. Invite group members to respond with appropriate meta-modelling challenges

For example,

- “What stops you from standing the other person’s harsh tonality?”
- “What would happen if you did ‘stand’ that person’s unpleasant tonality?”



Precision Questioning for Empowering States



Exercise – Activity

1. Identify an empowering state

Describe a resource and/or resourceful state that you would like to have or to have more of (e.g. confidence, pose, self-affirmation, enthusiasm, love, energy, etc.). Describe this resource fully.

2. Meta-model the state

As the person offers their map of the resource, Meta-model him or her to invite a richer and fuller map of the experience. Continue until the person confirms that richer map.

3. Anchor the state

As the coach kinaesthetically anchors this resourceful state, ask for an auditory digital term that summarises it "confidence, joy, calmness, etc."

Anchor repeatedly saying the term at the peak of the experience until just the word anchors it.



Visiting the land of nominalisations

Identify the nominalisations in the following statements:

People always push me around.

.....

Nobody pays any attention to anything I say.

.....

I like friendly dogs.

.....

I heard my mother in law yesterday gossiping about the neighbours.

.....

One should always respect the feelings of others.

.....

It's painful for us to see her like this, you know.

.....

Let's not get bogged down in details.

.....

There's a certain feeling in the room.

.....

Everybody feels that way sometimes.

.....



The Well-Formed Outcome Questions (WFO)



To move to a well-formed outcome, we gauge the distance and difference between present state and desired state. Where are we now? Where do we want to go? How can we get there? What stops us? What's in our way? This gives us a clear way to think more about moving away from aversions rather toward desired outcomes. This pattern uses the key components for effectively creating and reaching a desired outcome. In coaching we use this pattern as a reference tool since it allows us to do several important things:

By it we hand over responsibility to the client for his or her own plans and life:

- ✓ We set up milestones to measure and confirm progress
- ✓ We set up a directional frame for coaching
- ✓ We set up a process that gives us and the client a leverage point for change

Criteria for a well-formed outcome:

1. Stated and represented positively:

State what you want, not as what you do not want. Represent what you will be doing and thinking. Create a movie in your mind of life beyond or after the challenge or problem.

2. Sensory-based or empirical:

State it in sensory based terms in the here and now so that your internal movie will be close and immediate. Benchmark the specifics in see-feel-hear actions and behaviours.

3. Contextualised:

Describe the contexts of the outcome, when, where, with whom, how often, etc.

4. Actions steps and stages:

Represent the outcome in terms of processes, the specific steps and stages, and behaviours, which will move you to achieving your goal. Use verbs rather than nouns & nominalisations.

5. Self-initiated and maintained:

Describe the processes and behaviours that are within your own control, which you can initiate & maintain.

6. Resources specified:

Describe the resources you will need to achieve your outcome; how will you do this?

7. Evidence procedure:

Identify any evidence procedure that will let you know when you have achieved your outcome.

8. Compelling:

Describe the outcome in language that you find compelling and motivating. Use the client's actual words and language.

9. Ecologically balanced:

Describe your outcome in a way that you recognise as balanced and ecological for all the contexts and relationships of your life.

10. Forecast in a time frame:

Place in your time-line in your future (see time-lines).



The Well-Formed Outcome Pattern

Exercise – Activity

As you learn these NLP patterns, we recommend that you follow these as written to enable you to embed the learning.

Steps are numbered with an explanation of a high-level outcome. Beneath each step are the phrases or questions to use.

Avoid getting into the content and stick to the context, process and structure of the pattern.

Context = Client does the work = effective results are self-determined

Content = Coach does the work = ineffective results are the result of over-responsibility

1. State the outcome in positive terms

- *Where are you now? (Present state). Where do you want to be? (Desired state).*
- *What do you want to be different in that desired state?*
- *What do you want to positively achieve or experience?*
- *What are you looking to move toward?*

2. Specify the outcome in sensory-based terms

- *What will you see, hear, feel, etc., when you have it?*
- *What steps or stages are involved in reaching this outcome?*
- *Have you used all of your senses in this description?*

3. Identify the contexts of this desired outcome

- *Where, when, how, with whom, etc. will you get this outcome?*
- *In what context or contexts is this outcome appropriate?*
- *What are the most fitting and appropriate contexts for this outcome?*

4. Identify the steps and stages involved in reaching this outcome

- *What are the steps involved in reaching this goal?*
- *What are the stages involved?*
- *Is this goal chunked down into small enough bits so that you feel that each piece is do-able?*
- *Does the size of this outcome seem overwhelming to you at all?*

5. Self-initiated and maintained

- *Is the outcome something that you can initiate yourself and maintain?*
- *Do you have it within your power and ability to reach this goal?*
- *Is it within your control?*
- *Can you initiate the actions to get started?*
- *Can you maintain those actions or is it dependent upon what someone else needs to do?*

6. Identify the resources you will need to achieve this outcome

- *What resources will you need in order to get this outcome?*
- *Who will you have to become?*
- *Who else has achieved this outcome?*
- *Have you ever had or done this before?*
- *Do you know anyone who has?*
- *What prevents you from moving toward it and attaining it now?*





7. Evidence Procedure

- *How will you know that your outcome has been realised?*
- *What will let you know that you have attained that desired state?*
- *How do you know when to exit?*
- *When are you there?*
- *When will you feel satisfied?*

8. Ensure the outcome is compelling and motivating

- *Is the outcome compelling?*
- *Does it energise you?*
- *Will it get you up out of bed in the morning?*
- *How much do you want this?*
- *How much do you feel this is compelling from 0 to 10 if 10 is absolute?*
- *What do you need to do to make it more exciting for you?*
- *What would make this really rock?*

9. Quality Control the Outcome to make sure it is balanced and ecological

- *Is the desired outcome ecological?*
- *What will you gain through it?*
- *What will you lose?*
- *Is it achievable?*
- *Does it respect your health, relationships, etc.?*
- *Are there any parts of you that object to actualising this desired outcome?*

10. Put the outcome on your time-line in your future and try it on

As you imagine a time and place in your future when this will become real to you ... just allow yourself to go there now ... in your mind ... and be there ... fully experiencing it and enjoying it.

... That's right, and as you do just notice what it's like when you reach this goal. Notice how it feels, what things look like, sound like, what your world is like, how you are moving through it.

... and enjoy this... checking it out on the inside to see if this is what you want ... and being aware of how you might want to edit it and make sure that it really fits ...

To wrap up getting a well-formed outcome statement

In meta-coaching, we coach to an outcome. Without an outcome, we have no agenda or 'frame' to coach to and so are doomed to merely having a pleasant conversation, but that's not coaching. To create a meta-coaching session, we have to get an outcome statement from the client.

10. Compelling	Packed with meaning and intention
9. Ecological	Check ecology of the outcome
8. Realistic	Which I evaluate as filling these criteria:
7. Contextualised	In (X) context:
6. Timed	A start, middle and end date
5. Positive	Stated positively
4. Steps/stages	I see, hear, and feel X as I do Y "
3. Self-initiated	Within my power
2. Evidence procedure	KPI stated clearly
1. Sensory-based	VAK Ad



The Power To Get Your Goals & Objectives



Over many years of consulting to organisations and coaching with Executives and Leaders, we found that many organisational objectives, stakeholder KPIs, corporate and strategic plans, are rarely realised in the way that they are envisaged or recorded. Our experience has led us to understand that among the many reasons for this fact, one fundamental ingredient is the absence of well-formedness.

The following model forms part of every coaching session that a Coaching Room Coach delivers – as part of ensuring that we are being as effective as possible with every client we see. The POWER to get your goals and objectives is laid out 5 simple, yet critical steps that give you the fundamental ingredients to a well-formed outcome.

Make your objectives:

POSITIVE – Is it something you want or really need?

OWNERSHIP – Can you initiate and maintain it yourself?

WHAT – What will look & feel like as you start to achieve it?

ECOLOGY – Is the objective healthy and good for you & your people?

RESOURCES – Do you have the resources you need to achieve the objective?

So, take a KPI or objective and quality check it with these 5 questions, to see if you have the power to get it!

Let's take a look at each of these questions in more detail:

POSITIVE:

What do you want or need? State it clearly rather than what you don't want. We cannot get what we don't want! The state of mind must be congruent – I want or I need 'X'

Why do you want it? What will it get you?

OWNERSHIP:

Is it within your own ability to initiate and maintain what it takes to realise this objective? If you need someone else, it is not within your own power. Are you able to do this?





WHAT:

Do you know what it will look, sound, and feel like as you begin to achieve or get the objective? If you don't, how will you know (really know) you have achieved it? Do you have a plan or strategy? How will you monitor your progress?

ECOLOGY:

Is the objective right for you? Is it also right for those involved and that will be affected by the realisation of this objective? Are there any objections?

RESOURCES

Do you already have the resources; time, money, authority, people etc.? Or, are they available to you, to help you realise this objective? If not, the objective may not be realistic.

How did you go? If you can congruently say YES to all 5 questions, then the likelihood is that it is within your own power to get your goal or objective.

If you could not say yes to all 5, it is unlikely that you have the power to get it. So, make a short-term goal of being able to say yes to all 5...

Strategies & Modelling



The strategies model

Definition

A strategy refers to a series of representational steps that moves from some original stimulus to some final response. As such, it gives more detail and richness to the old stimulus-response model. Based upon the TOTE model, the strategies model enriches the TOTE with the representational steps.

Overview of the strategies model

Strategies refer to the specific sequences of representations (both internal and external) that lead to a specific outcome. We discover strategies through elicitation. We discover a person's strategy for a given piece of behaviour by using various elicitation questions. We can then represent the strategy that comprises the skill or experience. All of that then enables us to replicate it, change or redesign it, or utilise it in a new situation.

We speak of strategies in terms of outcomes. This gives us the motivation strategy, the decision strategy, a convincer strategy, learning, selling, parenting, etc.

Using the strategies model

Tracking a neuro-linguistic mind-body system through its sequences enables us to replicate an experience. Doing this presupposes numerous skills. Given that a strategy identifies where the brain goes and how it responds along the way, then in order to produce similar results we have to minimally do the following.

Strategy skills

These skills presuppose that we have developed awareness and sensitivity to the signs and cues, which indicate the operating of a strategy. This means we need to develop high level skills to manage a strategy as we elicit it. This further presupposes other skills: anchoring, reframing, pacing etc. It implies the ability to do comparative analysis between strategies as well. In that way, we can learn to design better strategies.

Strategy unpacking

Unpacking unconscious strategies in order to make them conscious. Of course, when a behaviour has attained the status of a TOTE, its signal level lies below consciousness. This means that we no longer know explicitly the details of each step. This requires much skill and practice in making these unconscious strategies explicit. Typically, even the person displaying the strategy will not consciously know the steps. For this, NLP has developed and focused on the art of calibrating to accessing cues, sensory specific predicates, generic body types, breathing patterns etc.



The T.O.T.E. Model

Based upon the work of Miller, Galanter and Pribram in Plans and the structure of behaviour⁴.

→ test/ compare	→ operate	→ test	→ exit
Set or access criteria for desired state	Access or gather data	Compare/evaluate data in light of the criteria	

The first test: The cue or trigger that initiates the strategy. We use the criteria as we feed forward what we want.

- What lets you know it was time to decide?
- When did you begin deciding?
- How did you know it was time to decide?

The operation: Access the data as we remember, create, gather information required by the strategy.

- How did you know there were alternatives?
- How did you generate alternatives?

The second test: Comparison of some aspect of the accessed data with the criteria.

- How do you evaluate alternatives?
- What has to be satisfied in order for you to decide?

The exit: The decision point where we realise there's a match and exit or there's a mismatch and we recycle back to the operation stage.

- How do you select which alternative to take?
- How do you know that you have decided?

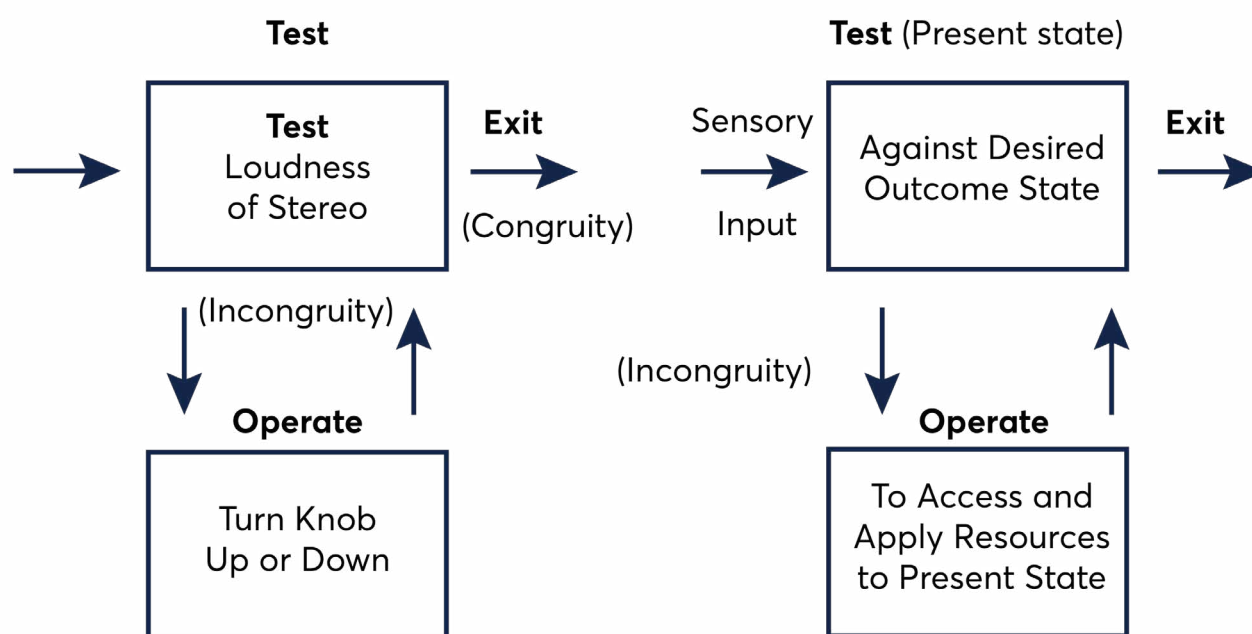
4: Miller, G., Galanter, E., & Pribram, K. (1960). Plans and the structure of behavior . New York: Holt.



Diagram of the TOTE Model



Strategy elicitation



Strategy elicitation

Using an uptime state, access an appropriate state and seek to establish rapport. Set the frame of outcome. Identify a specific referent event: index when, where, with whom, etc. Invite the person to step back onto the experience. Have the person describe the event until they re-experience it in a congruent way that's intense. Amplify and anchor this state using what you know about access cues, breathing, tonal shifts, gestures, etc. Ask basic questions about the state, about how the person knows they are in the state.

Explore the questions of how the person does this strategy.

Once you have a tentative strategy identified, check it to make sure that it makes logical sense, notice loops or recurrent sequence of steps. Use the NLP notational language to specify the strategy.

Use questions that encourage the person to "go inside" and access the experience. We call this a Trans Derivational Search (TDS) as one searches for referents. We all engage in TDS processes in order to make sense of things, deal with stimuli, and to re-create states and experiences. In elicitation, we use the TDS process to assist someone to go back through their constructs of past times in order to recover the structure of the experience.

Meta-states enable us to think about the structuring of mind in terms of levels or layers and our referencing process. As we go in to access our frame-of-reference, the meta-level frame as higher level "thoughts" become more solidified and stable.

The NLP Notational System



Subscripts are used for things that are created, things that are remembered, for tones, for digital information (d), and for internal (i), and external (e).

Additional modifiers for strategy notation will be used later to indicate the kind of response made by a person at various stages.

He may be congruent (>) or go meta (m). Decision points can be notated by a +/- and then an exit (-exit).

With this notational system, we can decode and isolate behaviours. This allows us to change and/or install new skills and behaviours.

REPRESENTATIONAL SYSTEMS	SUPERSCRIPTS	SUBSCRIPTS (AUDITORY ONLY)
V Visual: pictures	r remembered	
A Auditory: sounds	c constructed	d digital - t tonal
K Kinaesthetic: feelings, Sensations		
O Olfactory: smells	i internal	
G Gustatory: tastes	e external	

Syntactic Symbols

- Leads to
- / Comparison
- X Synaesthesia
- m Meta
- Simultaneous but not interfering

Spelling TOTE

Ae→ Vc→	/Vr → Ki+ or or Ki-	→ Exit
(hear sound of word and construct visual IR)	test against a visual remembered image of the word If it feels wrong, loop back to recall another visual image	sense that it feels right or that it feels wrong



Strategy Elicitation Patterns



Exercise – Activity

Suppose you wanted the recipe for a delicious dish. What do you need in order to create that delicious dish? You would need specific information about the elements to use, the amounts, the order for mixing them together, temperature, etc. The same kind of thing holds with regard to detecting and using the structure of subjective experiences to create an experience of excellence.

The Basic Pattern

1. Begin by establishing a positive frame for rapport. (Begin tracking representational systems (e.g., they begin talking and eyes go upper left (Vr + etc..))

1. Elicit state; you do that very well! Would you mind teaching me how to do that?
2. Model; suppose I lived your life for a day, how would I do this?

2. Access the state

Is the person fully and congruently associated in the skill or state? This is critical- (to fully elicit the strategy, you will need to take the person back to the place where the behaviour naturally occurs) to elicit the state?

Ask client; as you begin to do this activity, what are you first aware of? Then what?

3. Intensify the state

Check in; how much do you have? 0/10?

What will best amplify and intensify this state if necessary?

[The more of the state you evoke, the more of the experience you will have to work with]

4. Explore the how

- How do you do this?
- What are you consciously aware of?
- What are you doing intuitively in your body? [Look for the person to demonstrate it.]
- How do you carry out this task?
- What did (does) it feel like?
- How did you do it? How are you doing it?
- When do you feel best able to do it? What do you need in order to do it?
- What happens as you do it? When did that last occur?



5. Calibrate from an uptime state

As coach; Are you fully alert and open to the person's external cues while he or she is accessing?

What are you calibrating to in the state and experience of the person?

How does he or she change in the process of going into state?

Do you have clear signals of the person in state?

What does the person demonstrate?

[We all demonstrate as we talk about experiences, problems, outcomes, etc. Be attentive to such "instant replays" to note how a person cycles through the sequence of representations that leads to the experience.]

6. Ask the person to exaggerate

Now that you are experiencing that strategy, feel free to exaggerate any portion of it that seems important to you. How is that?

What comes up for you as you do this? What does it lead to?

7. Note the structure above the content

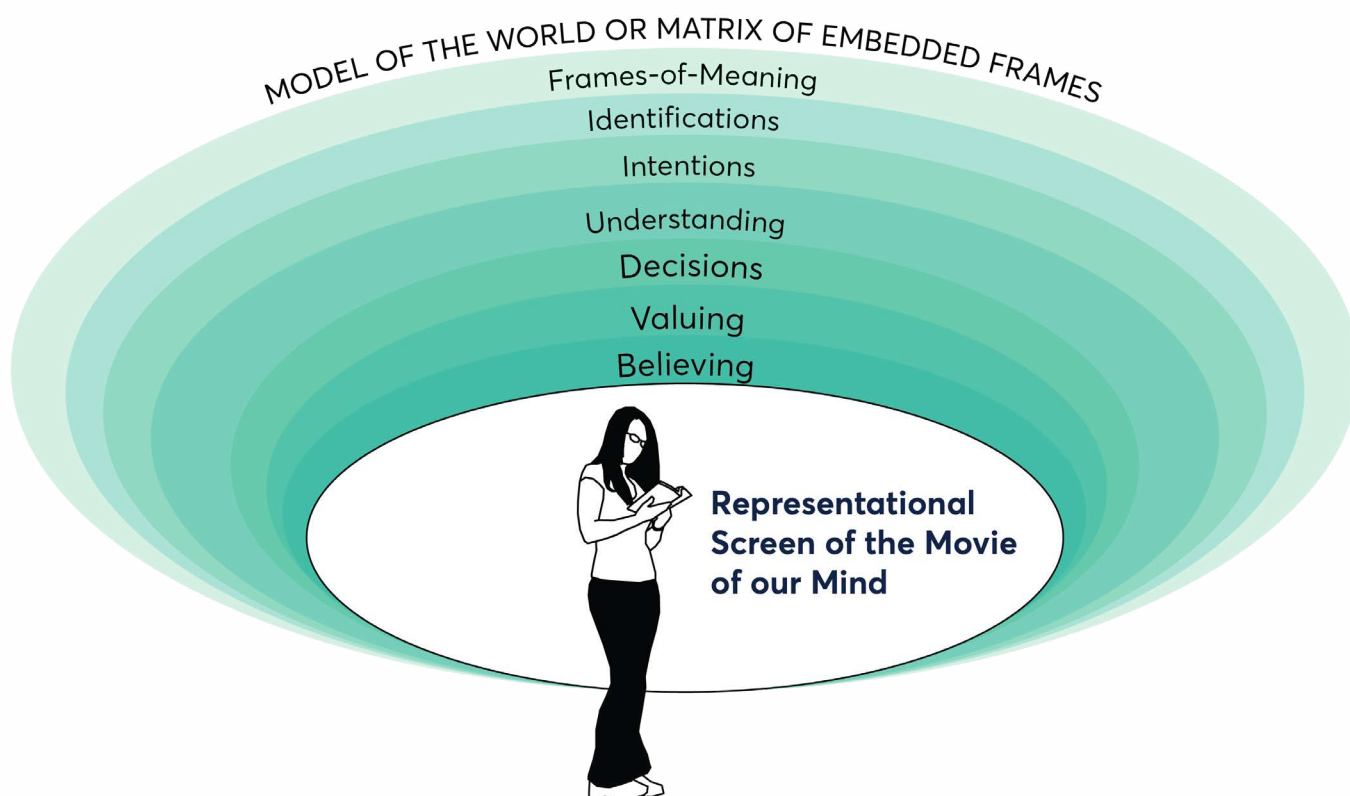
As you begin to notice the strategies, what is the formal structure of the experience?

What are the representational steps?

Track them here:



Matrix of Embedded Frames Diagram



Strategy Activities



Motivation strategies

1. Identify something that you are highly motivated to do and something you wish you were highly motivated to do.

2. Elicit the strategy of both the high and low motivation.

3. What's the difference?

Decision strategies

1. Identify a medium level decision that you have made recently.

2. Elicit this strategy from your partner in terms of representational steps that led to the decision.

3. Compare this to a major purchase or decision.



Learning strategies

1. Identify a time when you learned something with ease and lots of good feelings.

2. Elicit the strategy.

3. Compare that strategy to when you learned something but did not have fun and did not find it easy.

Influencing strategies

1. Identify an experience from someone who successfully communicated with someone and influenced that person in a significant way.

2. Gain rapport and spend time eliciting the strategy.

3. Using the notational system, write out the strategy as fully as you have elicited it.

4. Design a strategy of influence that you want to install in yourself.





Love strategies

- How do you know when you feel loved?
- What lets you know that you are valued, respected, and adored?
- What has to be present in order for you to experience the state of love?

Our strategies for love seem to have a special condition, namely, that most of us have a preferred representation system and we experience it as a synaesthesia. That is, as see+feel; hear+feel; feel+feel. So, as you explore, you will discover that you probably like stimuli in all sensory systems, and yet what absolutely and without question has to be there in order to feel love?

Eliciting a love strategy

1. Access a referent experience and elicit the state of being convinced of being loved

When have you absolutely felt loved? By whom? When and where?

2. Explore the stimuli that elicit the feelings

- *What best elicits this feeling?*
- *How do you know? What lets you know?*
- *Visual: Is it what you see in the other?*
- *Is it a countenance, smile, appearance, etc.?*
- *Auditory: Is it what you hear?*
- *The tone of the voice, the words said, some special way in which it is said?*
- *Kinaesthetic: Is it what you feel?*
- *How you are touched, embraced? When and where?*
- *The kind or pressure of a hug? A kiss?*
- *While there are many things that add to the experience, what could you not do without?*

3. Identify the variables that are absolutely necessary

- *What has to be there? What is absolutely required?*



The S.C.O.R.E. Model

Exercise – Activity

The SCORE model provides a way to consider many of the basic components that go into effective problem solving and enables us to sort out and organise data. The letters of SCORE stand for Symptoms, Causes, Outcomes, Resources, and Effects. Robert Dilts developed the SCORE model as an NLP tool for working effectively in moving from present state to some desired state. As such, it offers the most basic NLP pattern for working with subjectivity. SCORE describes an overall meta-pattern for thinking about present state, desired state, and bridging from one to the other with resources.

1. Gather information using the SCORE model

Symptoms:

The problems that are typically most on our mind. The most noticeable and conscious aspects of a situation or problem.

- What surface and presenting symptoms do I notice?
- What other symptoms may I not have attended to?
- What about long-term symptoms? How do I represent these symptoms?
- What meanings do I attribute to them?

Causes:

Those representations and beliefs that bring a situation or problem into existence. The cause is not an experience, but our interpretations of what the experience means to us.

- What causes this situation?
- We usually experience these as less obvious and more hidden.
- What underlying causes could possibly explain this?
- Is this factor only contributing to a situation, but not actually causing it?
- What contributing factors also play into this?
- What about other contributing factors that I may not have paid much attention to?





Outcomes:

The end or goal we have in mind, which also plays a contributing role in as much as in the system of human consciousness outcomes feed-forward information.

- What direction have I put myself in?
- What orientation effects the current situation?
- If I continue on this path, where will it take me?'
- What other outcomes may arise from those outcomes?
- What final outcome state do I want to move toward?

Resources:

Those factors and components of thought, emotion, memory, imagination, etc. by which we create our representations, meanings, beliefs, behaviours, etc.

- What personal resources do you have in your representations and language?
- What resources do I need to move from this present state to my desired state?

Effects:

The results or consequences of applying our resources to the situation.

- What happens when I think this way? Feel this way?
- Speak or act in this or that fashion?
- Does the response I get fit with the outcome I want?
- Should I stop doing what doesn't work and try something else (the resource of flexibility)?

2. Use SCORE to format and structure your overview of the situation and to guide your decisions and actions.

- Do you have clarity about your outcome?
- Do you have access to sufficient resources?
- What other information do you need to gather?
- Where do you stand in the overall picture of current situation resources moving you to desired outcome?

	Present State →		Desired State	
Causes>	Symptoms → of Present State	Resources → needed to move to →	Outcomes → Desired Goals & Objectives	Effects or Consequences





Score questions:

- What do you think about this?
- What do you want to get from this?
- How will you use it?
- How will you obtain it?
- What do you need to do to take the next step in obtaining it? (Resources)
- What has stopped you? (Symptoms)
- How will you need to work with a decision-making body? (System)
- What cultural issues and problems will you need to address? (Environment)
- What criteria will you use to choose an external solution or supplier? (Criteria/values) What will happen if you decide to bring in an unfamiliar element? (Evidence)
- How will you know that this product might be the answer? (Evidence-procedure)
- What will you obtain from getting that?
- What's going on in this company that must be addressed or hasn't been looked at?
- Would you consider that a solution or a problem?

S	
C	
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The SCORE Dance



Created by Robert Dilts

1. Elicit and spatially anchor the five states of SCORE

- What is the symptom or symptoms?
- Given this symptom, when you step back what are the causes and contributing influences?
- What do you want? What is your desired outcome?
- When you achieve that outcome, what will that give you?
- And when you get that, what will be the next result from it?
- If you go to that outcome of the future and turn around, what are the key success factors that enable you to achieve the outcome?

2. Fully access and anchor each of the SCORE states and positions

- How much do you feel this symptom?
- How much passion and desire do you feel about reaching this outcome?
- What do you sense about the cause of the symptom?
- What is the feeling of the resources?

3. Elicit a mentor for each state

- Who do you know that can serve as a mentor for symptom, cause, outcome, effect, and resources?
- What imaginary mentor can you create in your mind?
- When you are in the present state (symptom), who do you know that could mentor you?
- Who could mentor you while you are in the position of the cause? Etc.

4. Step into each mentor and transfer that information back to your SCORE states

- What is it like now as you bring the feeling and information of the mentor for your symptom position back to your symptom state?
- Repeat for each.

5. Rehearse through SCORE and mentors several times

- What's going on for you as you dance through, quicker and quicker, these states?
- As you now complete the fifth time through, what's happened to the initial problem?



TIME-LINES



The Time-Lines Model



"Time" – the great nominalisation. You have never walked out of your front door and stumbled over a hunk of "time." You couldn't if you wanted to. "Time" doesn't exist "out there" in the world. To have "time" we have to have a human mind that can reflect onto itself.

- "I disagree! I could trip over a grandfather clock, or a sundial."

Yes, that's true, you could. Yet you still would not have tripped over "time." You would have tripped over some device that we use to mark and measure the movement of activities. And, of course, that's what occurs "out there" in the world activity. We live in a world of happenings. We live in a process universe where things constantly change. At different rates of speed, everything is in a process of change. At the sub-atomic level, the quantum level (a level that our nervous system cannot detect), the world is but a "dance of electrons."

When we notice this and begin to compare and measure one set of activities up against another set of activities, we invent the concept of "time." Traditionally, we have used the rotation of the earth ("day" and "night") and the orbit of the earth around the sun (a "year") to establish the standard that we use to measure "time." Over the centuries we have refined our "time" measuring devices as we have invented 24 "hours" in a "day" and 60 "minutes" in an hour and 60 "seconds" in a minute, etc. None of this is exactly precise, which is why we had to invent "leap" years, but it has given us a fairly common standard for computing the relationship between events.

- "How fast can he run a mile?"
- "He can run right at a 4-minute mile."
- "How long will it take you to finish that report?"
- "I need some of your time, could you spare 15 minutes for me?"
- "When can I schedule you in for our next appointment?"

Ah, time! While it seems so real, it is at best only a human concept. It is a social reality that we have constructed. Now, as a shared reality that we all participate in and assume, it seems to dominate our lives. We can even develop a bad relationship to this concept. Imagine that one! A person can develop negative attitudes, thoughts, and feelings to the idea of "time," scheduling, being on time, having time for this or that, etc. Ah, the higher dimensions of the mind, the dimensions of Neuro-Semantics.



Advanced “time” awareness

In Michael Hall's book; Time Lining: Adventures in Time⁵ (1998), he identified many different kinds and levels of “time.” Michael extended the classic NLP use of time-lines that Richard Bandler invented, and that Steve and Connirae Andreas further developed and extended; and that showed up for the first time in NLP literature in the book by Tad James and Wyatt Woodsmall Time Line Therapy⁶ (1998).

Revisiting the work of Edward Hall, Alfred Korzybski, and current theorists on time, Michael extended the NLP idea of “time” to first of all recognise “time” as involving not primary state processes, but meta or higher levels of awareness. That makes all time-line processes and patterns meta-states.

Here we will first explore the NLP model about “time” and then into the next step of the neuro-semantics of time as meta-frames. This leads to many new patterns, new ways of thinking about “time,” new distinctions about the many kinds of time, and more mastery over this central concept in human consciousness. As a meta-class of life, a symbolic class of life, we are the kind of creatures who engage in mental-time travel as we move back and forth between our memories of the past, our sense of the present, and our imaginations of the future.

The meaning of time-lines

We humans uniquely have the transcendent ability to sort for “time.” If we couldn't sort for awareness of time we couldn't tell how to get anywhere for a meeting. How we particularly sort for “time” uniquely distinguishes us. Most of us have some sort of line as we code and distinguish the difference between past, present, and future. This leads to the idea of a time-line(s). There are some however who use other configurations. The following pattern offers a way to elicit and understand how we code time. Because most of us store time in a linear way, we end up creating time-lines. Yet the location of these lines, their size, colour, organisation, etc. can make a lot of difference in our everyday experiences.

Time-lines gives us a description about how we encode time. At best, our time-lines provide us but a blueprint or map of things, a representation, not reality. Time is basic to our organising of our experiences and our definitions of reality. Without your ability to process time in some way you'd have no awareness (consciousness) of causality.

Our time-lines crucially effect and determine a good deal about our personalities. They do because we use our past memories and our future hopes to determine how we relate to the world, to ourselves, to others, etc. As you code time in your heart so you are. Character and personality in-part arises from our own time coding.

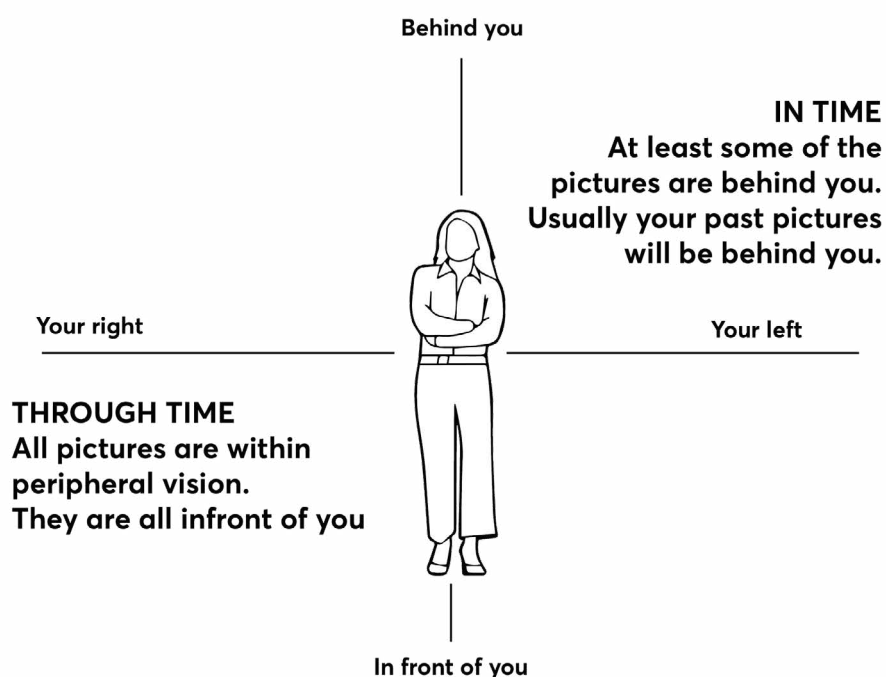
As you elicit time-lines in people, especially listen for temporal words as well as temporal metaphors. Do you know someone who “always lives in the past?” Or someone who “only thinks about the future and never takes time to stop and smell the roses today?” Or someone who lives only for today?”

5: Hall, L. M. & Bodenhamer, B. G. (1998) TIME-LINING, Adventures in Time. Advanced Patterns for Adventuring in Time. Crown House Publications.

6: James, T., & Woodsmall, W. (2017). Time line therapy: And the basis of personality. Crown House Publishing Ltd.



Eliciting the Encoding of “Time”



Sometimes the problem we struggle with does not concern anything in today's reality, but something that occurred in "the past." Thus, the problem exists about how we keep our thoughts and feelings from the past in our current awareness.

1. Identify a referent: some simple activity you regularly do

What do you do on a regular (daily) basis that's small, simple and not attached with a lot of emotion?

Menu: driving to work, brushing your teeth, dressing, combing your hair etc. Remember doing this five years ago.

Recall it two years ago, then last week. Think about doing it this morning

Consider doing it next week, then two years from now, five years from now.

2. Notice how you have encoded your awareness of time

How are you aware of this activity?



What do you see, hear, or sense in your body that allows you to distinguish past, present, and future? What are the sensory factors?

How do you naturally edit these representations? What are the sub-modality qualities?

Where in space do you locate them? How big or small? What is the size of "today," "a week," "month," "year?"

- Notice your pictures or images:
- In colour or black-and-white
- A movie or still picture
- 3D or flat
- See your younger/older self or looking out from your eyes
- Framed or panoramic
- Bright or dim
- Close or far
- In focus or blurred
- Location of picture in field of vision

3. Step back and identify the overall configuration

Does your time structure look like a line, a boomerang, a spiral, etc.? Do you have some metaphor for it: a filing cabinet, a calendar etc.? Do you have more than one time-line or time-configuration?

How many? For what areas of life (business, personal, recreational, spiritual, etc.)?

4. Spatial sorting of the time zones

How do you distinguish the time zones?

How do you tell the difference of events of the past, present, and future? Where in space do you sort out your memories of the past, your sense of the present, and your imaginations of the future?





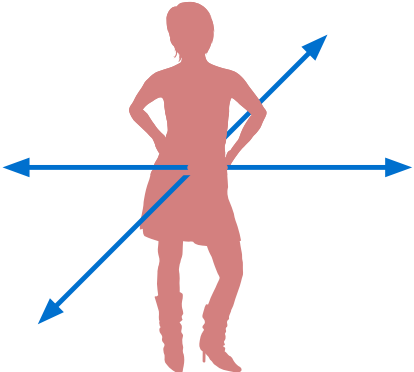
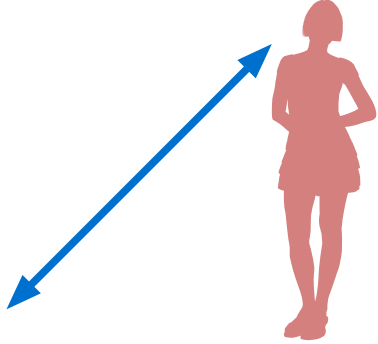
Debriefing about time lines

In time-lines, the location of our images and pictures serves as one of the most crucial factors. We typically store our concept of time sequentially and linearly. Colour versus black-and-white, frame versus panoramic, etc. are distinctions that do not allow us to make variations along a continuum. Yet we need variation to encode a sequence of events so that we can note relationships between events. That's why our brains typically use analogue sub-modalities for encoding these variations. Location is an analogue distinction that permits us to distinguish sequential events that occur one after another.

We typically use size, distance, and location of pictures and images to represent our concepts of time. This enables us to store time in various places around, behind, before, above, and below us (various locations at varying distances). If we step back to get an image of the overall configuration of this time representation, we usually have a line, shape of some sort, picture, etc. Thus, the origin of the term, time-line.

The coding/structure of time enables us to tell the difference between events past, present, or future. It affects our personality in major ways since it affects our sense of cause-effect, order, structure, etc.

People in different cultures operate from different concepts of time. In the field of NLP, we speak about this using the following distinctions as concepts. From these we have developed numerous patterns.

In-Time orientation 	Being able to get lost in time by forgetting to notice "time." A primary state experience that "loses one's mind" about time and comes to one's senses and exists so much "in the moment" that time vanishes. A great orientation for love making, flow experiences, exercising, watching a movie, going on vacation. A terrible orientation for attending classes at university, keeping appointments, catching trains, etc.
Through-Time orientation 	Being able to intuitively know what time it is, to sequence and order oneself over the space of time, to order and sequence activities effectively. This state of mind effectively structures one's sense of "what time it is" in relationship to activities, and cares about time, and loves (values) being "on time." A great orientation for business, school, military, etc.

Time sequencing that is random-in-time (e.g. Fiji-time). Caring more about what happens during time, than the comparison and awareness of time itself.

Time sequencing that is sequential-in-time (e.g. Military time). Caring more about noting and ordering events rather than perhaps the quality of the happenings in that time.





Orientation to time

PAST	PRESENT	FUTURE
Memories	Sensory awareness	Possibilities/plans
Solid/real	Flexible	Anticipation
Fixed, rigid, stuck	Some fixedness	Primarily movement
Limited	Choice	Opportunities/expansive
Predestination	Responsibility	Visions/dreams
Consequential	Impulsivity thinking	Anticipatory thinking
Already	Now	Then, one of these days
Sense of reality	Sense of today; the now	Sense of hope/desire

Time styles

Out of time	In time	A-temporal
Dissociated	Associated	Timelessness
Out of the body	In/through the body	Above the body
Sequential	Random, simultaneous, synthetic	Meta-position
Values and likes time	Dis-values and dislikes time	Neutral to time
On time; punctual	Frequently late, non- prompt	
Aware of time	Lost in the now, the moment, the memory	



Time-line Awareness Pattern



As you learn these NLP patterns, we recommend that you follow these as written to enable you to embed the learning.

Steps are numbered with an explanation of a high-level outcome. Beneath each step are the phrases or questions to use.

Avoid getting into the content and stick to the context, process and structure of the pattern.

Context = Client does the work = effective results are self-determined

Content = Coach does the work = ineffective results are the result of over-responsibility

1. Identify your time-line or lines

Having elicited your representations for time past, present and future via the metaphor of a line, now imagine floating above it and looking down upon it.

2. Float back in time along the time-line

As you do, notice the you of your past.

3. Now go forward in time

Observing both the events you represent and how you represent those events, remembered or imagined.

4. What time problems did you notice that you would like to address?

What events exercise too much importance? What events carry too little impact? How encoded? Black areas, pits, turns, twists, etc.

5. How might you like to alter your time-line?

Identify some of the things you might like to change about the events on your time-line: shape, configuration, tilt, colour, etc.

6. Re-edit the representations

Notice the editorial frames (or sub-modalities) and change the properties of the situation, i.e., distance, size, brightness, etc.

Notes:

Time-lines (as meta-states)



How do the time-line processes work and why?

Time-line processes work in part due to the effective power of stepping back from a painful state. As we learn to go Meta to our; negative emotions, concepts of time, poor decisions, inadequate generalisations, etc., we obtain distance from them so that we can recognise them as maps. This enables us to gain perspective to our immediate thoughts-and-feelings. It empowers us to think clearer and with more objectivity. It enables us to bring other resourceful understandings to bear on our states. This stepping back also enables us to know ourselves as more than our experiences in "time."

Time-line processes work by means of our representation of location. As we have encoded time symbolically by using the symbol of "location" so that "the past" is behind us and the "future" is in front of us, when we change this structure, other things change.

Psychologically, our emotions involve "time" for us to express and to create meanings. When we go before (a temporal predicate) an event (the context in which we create some un-enhancing map), it becomes impossible to compute from that empty representation any belief that would generate the negative emotion.

Our brain-body system does not distinguish between information imagined vividly and actual experience. When we send messages to our brain using time-line processes, our brain only knows to represent such so that the body then experiences it. This actualises the thoughts as internally and subjectively real. That's why you can just vividly imagine eating a lemon ... and find your mouth watering or why just imagining someone scraping a fingernail down a blackboard and scratching it causes our skin to cringe.

When we apply the idea of time to our states, we are working with a meta-state awareness. By stepping back from ourselves and learning how to just witness our; experiences, emotions, and life, we observe without judgment enabling us to accept ourselves and to create a crucible whereby we can more clearly evaluate the beliefs, generalisations, and frames that we have created from those experiences. This is the magic and power of using the metaphor of time as a line.

Similarly, when we imagine floating above and before an event, we cue our neurology to cease experiencing the old emotion derived from the event. We've changed the context of the frame. By so out-framing the old experience, our emotions transform. From that frame of reference, the event in time has not yet occurred and so does not exist. This interrupts the mind-body system so that it does not create the emotion in the first place.



Basic time-line pattern – the kinaesthetic time-line

Typically, we visualise our time-lines, yet we can also externalise our time-line to work with it kinaesthetically. For those who don't prefer the visual system, this is especially valuable since it helps those who do not easily make internal pictures. Experiences that we store "out" of time can sometimes become represented as if they continue always to happen in an ongoing manner. Even though those events have already occurred, and we consider them "over" for us, we code and represent them in such a way as to cue our brains that those events continue with us as our ever-present reality. And, if we experienced those events as traumatic in the first place, this way of coding can create continual and/or even cumulative hurt in an ongoing fashion. To deal with representations of previous experiences we must recode them in more neutral and less compelling ways, and then reinsert them into our time-line. This can create a positive resource.

As you learn these NLP patterns, we recommend that you follow these as written to enable you to embed the learning.

Steps are numbered with an explanation of a high-level outcome. Beneath each step are the phrases or questions to use.

Avoid getting into the content and stick to the context, process and structure of the pattern.

Context = Client does the work = effective results are self-determined

Content = Coach does the work = ineffective results are the result of over-responsibility

1. Lay your time-line on the floor

"Stand up and allow yourself to turn appropriately and to point in the direction of your past... In which direction does it feel or seem to you that the past lies in? Point to it. Now point to your future ... Now let's mark this out by walking back to last month, last year, five years ago."

Walk with the person to his or her past and then future (use markers on the floor).

2. Identify the configuration of the time-line

"Walk through your present, past, and future. Good. Now step aside from your time-line on the floor and simply notice its configuration, size, etc. As you take this meta-position by stepping aside from the line, just notice how your sense of time feels to you."

3. Identify a behaviour that you want to change

"Notice the kinaesthetic feelings associated with that undesired behaviour. And begin to just feel that problematic behaviour. When you feel ready, amplify it. I want you to recognise this feeling and allow yourself to go back in time to when you first had this feeling."

[Anchor the problematic behaviour]

4. Step back in small steps to where you had that same kinaesthetic sensation previously

Use the anchor to assist the person backward in time, noticing and anchoring it again each time it arises.

"With more small steps, go back even further, " "How old do you now feel or sense yourself?"

"Do the kinaesthetic sensations diminish or intensify as you take this step backward?"

Invite the person to go all the way back to the point where the kinaesthetic feelings first began. At each of the kinaesthetic spots have the person identify his/her age. Take another step backward.





5. After moving all the way back to earliest experience of the kinaesthetic feeling, invite a meta-position

"I want you to step off the time-line now, to this meta-position..."

"Where did you first experience those sensations? When did that occur? What do you need to go through life and time and to feel different about yourself? What do you need so that you do not need to re-experience life as you did?"

Specifically index the old trauma feelings: where, when, and how to bring into consciousness facets the person may not be aware of.

- *"Do you have these resources now?"*

If not, assist the person to find references for those resources from others by imagination (construction) or by putting together bits and pieces of history. Access as many resources as the person needs until you get a yes.

- *"Does this supply all that you need to effectively handle the (those) event?"*

6. Anchor resources as they arise and stack them

From the meta-position anchor the resources and bring the person up to the present. Reframe limiting meanings that emerge. If the person says that some event made them a "failure," validate and reframe it as an experience of learning. Assist using NLP patterns for updating the meanings using conversational reframes to give new meaning.

- *"While you have found this very painful and upsetting (pacing), you can begin to realise that this has also taught you something very important in life to avoid."*

7. Viewing the younger self from several positions

Assist the person to gain new and different information from different perspectives. This typically shakes one out of a limiting tunnel-vision while simultaneously building up a new and more expansive perspective. Gather up needed resources.

"When ready, step back onto the time-line. Step onto the time-line where the first instance of the undesired behaviour occurred."

"I want you to quickly walk up through "time" on your time-line taking all your resources with you. Do this quickly!"
[As you say this, and they begin to move, fire the resource anchors on their elbow and walk with them as you take them up the line to the present.]

8. Zoom up to the present and stop

Depending upon the emotional experience of the experiencer, give the person a moment to process things.

"Now let all of these learning's and experiences integrate fully into a new sense of yourself, into feeling so much more resourceful. Turn around when you feel ready and face your old past."

"As you look back on your past, notice how things have changed and become different and will continue to become different, now and into the future, providing you new ways of thinking and feeling about it." [Let that perspective integrate.]

9. Facing the future with a new hope

"Now turn around to face your future in a new and empowering way. As you now look at your future, notice how the future too has become different, how it has become brighter and more hopeful, and you can wonder just how much brighter it will become ... What changes do you now notice in your time-line itself? How will this assist you as you move into your future?"







Changing your Time-line

Would you like to change your time-line or lines? Since our time-lines simply exist in our mind-body as a coding of the concept, the process of changing these internal representations of "time" can occur relatively simply. But ... a warning, when you change your time-line, you may initially experience disorientation, even feel dizzy, "strange," "weird," etc.

There are no right or wrong time-lines; there are only useful and un-useful time-lines. Our ability to know if we have already paid our taxes or not also arises from how we mentally organise time. How do you encode memories of the past or future? How do you store this kind of information in your brain? Do you like how you experience your time- lines? Are they useful? Do they help you to sort things out, enable you to enjoy experiences, to move with confidence and resourcefulness into your future? If not, then you might want to make some alterations in it. It's a human construction, so it can be transformed.

Changing a through time orientation:

1. Float up above your time-line

From there straighten your line so it runs left to right. Then, rotate your time-line ninety degrees (or rotate yourself ninety degrees)

2. Then drop down into your time-line

Do so with the realisation and feeling that you now have your "past" behind you. And as you let yourself represent your "past" as behind your head, you can open your eyes to see the "present" directly in front of your face while the future seems at arm's length or further in front of your face. Take a moment with this ... How does it feel?

Changing an in-time orientation:

1. Float up above time

Straighten your time-line and then rotate your line ninety degrees (or rotate your body ninety degrees).

2. Drop behind your time-line

Do this so that everything lies directly in front of you. Make the images about six inches to one-foot square and place past images an arm's length to your left (if right handed). Notice that your future has moved to the other side. The present goes directly in front of your face about a foot out. Imagine the tops of all three images to stand at eye level. You have now taken on the coding of an ideal Through-Time person. Take a moment with this

... How does this feel?

Some people experience profound changes as they do this exercise. Others experience few changes. A few people will lack the ability to do this on their own and will need assistance from someone trained in working with time-line processes. You may wish to leave your time-line in its opposite position for a while just to experiment with it. But avoid driving when you first try on a different time-line. When you feel ready to put your time-line coding back, float up again and reverse the adjustments you made.





Change personal history

Because the "past" only exists in our mind and does not exist externally in the world "out there," it has no real existence part from our mental and linguistic reality. The actual events and happenings have passed on. Yet we can keep our memory of those events inside us - in our mind and body. When we do, what we call the "past" is our memory of those past occurrences.

Nor do such memories stay put. They continually change as they are subject to the effect of ongoing experiences and changes. With every new learning, feeling, experience, etc., how we "look back on," and remember things changes. That's because the very process of thinking, remembering, recalling, etc. is a dynamic process and hence, a new event.

Remembering inside of the human neuro-linguistic system is not the same as looking at old photo albums, handling old pictures and memorabilia. Those "things" stay the same (well, okay, they also are decaying, fading, changing, but at a very slow rate). This is very different to the act of; remembering, of using our brain, higher cortex, meanings, beliefs, etc. to recall and recount prior events. We are forever interfering with our memories and so even the "past" we remember never stays the same. With each revisit to it, we change it. Every new understanding, development, learning, and experience we revise and therefore update our memories. Since our memory only exists as a construction. So as Richard Bandler says, **"It is never too late to have a happy childhood."**

All of this makes the dynamic processes of remembering very personal. What we remember, why we remember, and how we use our memories is our responsibility. Some people believe that they must keep "accurate" accounts of their past. They believe that accuracy of what happened is more important than the effect of such hurtful and traumatising memories on current day states.

We believe that just because something really did happen - that in itself is no reason to keep defaulting to it and using it as a reference. To use the most hurtful, ugly, and traumatising memories as our frames of reference only disempowers us. Doing so means we will keep cuing our mind-body system to "live in the past," re-live the hurt, and to keep re-accessing negative emotional states. When we do this, we create ongoing hurt and disempowerment. This is not a wise way to run our brain.

Instead of mis-using our ability to detect, recognise, and encode time in that way, we can set other frames with more empowering beliefs. We can learn to use our "past" for learning and feedback, rather than for state induction of fear and dread. We can indeed change our personal histories.

This NLP pattern offers a way to recode the "past" so that it no longer serves as a reference for destructive feelings or for defining self in negative ways. It recodes memories as resources and learning's and becomes an enhancing orientation for moving into the future with a positive attitude. The process finds a problem memory, traces it to its source, reframes it with resources and then brings that resource state up to the present and into the future.



The Change Personal History Pattern

Exercise – Activity

Use this pattern to recode your "past" so that it no longer serves as a reference for feeling bad or for defining yourself in a negative way.

1. Access problematic memory

"Do you have any memory of the past that you find problematic or unwanted?"

"Do you have any memories that still have strong unpleasant feelings associated with it?" "Get the memory, nod when it begins to feel bad. I will establish an anchor for this state."

2. Searching back through time for original events

"Now as you feel this [fire the anchor], I want you to go back ... in your past from today ... and allow the next time you felt something like this to come to mind. [Anchoring a trans-derivational search.] Let me know by nodding when you have found another instance of this feeling [fire anchor.] [Continue to calibrate person's experiencing the negative state.]

"What is your age as you're experiencing this?"

3. Continue the search backwards through time

"Now float back again to the next time you feel something like this feeling ... letting me know by nodding and letting me know your age again." [Keep using the anchor as you invite the person to go back to find 3 to 6 isomorphic experiences of this same negative state.]

4. Break state

"Good. Now I want you to return to the present, to this moment with me."

"What resources would you have needed in those past situations that would have allowed you to have been more effective and empowered?"

[Menu: assertive, confident, loved, self-esteem, proactive, set boundaries, etc.] Elicit and anchor each resource state.

- "Do you know how to access confidence? When were you most confident?"

5. Collapse anchor

"I want you to now return to the oldest experience you recalled ... good ... and as you do, I want you to feel this [fire resource anchor and then the anchor for the negative state, then release the negative anchor, while maintaining the positive anchor]. What is that memory like now when you know you have this resource with you? How would this resource make your past different?" [Repeat this process inviting the person to move through personal history, stopping at each instance with the resource anchor.] "And notice how your history changes when you feel this."

[Trouble-shooting: If the person has difficulty changing a past experience, return to the present and more fully elicit and anchor additional resources. The strength of the resources leverages the transformations.]

6. Break state and then test

After changing the past experiences, break state.

"Now I want you to just think about that problematic feeling and notice what happens. How have your memories changed? In what way?"

7. Future pace

"Now imagine moving into your future feeling these resources ..." "Do you like that? Would that enhance your life?"



Change Personal History Using Meta-States



The following adaptation of this pattern re-states it using the Meta-States Model. This pattern allows us to use our memories as resources for moving into the future with a positive attitude and faith.

1. Identify the problem event

This will serve as the primary state. "Think about a time and place in your history that still troubles you... How does it trouble you? What problem does it create for you? When you step into that memory, what emotion arises? What meanings?"

"Now step out of that problem state."

2. Take an observer's viewpoint of that experience

"To take a meta-state to the primary state, float above your time-line and go back to the problem event to observe it as a witness. From this meta-position, see that younger you going through that event." (If you have difficulty staying out of the experience, put your representations up on an imaginary screen.)

3. Gather learning's about the event from the observer position

[This allows you to move into another meta-state about the primary learning about the event.] "What resources did that younger you need? What resources did the others in the situation need? Have you identified the resources needed that would have changed it?"

4. Return to the present and fully access the resources

"From the position of the here-and-now, access and anchor each and every needed resource. Amplify these and then test your anchors for the resources."

5. From the observer meta-position, transfer the resources

"When you have returned to the past event, give that younger you each resource as a gift from your present self. Then let the event play out with the resources. Imagine the younger you now acting, thinking, feeling, etc. in a transformed way. From this position, you can also give the others in the movie the resources that they needed."

6. Come forward through your history with the added resources

"Step into the movie and become that younger you for the moment, and then imagine yourself moving up through your time-line experiencing the resources so that as you move through each subsequent year of life, the resources transforms your history and enriches your life. Let the resources transform yourself and the others."

7. Return to the present and run an ecology check

"Does this new edition of your memory provide you a sense of closure?" "Does it encode better learning's and responses? Does it enhance your life?" "Would you like to live with this new edition?"

"Does it provide you a more useable map for navigating life?"

8. Future pace

"Look out into your future from the new resourceful perspective.."

Releasing Negative Emotions



Firstly, you now know the general approach to "negative" emotions using time-lines has been to begin with the pattern for eliciting time-lines and to use it to "take a person back to the event" from which they created the original negative emotions. After going back, in one's mind, to a past event from which you felt negative (i.e., guilty, resentful, angry, scared, terrified, depressed, etc.). Secondly, "floating above your time-line," looking down upon the event and inquire of your unconscious mind what you need to learn from that event that you might want to keep with you.

The third step then involves going back a bit further, to 15 minutes prior to that event and then dropping down into that moment in time and looking toward the future. We then ask, "Where are the emotions?" Or, "And what do you see of the future that has not yet happened from this vantage point?" The question is rhetorical - an open future. We then strengthen, confirm, and validate this awareness and feeling by making sure that from fully associating into that position prior to the negative event a person sees an open future of possibilities.

When that's accomplished, we ask the person to zoom quickly forward, all the way back up to the present ... Sometimes we say, "come back to the now only as quickly as you can let go of that negative emotion ..." Afterwards, we then test. "Can you remember any event in the past where you used to be able to feel that old emotion?" If so, the person would repeat the process.

While this describes a very effective pattern for old emotions that are no longer relevant, it tends to quickly dismiss emotions as such without taking into account the validity, usefulness, and appropriateness of the emotion or the informational value of such emotions.

Yet emotions provide an informational value to us because they arise as an evaluation of our thoughts about how things are going. Emotions are "Stop, Look, Listen!" signals about the difference between our Maps of the World and our Experience of the World. Yes, our thinking can be inappropriate as well as appropriate, inaccurate as well as accurate, mistaken, erroneous, and exaggerated. Some emotions come to us as warnings to be heeded. To "release" them before evaluating them is to consider a "negative" emotion as somehow inherently "bad." They are not.



Releasing Negative Emotions



Exercise – Activity

1. Determine the kind of guilt/guiling (anger, fear, resentment, self-pity, grief, etc.)

- What kind of "guilt" is this?
- What law have you violated?
- Is this valid or invalid information?
- Is this feeling accurate or inaccurate?

2. Elicit and use the person's time-line

- Where do you put past events? Future events? Today's happenings?

3. Flush out the cause or contributing factors for the negative emotion (in this case, guilt)

- What is the original source of this negative feeling?
- What were any other contributing influences that affected it?
- What have I learned, or could I learn that will serve me in the future?
- Am I ready to release it and disconnect from it?

4. Float back to the original event

As you identify the original source or time when the negative feeling began, float above your time-line, and go back into that past.

From this higher-level perspective, what have you learned from that experience?

Preserve all the things you can now learn from that experience so that it can inform you in a resourceful way.

5. Float back even a little further in time

You can now allow yourself to float back on your time-line even further and to do so in a comfortable way, as you float past the original source or time of the feeling ... and go back even further as you float back to 15 minutes prior to the event. Now direct your attention forward ... to the present Pause to experience this fully. As you now see the event below and in front, and knowing that you have acknowledged the wrong, changed your mind about the actions, are willing to apologise or make amends, give yourself permission to fully let the guilt go. As you open your eyes to the future that has not yet occurred, from that point in time, what do you see? Is the negative emotion there? Do you need to create that this time?

Have the old emotions flattened out and become de-energised?

6. Quickly zoom forward in time

Seeing the future open with possibilities, just imagine zooming quickly to the present, allow the past to change, in your mind, as it serves to enhance your life and maintaining all your learning's and values. Do so comfortably until you come to a place where you can zoom this feeling of release up through time as you take this feeling and move into your future with it.

7. Future pace

Associate into a future experience in which you would formerly have re-triggered the old guilt.

Are the old dated emotions completely gone?



Decision Destroyer

Exercise – Activity

Sometimes as we move through life, we make some poor decisions. Afterwards, those decisions become part of our mental map and begin to operate as a major psychological force in our life (as a meta-state). This pattern destroys such limiting, destructive, and un-enhancing decisions. Decisions function as part of our mental maps that provide specific instructions about what to do. And while a decision in one context and at one time may function very well for our benefit, as contexts and times change, these decisions can become out-dated and un-useful. This pattern allows us to alter the decisions that we have constructed.

1. Identify a limiting decision that you still live with

What did you decide? Fully express the decision and its meanings. When did you adopt this decision? How long have you lived with it? How has it become limiting to you? Fully elicit this information.

2. Identify an enhancing decision you would like to live life by

What would be a more enhancing decision that you would serve you better now and in the future? Access this decision state, anchor it fully. What decision would have been empowering and would have transformed your life? Describe it fully so that you can fully associate into it and the feelings it induces.

"I will speak up in an assertive way. I have the right to my voice, and I will use it." "I will develop the self-control and confidence to become highly competent in my work." etc.

Feeling the decision, step into the time-line at the point where this once was the limiting decision.

3. Preserve the learnings

Float above your time-line back to when you made the limiting decision. Take a moment to notice the learning's available in this experience for you. Preserve the learning's that you want to keep within you.

4. Move to a time before the limiting decision

Above your time-line, float back further. Go past the limiting decision event to 15 minutes prior to that event. Stop there and see yourself below. Float down into that prior time and associate into it. From this perceptive you can look into your future from that vantage point just prior to the limiting decision. And yet, since it hasn't been made yet, the future is wide open. You might also notice that the emotions along with that decision have disappeared as well ... see them vanish. Re-access your enhancing decision.

Once you have your enhancing decision fully accessed from above the time-line, float down into that younger you, bringing with you that Enhancing Decision fully and completely.

5. Let the empowering decision transform things

Now with this empowering decision in mind, move up into that younger you ... and let them change your memories and feelings as you move through time with that new resourceful decision.

Quickly zoom up through your time-line to the present, stopping the present. Fully integrate the experience and future pace.

Future pace - check ecology.





Meta-stating a new decision in “time”

In this pattern we will use the meta-level concept of time (past, present, future) in a way to serve our empowerment and effectiveness. The design is to undo false, un-useful, and toxic mappings from past events that we no longer need to drag with us and use to torture ourselves (or others!). A decision map created at some previous time does not have to be treated as un-changeable. We can re-code an old decision and update it.

1. Identify your time-line

Think of some simple activity that you did this morning, then think about it last week, last year, 2 years ago, 5 years ago ... next week, next month, next year, 2 years from now, 5 years from now.

Where do you locate these memories and imagination?

What kind of a configuration do you have these in: a line, circle, drawer, roll-a-dex, etc.? Differences in pictures, sounds, feelings?

2. Float above your sense of time and draw a time-line

Now float back to a specific memory, then float forward through now to a time in the future.

3. Identify a decision, belief, experience, etc. in your history in which you experience some hurtful, ugly things and made some very un-useful maps from

- - A limiting decision
- - A limiting belief
- - A limiting hurt that you can still feel bad about

4. Access, anchor, and amplify some resources

What resourceful states, ideas, understandings, decisions, etc. would have totally transformed that old experience?

5. Float up and then back on your time-line to 15 minutes before the event

Anticipate that in a minute, when you float back down into your time-line, 15 minutes prior to the old experience and look into your future, you will not see the old stuff because it has not happened yet. And now you can fully and completely re-access the resources that you want to experience as you live through the experience ... and as you do, the resources will totally transform everything. Float down... with the resource... and bring it through the experience and up to the present.

6. Future pace and check ecology

Notes:



Re-imprinting

Traumatic episodes and reactions can arise from traumatic experiences, negative input through stories, movies, and imaginations. Once we map out a "trauma," the trauma can come to function as a belief- identity imprints that lead to limiting beliefs. Imprints can involve positive experiences as well as negative. Frequently, people abused as children grow up and make unconscious choices that put them back into situations that seem to repeat the prototype trauma situation. By definition, an "imprint" codes people with a map that seems to function in a very ingrained way. One not so easily affected by conscious methods of cognitive restructuring.

Imprints may involve single experiences or a series of experiences. From them, we may come to believe the imprint as reality, "This is the way things are." Imprints can even arise from the beliefs of significant persons. The belief of another person which becomes imprinted in the child. Sometimes the belief operates in a "delayed action" format. Thus, at the time, the person may reject the other's view, but later the other's beliefs (as internal representations) seem to "come alive."

Imprints, as beliefs, work in a self-fulfilling way. When we try to argue with a belief, the person may have too much data, gathered over time, supporting the belief. By going back to the original imprint, we come to a time before the person's maps become cluttered by later confirmations. In imprint situations, often a person switches positions with a hurtful person and experiences the other's reality. A child in an intense ongoing relationship with parents often imprints or introjects some of the parent's beliefs and behaviours and makes them part of his or her own beliefs.

Children do not have a clear sense of their self-identity. They often pretend to think and act as someone else. Sometimes they take on the role model lock, stock, and barrel with very little discrimination as to what they accept entails. Our adult selves, in many ways, involve an incorporation of the models we grew up with. Our model of adulthood has the features of past significant others. In them we can find family beliefs, precedents, rules, scripts, etc. that arose from our childhood.

Introjection of a significant other frequently, although not always, occurs in the imprinting process. When this doesn't occur, we probably just have a problem with a person or certain behaviours. The key lies in what belief/s a person developed via the imprint experience. Imprints generally operate outside of conscious awareness.

The mechanism for discovery of the imprint comes from anchoring an imprint feeling (a negative emotion) and using the emotion as a guide to find past memories. Travel back with it to the point where you feel confused, to where you feel, "I don't know." At the impasse, we have probably come to the right address. The emotion will lead to the experience where we created the limiting belief. If one encounters a "blank," anchor that is blank as a state, take it back in time to a significant past imprint.

When a person reaches an impasse or imprint, immediately interrupt them and anchor a powerful resource state (i.e., courage, power, etc.). Take that resource state back into the impasse to help the person get through it.

By finding the imprint experience and re-coding it with the resources that all the persons involved needed back then, people change their perspectives and the subsequent beliefs derived from that experience. Re-imprinting creates a multiple perspective viewpoint, which serves as the basis for wisdom in making decisions, dealing with conflicts, negotiating, relating, etc.





Re-imprinting helps with the updating of internal maps by highlighting resources one can use to resolve and/or avoid trauma situations. In re-imprinting, we mentally give the people who perpetrated hurt the resources they needed in order not to have created such hurt. Doing this doesn't excuse or condone the hurtful behaviour; it simply maps out appropriate resources and behaviours. Often, victims of crimes build limiting beliefs that anger and fear then maintain. Such, shows up as revenge beliefs and then creates even more stuck-ness by creating a victim's identity. Giving the perpetrator the resources they needed prior to the incident where the imprint occurred helps to resolve one's memory of the episode.

Re-imprinting helps a person to update the internal maps. It allows them to hold different beliefs and resources. It allows the imprint experience to mean something resourceful.

The reimprinting pattern

1. Identify the problem. What belief, behaviour, emotion, etc. do you want to change?

"What associated feelings go along with it?" Inquire about what the person has done to change that belief or behaviour. "What stands in the way? What stops you?"

2. Locate the experience

With the anchored feeling, initiate a historical search using your time-line, etc. to locate the imprint experience.

3. Using a time-line travel back with the emotion

[Establish a time-line and go back to the imprint experience. Have the person stay with the feeling (while you hold the anchor) and begin to remember the earliest experience of this feeling. When the person has gotten to an earlier experience, while associated in this regressed state, have him or her verbalise the beliefs and Generalisations formed from that experience.]

"Take a moment and think about how frustrating (or whatever the negative emotion) everything has been. Take that feeling back in time ... what do you experience? Does it involve anyone else? ... Do you see the person looking at you? ... Go ahead and put yourself inside 'the you back then' for just a moment. What beliefs do you make about this experience? ... What beliefs about others, about the world, about God? ..."

[Sometimes when the person verbalises the belief, this will consist of the first time he or she has become aware of it. The articulation of the belief itself will cause the misbelief to simply evaporate.]

4. Break state and review the experience

Ask the person to step off the time-line and review the imprint experience, identifying the situation and the other participants.

"I want you to come back here to this room now, and to leave that past memory." Then have the person experience the episode as if watching a movie of them self.

"Look back at that experience you had, put it way out there so that it completely leaves, so that you no longer find yourself in it at all... and watch that younger you... how has that experience affected you since that time?"

Ask the person to verbalise any other beliefs formed as a result of this imprint or any beliefs that arose "after the fact." Sometimes people don't form beliefs at the time of the imprint, but later. We can build imprint beliefs both during and after the episode



5. Find the positive intentions in the feeling or belief

The person may have to ask the characters. "What positive intention did you have in doing this?" Did they seek to install this belief that you exist as a worthless person? Trying to screw you up? What intention did this part have in doing this? Would he like it if he knew what is now going on with you?

6. Identify and anchor the needed resources

"What resources and choices did you need back then but did not have? What resources and choices did the other characters in that situation need? What would you need to give those persons in order for them to respond differently? More acceptance? So, they need a realisation that different people have different models of the world? As you now vividly recall a time when you fully had that accepting feeling, find a specific example. Great.

And how well do you have that resource anchored?"

7. Apply the resource

As you step off the time-line, review the imprint experience from the perspective of each of the characters involved. Holding the anchor, give each character in the situation all the resources they would have needed to achieve a desired outcome - back then.

"Take these resources and give it to this other person. This other person is in your brain right now - that image or memory comes from your brain. So, take this and give it to him. What does he or she do differently? ... What beliefs do you now build out of this experience? ... Just go inside and allow your unconscious mind to review each experience with this experience knowing that they now have the resources they needed. We know that this person didn't have that resource at that time, although as your resource, you can update that model now ... "There is a younger self back in that experience that needs resources that he or she didn't have then. What resources do you have now that would have allowed you to build a different set of beliefs then? What insights, skills, abilities ... ? What is the closest you have come to having that resource? Now take that light and shine it back through your history. Shine it on that younger you ... so that as that younger you begins to feel this resource.. you can allow yourself to imagine how that would have changed things. And you can now allow yourself to be relaxed and secure, calm and comfortable with yourself in that memory ... see that younger self in front of you building resourceful beliefs and abilities."

8. Associate and relive the imprint experience

Becoming each character, have the person step onto the time-line [holding the anchor] with all the resources previously given to that character. Then have the person update and/or modify the beliefs associated with the experience.

9. Receive resources

Ask the person step onto the time-line as their younger self and receive the qualities, attributes they needed from each significant character.

10. Review and future pace

Ask the person to step off the time-line and review the changed experience. When he/she feels satisfied with the outcome, have the person step back onto the time-line, and then move up quickly into his or her future. Then stop and use the resources to see how they will think-feel and live in a new and different way.

Notes:



Finishing Unfinished Business

Exercise – Activity

The following pattern offers a process for assisting a person to catch up in their psychic development after he or she has cleaned up old traumatic memories, limiting beliefs, and/or dis-empowering beliefs.

Eric Erickson's Developmental Model of the Psycho-Social Stages:

- Trust/mistrust of others who respond to and care for our needs
- Autonomy/shame and doubt: Functioning as self-sufficient and exploring
- Initiative/guilt: Exploring and negotiating boundaries
- Industry/inferiority: Learning to become competent, productive in mastering skills
- Identity/role confusion: Establishing a sense of self
- Intimacy/isolation: Dealing with companionship, love, friendships
- Generativity/stagnation: A meaningful contribution
- Integrity/despair: Making sense of life.

1. Adopt a commitment to reality

Having cleared up the hurts of the past, having used your new understandings and "ego strength" to face those past hurts from your strengths, you have begun to "make yourself a friend to reality" rather than an enemy. Those days of feeling and thinking in an antagonistic way to reality have ended. As you have learned to step back from the experiences that that younger you had in the past by floating above on your time-line, you now have the skill of looking at and accepting the disliked, obnoxious, dysfunction, etc. without taking it personally. What a skill! And you can congratulate yourself for learning to accept without confusing it with approving, validating, or endorsing what existed. You can accept what exists—what existed and dislike it and realise fully it only existed as an event, an experience, a set of behaviours and that you exist as so much more than those experiences.

This skill signifies the adult recognition of reality as a dispassionate fact. How different from the way we thought-and-felt as children! Then we took events personal, we thought in egocentric ways, we introjected the hurtful behaviours of others, and we built disempowering beliefs about ourselves and we have now learned to do that no more.

2. Access a state of adult acceptance

Think about a time or situation where you accepted something that you did not like. Pick something simple to practice identifying these representations: Cleaning the bathroom and toilet, doing dishes, preparing your tax return, etc. How do you, representationally, construct this acceptance of disliked activity? What beliefs and values support this state? When you have it fully and resourcefully, anchor it.

3. Access a friendship to reality state

Maturing, developing, and becoming fully human necessitates a commitment to what actually exists, in the place of wishful thinking, magical thinking, and regretful thinking ("Oh, if only ..!"). Once you access a time when you positively felt that kind of orientation, notice your inner representations of those movies as well as the supporting beliefs. When you're ready, anchor that state and representations.





4. Access the state of "finishing business" state

Identify the state of "finishing something." What project, tasks, relationship, etc. have you engaged in, invited yourself in, and then brought to a completion and released so that you let it come completely and thoroughly in a positive way so that you simply took the resources of that experienced and moved on to the next step? Think about a grade in school that you finished, or a particular subject or skill you learned. How did you complete that business with your instructor, coach, and friends?

In accessing this resource state of "having positively brought something to closure" notice all of the representations and supporting beliefs that made this an enhancing life experience for you. You "came to terms" with the time-limited nature of the subject. You began something and then you completed it. Anchor this.

5. Finish the "unfinished business"

As you now float above your current time-line, where you live and act and feel and think today ... looking down upon it and noticing how it moves back into the past, allow yourself to notice what developmental tasks (the Erickson list) that you did not complete trust, autonomy, identity, etc.

From above your time-line move forward into the future to a time when you can imagine seeing yourself as having finished that task. Now go there. What does finishing that task look like, sound like, feel like? What supporting beliefs, values, and actions go along with it? Fire the "finishing business" and "a friend to reality" anchors as you float down into that time and fully experience it with completeness. And you can enjoy the full development ...

Use as a swish.

When you have fully captured the feeling and meaning of finishing that old business, return to now and look into your future at that future you ... noticing the steps and stages that you will take day by day as you move more and more into your future ... because you can.

The Trance-Logical Levels of the Milton-Model

The Milton model

There are levels within the Meta-Model, levels that allow us to invite a person to move up into the land of trance. Actually, the very same linguistic distinctions, which allow us to either speak with precision, allow us also to speak with Artful Vagueness and so to induce trance. It all depends on how we use these distinctions.

Structure Metaphor (Met) Presuppositions (Ps) Multi-ordinality (MO) Identification (Id)	Distortion Mind-Reading (MR) Complex Equivalences (CEq) Nominalisations (Nom) Cause-Effect (C-E) Lost Performatives (LP) Delusional Verbal Splits (DVS) Pseudo-Words (PW) Personalising (Per) Static Words (SW)
Generalisation Universal Quantifiers (UQ) Model Operators (MO) Either-Or Phrases (E-O) Over/Under defined terms (O/U)	Evaluative Language Deletion Deletions -- simple Deletions -- comparative/superlative Unspecified referential indices Unspecified processes adverbs modifying verbs Unspecified processes adjectives modifying nouns
Questioning the assumptive structure The assumptive formats or frames Map-territory distortions	Questioning distortions Specifying the knowledge source Specifying logical level confusions Specifying equations Specifying causations, syntax, order Specifying referents Hyphenating
Questioning generalisations Challenging the allness Challenging the rules Challenging the one-valued structure Challenging the two-valued structure Challenging the specificity	Indexing deleted references Specifying the what, when, who, where, how, etc. Representationally tracking referents





IN TRANCE

Questions:

- What is this an example of?
- For what purpose...?
- What is your intention?
- By having this, what does it give you that is even more important?

GENERAL - BIG PICTURE - CHUNK UP



The MILTON MODEL



The META-MODEL

Questions:

- What are examples of this?
- What specifically?
- Any Meta-Model Question!

SPECIFIC - DETAILS - CHUNK DOWN

OUT OF TRANCE



Hypnotic Language Patterns

Milton Model

In using the meta-model hypnotically, we play with the ill-formed-ness of the language in order to speak with artful vagueness. The Milton model is in effect, a reverse meta-model.

1. Comparative deletions or unspecified comparisons

A statement that makes a comparison but fails to specify the standard, the basis, the criteria, etc. of the comparison.

"And it's more or less the right thing to do..."

2. Lack of referential index

A statement that lacks a specific referent.

"One can, you know, relax..."

3. Unspecified verbs/nouns

Verbs and nouns that are vague, general, and having no specified referent.

"And you can learn in new ways, so that your skills at hypnosis can greatly increase ..."

4. Universal quantifier

Words that indicate universality, or allness.

"And as you appreciate all of the things that you have learned, and all of the things you will be learning..."

5. Lost performatives

A value judgment is presented but the "performer" of the judgment, the person who made the map, has been left out.

"And it's a good thing to wonder, to really wonder ..."

6. Nominalisations

When verbs or process terms are turned into nouns, frozen in time and treated as things, we have nominalised (or named, nounified) the actions.

"As you experience a deeper relaxation than you have before, your appreciation for the new insights can further deepen your growing resourcefulness..."

7. Cause—Effect

A map is made about events, experiences, activities in terms of one causing another and one being the effect of some cause. The causation can be overtly stated or just implied.

"If you are feeling confused, then it means that you are at the gateway of a new learning..." (If... then)

"As you wonder, curiously, then will only allow you to really learn ..." (as you ... then ...)

"Because you are wondering, you are really learning, perhaps in ways that you don't even yet realise..."





8. Mind-Reading

Claiming to know the thoughts or feelings of another person without specifying how you know that information.

"I know that you are wondering just how much more resourceful you are going to become ..."

9. Complex equivalence

Two things that occur at different logical levels (levels of abstraction or levels of mind) are equated as if the same, or equal.

"When you begin to hear these patterns, it means that you are really learning..."

10. Presuppositions

Something is assumed to exist, be real, be meaningful, etc., something we just assume or presuppose without presenting.

"You are learning many things ..."

11. Tag Questions

A question added after a statement that can displace resistance, invite acceptance, sneak the statement in, etc.

"You can relax even more fully, can you not?"

12. Conversational postulates

A seeming question that actually calls for a "yes" or "no" response, but which actually presents a statement or command and that activates the hearer to act.

"Can you pass the ketchup?" "And because this is something that you really are drawn toward, can your hand move up toward your face as a sign of your growing interest as an expression of your commitment to become more resourceful?"

13. Extended quotes

Using quotes from others inside of quotes or stories, or narratives. The design is to communicate messages without them seeming to be commands, suggestions, or questions.

Last week Bob was telling him about the training in NC where he was using the Meta-Yes pattern and how that Jim had used it with his wife and when she said 'Yes' she found herself able to feel really much more in control of her life than she had ever before . . ."

14. Selectional restriction violations

Describing something in such a way that a literal reading or interpretation would recognise it as ridiculous, but which makes sense when caught up in the story.

"And if the grass growing in your front yard could speak, maybe it would say, 'Hey, I've got feelings too!' and might feel put off by the lack of considerate treatment, because when feelings are ignored, relationships can be damaged, and ..."



15. Ambiguities

Statements are made that lack clarity of reference and so are ambiguous in meaning. We can generate ambiguities in sound (phonological ambiguity), structure and order (syntactic ambiguity), in extent of meaning (scope ambiguity) and in punctuation (punctuation ambiguity).

- **Syntactic:**
In this kind of ambiguity, we cannot immediately determine from the context the function of the word
"Hypnotising semanticists can be tricky."
- **Scope:**
In this one, we cannot determine by the context how much one portion of a sentence applies to another portion
"Speaking to you as a child..." "The old men and women..." "The growing relaxation of your hands and feet..."
- **Punctuation:**
In run on sentences, a word both ends and begins a sentence. "Let me see your hand me your watch." In improper pause, you begin a sentence and insert pauses which forces a mind ... read. In an incomplete sentence we begin a sentence and never complete... We then simply go on to another statement
"I want you to notice your hand me the glass..."
- **Phonological ambiguity:**
"Hear... here..." "Light... light (not heavy)..."

16. Embedded commands, questions, suggestions

A command, question, or suggestion embedded into a conversation or statement that is marked out by tones and volume.

Hypnotic Processes for Communicating



In a way that induces trance

Pacing current experience to lead to new experiences

Making statements that allow the hearer to be able to externally verify the statement and so it matches or fits with the person's experience. "And as you notice yourself just sitting there, listening to my voice and really wondering where this is going to lead, you can begin to notice the tension in your legs and move them ever so gently to relax even further . . ."

Double binding statements

Making a statement that describes things so that however a person responds, the response is inevitable. The person is "bound" by the description.

"And that means your unconscious mind is also here and can hear what I say. And since that's the case, you are probably learning about this and actually already know more about this at an unconscious level than you think you do, and it's not right for me to tell you, learn this or learn that, because you can learn in any way that is most effective for you, can you not?"

Utilisation or incorporation

Using or incorporating whatever happens in a context and making it part of the communications and experience. Client "I'm not convinced"

"That's right, you are not convinced yet and I wouldn't be either because there is one key question that has to be asked before you can feel totally convinced about this..."

Intonation patterns (at least in English)

Statements are conveyed when we keep our tone of voice even or straight. Questions are suggested by raising our tone at the end of a sentence.

Commands are suggested by lowering the tone at the end.



Exercise – Activity

1. Identify 3 to 5 resourceful states

Calm >Curious >Learning >Practicality >Achievement

.....

.....

2. Write an Induction that ties the states together

"As I think about a gentle breeze blowing through my hair as I stroll along in the beautiful garden... it makes me want to breathe the beauty and relaxation in and enjoy it ... and to stop... and just notice the wonder around me ... and it's like the gentle calmness of the garden itself that enters into me... comfortably with its life-giving vitality so that the thoughts that race around in my head slow down and enjoy this moment ..."

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3. Induce one-into a light trance state using your scripts

Take each other through the process of inducing a light trance using your scripts and test.

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NLP PATTERNS



Somatic Swish



Exercise – Activity

1. Put your time-line on the floor

Stand up and orient to a time-line before, behind, and around you.

- Where is your future?
- Where is 1 week away, 2 weeks, 3, 4, 2 months, etc.
- In 1 month (or 2 or 6) will you be more skilled than you are right now? [Yes]

In your mind, zoom out to that time when you can see or imagine or feel yourself more skilful with these NLP patterns and processes.

2. Imagine a desired skill or behaviour or state

Imagine a skill that is possible to experience in the near future of that future you. Code fully using all of your cinematic features (VAK and sub-modalities) so the movie that you play is totally compelling.

Let's go out and visit that future you: Step into it ... experience it. Now let's back up to the now.

3. Imagine that desired image in a lesser degree

Since everything develops, since nothing starts off full-grown, you can imagine yourself growing, developing, and becoming more skilled in the weeks and months to come, can you not?

A week before that image would have been a lesser developed image, less robust ... see the you weeks away, the you 2 weeks away, the you of next week. Make a series of lesser images in front of the you 1 month from now. Go visit those images if you want to.

4. Back to the moment

Walk into your future and through these ever-developing images, and along your future pathway until you get to that you of a month from now who will be more skilled ... and gather up your resources as you move along ... gathering up feelings, states, etc. As you move along.

Now that you have done that once, let's back up to the Now and move very quickly through these images, breaking through each one until you get to that future self.

Notes



Creating a New Part



Exercise – Activity

The purpose of this pattern is to create a new part if you don't do something simply because there isn't any part within that's organised to do that behaviour organised with thoughts, beliefs, desire, insight). Any learning process organises and sequences skills to build a part to do something.

"Parts" need to be described in terms of what they do, their function; not in terms of how they do it, their behaviour. We build parts to achieve outcomes. Creating a new part to achieve a specific outcome. The tricky part is building a part that won't interfere with other parts and outcomes.

1. Identify a desired behaviour, response, or emotion

Determine the specific outcome you want. Menu list: assertiveness, respond to conflict positively, handle rejection resourcefully, etc.

2. Access referent experiences that contributes to it

Access some historical experiences that involved some bits and pieces of the resource. When did you experience some part of it? Step inside each experience and access the desired aspects in all representational systems. Anchor each component piece of the new behaviour. Fantasy creation: Create a detailed set of images of yourself engaging in this new behaviour. Create a visual and auditory movie of it so you can observe the whole sequence.

3. What frames support this?

What beliefs, values, identities, decisions, understandings, etc.?

4. Use the ecological frame

Does any part of me object to this new behaviour? Are all facets of my mind-body aligned with this?

Satisfy Objections: If there are objections, identify them, use that information to re-edit the movie. Continue until there are no objections.

5. Use the association frame

Now, step inside the Movie and go through sequence from the inside in an associated state. Experience yourself successfully engaging in the behaviours. Amplify and anchor it.

6. Solidify and commission

Do you want this? Would this enhance your life? Will you own this as yours? Imagine taking this into your future.

Notes



Negotiating Between Parts

Exercise – Activity

Agreement frame

This pattern is useful for stopping internal conflict when two or more “parts” or facets of our thinking and feeling conflict and interrupt each other. The pattern is based upon the assumption that there is a lack of congruence of these conflicting parts. Use this pattern in cases where each part has a valid function and useful way of operating, but each part steps on the other.

1. Identify the parts in conflict

- Do you have a part of your mind that wants to achieve something that’s important to you and then another part that interferes with that?
- What are these parts or functions? [Name the parts.]
- What are you seeking to accomplish? What behaviours are you seeking to produce?
- What is your positive function or intention for me?
- Are there any other parts that are interrupting you?

2. Engage the parts to find the purpose and positive intentions

- Is this important for you?
- How is this function important?
- What is the Positive Intention above this?

3. Invite a new arrangement

- Is your purpose, function and positive intention important enough to you that you would be willing to work with this other part so that you can obtain your objectives and outcomes?
- When you consider the positive intention of this other part, are you in agreement with it as an important and valuable contribution to you?
- How would you like to sequence things so that there is a better arrangement between these two important facets?
- Are you willing, for the purposes of exploring and developing a new arrangement for the next week to see how it will work out?
- Will you take responsibility to do your thing in a way that honours the other part and to receive the same in return?

4. Run an ecology check

- Are you aligned with this? Would this enhance your overall functioning?
- Are there any other parts involved in this?
- Are there any other parts that interrupt this part, or that utilise these interruptions? If so, renegotiate.

Future Pace: As you think about taking this into your future, what happens? What do you feel? Are you aligned with this? Are there any objections?



The Visual Squash – parts integration



Exercise – Activity

This pattern offers a way to create an integration of warring parts. When we have two conflicting internal representations of something, the differing representations may set up differing programs for believing, perceiving, emoting and behaving. They may run conflicting neurological patterns so that we try to use two conflicting responses at the same time. Use this pattern to integrate two simultaneous models of the world.

1. Identify the inner conflict

- What parts or facets of yourself seem to be in conflict?
- Give each of them a name or label. Notice how you have internally represented each part.
- How do you know they conflict? What do they conflict about?

2. Allow visual images to arise

Let's separate each part, one into your right hand and one into your left. Which do you want to put in this hand (right)? Okay, do that. Now allow a visual image of each part to form ...

[For example, put your playful part in the right hand and your work/business part in your left hand.]

3. Separate intention from behaviour

- What does this part want?
- What is its positive intention for you?
- What does it value and care about?
- What can you appreciate about this part?
- [Repeat for each part.]

4. Establish communication

- What resource (or resources) does this part need which would be useful in assisting it to be even more effective? And what about this other part?
- How could this playful part be useful to the work part? How could the work part be useful to the playful part?
- What higher values, benefits, outcomes, etc. do both parts want?

5. Allow a new image to emerge, then a series of images

I want you to now allow a third image to form ... somewhere in between the other two images that you have of those parts. Let an image form out of the two that combines the best of the two. Let it take on the valuable qualities of each of the parts.

Now look at this new part and imagine what it will look like, sound like, and feel like when it has the combined resources of the two parts. And as you do, you may need to imagine a series of visual images that represent the transition from each part and to do so until you have a representation in the centre that combines both fully.



6. Collapse or merge the images

Now, now bring your hands together, each containing the individual images of the two parts. Let them simultaneously merge (or collapse) so that only the third Image remains. Do that now

7. Take the integrated image inside

Reach out in front of you to this new integrated image, which contains the values of both of the parts, and bring it into yourself. And where do you want to store it inside? Let it permeate your understandings and notice how it transforms things ...

8. Test

Okay, let's break state for a moment.

Good. Now, think about the conflict situation that you began with. What happens? How do you feel? What's different? What has shifted?

Notes



Negotiating and Influencing

Exercise – Activity

Prepare yourself for negotiating by accessing your best negotiating states and the beliefs (frames) that support such. "I can and will always walk away from any negotiation deal." "I don't have to have this deal." "It's only about money."

1. Operate from a clear vision of outcomes

- Begin by pacing to establish rapport.
 - Set frames for willingness to develop consensus.
 - Preframe future possibilities.
 - Identify outcomes:
 - What do you want? What is your outcome?
 - What is the other person's wants and outcomes?
 - Use assertive format: I think, I feel, I want. Reflect back the other person's assertions.
 - Creatively develop numerous options and alternatives for satisfying outcomes. Access and elicit (in self and other) states of creativity, playfulness, options, in order to brainstorm and generate lots of alternatives.
-
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2. Use dialogue to develop potential agreement frames

- Searching for agreement frames: Move beyond "positions" to higher level outcomes.
 - Initiate dialogue that openly explores possibilities.
 - States of persistence, belief, commitment, etc.
 - Skills of dialogue: attentive listening, exploring, etc. Rather than propose and counter-propose, explore, restate, validate, probe and clarify.
 - Commitment to a win/win arrangement: win/win or no deal.
 - Explore objections, problems, issues. Probe the meaning, importance, understandings, etc. that drive them.
 - Prioritise preferences, using scaling processes to gauge importance.
 - Refuse any attack/ counter-attack moves. Defensiveness never helps. Defuse when attacked. Separate person from behaviour. Assume positive intention and explore.
-
-

3. Develop tentative plans

Using agreement frames, commitment to larger outcomes, make offers and establish tentative solutions. State reasons before making a proposal (to sell it by setting frames).



Having Great Meetings



Exercise – Activity

To transform meetings into a useful, productive and valuable tool; one that truly supports our productivity. [From Bernice McCarthy – www.4mat4learning.com.au](http://www.4mat4learning.com.au).

(4) WHAT IF	(1) WHY
Closing a meeting Assign anybody running a polarity response the job to troubleshoot problems just as soon as a legitimate and well-formulated plan has been devised. Invite them to play devil's advocate at that time. Succinctly summarise. • "What we have achieve today is . . ." • "What was the best thing that you are taking away from this?" Check for confirmation. Aim to operate with efficiency.	Clarify your purpose, reason, importance, etc. for the meeting before arriving • What is the meeting for? Outcomes? • Is the meeting essential? Can I (we) handle this via phone, email, faxes, memos, etc.? What do I want from the meeting? What do others want? • How will we know? (Evidence) Readiness to go in: pace, create rapport, work as a team, etc.
(3) HOW	(2) WHAT
Conduct the meeting Get to it with the focus, direction, and clarity. State check: Are we alert? Are we in the best states? Do we need a break? Clarity of discussion, outcome, decisions: how record meeting. Willingness to flush out hidden agendas via: relevancy challenge: "How does this relate to our purpose here?" "Is this truly relevant? How? In what way?" Backtracking frame: "If I understand where we are, we have ... and decided on ... and so that now brings us to ... Have I missed anything?"	Begin by establishing your purpose and agenda Meta-communicate about the meeting in terms of what you as a group want to achieve. • What are our objectives/ outcomes for this meeting? • How can we best use our time together? • How will we know that we have achieved these? • Sensory based, specific, short or long term, etc.? • How much time do we want to devote to this? • Who is needed here? Who is not? • How will we procedure? • Who will play a referee role to keep us on task? Permission for everyone to present a relevancy challenge.



NLP patterns

There are many patterns in NLP, perhaps 150. Check the Patterns below that you know about with a check mark (✓), those that you are skilled at with a star (*) and with a hyphen (-), for those that you are unfamiliar with.

	Well-formed outcomes		State elicitation
	Swish pattern		State calibration
	Movie rewind (or phobia cure) pattern		Pacing
	6-step reframing pattern		Anchoring
	Circle of excellence		Collapsing anchors
	Meta-modelling		State interrupt (pattern interrupt)
	Chaining anchors		Visual squash pattern
	Accessing time-lines		Change history
	Decision destroyer		Belief change using sub modalities
	Shifting perceptual positions		Strategy unpacking
	Strategy elicitation		Meta-yes/no
	Meta-stating		Re-imprinting
	Changing meta-programs		Threshold pattern
	Context and content reframing		Detecting meta-programs
	Positively responding to criticism		Self Research and Self Assessment



Self Research and Self Assessment

Exercise – Activity

Where are you in terms of your knowledge and skill of basic NLP?

What are your evidence criteria that you have learned the model and have developed some of the basic skills?

How shall we assess our knowledge and skills?

How far along have you come, how much further do you want to go?

Practitioner level standards

What does it take to become certified as an NLP Practitioner?

To ask this question is to bring up the minimum requirements for understanding the model and for being able to actually use and practice the patterns and processes. Our focus on this day is to assess where we are our strengths and weaknesses. Are you open to that?





For competency of the basic practitioner training of META-NLP (NLP practitioner training) you will need to be:

1	Able to know and behaviourally integrate the NLP presuppositions.	
2	Able to quickly get rapport with a person and to maintain that rapport by pacing them verbally and non-verbally, and to then lead.	
3	Able to calibrate another person's inner states by using exquisite sensory experience. Such calibration includes the ability to note a person's use of predicates in their language and eye accessing cues as they speak.	
4	Able to create a well-formed outcome for self and elicit one from another.	
5	Able to overlap to other representational systems and to translate out of your primary system into other systems.	
6	Able to identify and use the meta-model in communicating and information gathering. To be able to ask challenging meta-model questions for any presenting surface statement. This presupposes recognising the linguistic distinctions of the meta-model.	
7	Able to identify and use the Milton-model so as to take a person into an altered state and allow them to experience the resources that are a part of that state. Able to generate the language patterns as well as the behavioural flexibility of voice to facilitate trance states.	
8	Able to identify the frame of a person, to expand the frame, de-frame, reframe and to use alternative frames for doing change work: the "As If" frame, the first, second, third- and fourth-person position (perspectives) frames, the relevancy frame, a contrast frame, etc.	
9	Able to anchor in V.A.K. systems and then to be able to fire off an anchor and have the person to re-experience the state anchored.	
10	Able to shift one's own state of consciousness from external (uptime) to internal (downtime) according to the task's need.	
11	Able to step into a state and fully associate in that state and then to step out and experience more of a witnessing or observing state (to experience so-called "dissociation").	
12	Able to "chunk up" and to "chunk down" in handling various sizes of information, to move up and down the scale of specificity and abstraction.	
13	Able to detect, elicit, and shift "sub-modalities" when working with various patterns.	
14	Able to elicit responses both verbally and non-verbally, and to amplify the state or response that's elicited.	
15	Able to access, build, and amplify resources (resourceful states) in self and others.	
16	Able to show a wide range of verbal and non-verbal flexibility with the basic models (meta-model, sub-modality model, meta-states model, time-line model).	
17	Able to step back and ask questions about ecology in order to check on the ecology of an intervention or response.	
18	Able to think through (critical thinking skills) ethical questions using the meta-model questions and the basic premises of NLP and Neuro- Semantics.	



Testing your Knowledge of NLP

NLP fundamentals

- What are the representational systems in NLP? What do we mean by that phrase?

- What does it refer to?

- How are the sensory systems of visual, auditory, kinaesthetic, etc. important to a model of communication?
How does knowing about the VAK help us communicate better?

- What are sub-modalities? What does this term refer to?

- What is the position of Neuro-Semantics on sub-modalities, which differs from traditional NLP?

- What is the difference between analogue and digital in NLP?





- What difference does the difference between analogue and digital make? Why is this important? How can you utilise these distinctions?

- What are five distinctions between each of the basic representation system?

- Contrast and compare the following sensory systems: visual, auditory, kinaesthetic, language.

- What is sensory acuity and how can a person develop more of it?

- What is the Meta-Model?

- Where did the Meta-Model come from? How was it developed?

- What does it mean to read eye-accessing cues? What are these eye-accessing cues?



- Why would a person want to learn the art of reading eye-accessing cues? What would be the benefits of doing that?

- There are many patterns in NLP. What are some of these patterns?

- Describe the well-formed outcome pattern and explain its value.

- What did Fritz Perls mean by his famous quote, "lose your mind and come to your senses?"

- What are the two royal roads to state?

- What do we mean when we speak about calibrating to a state? What is calibration in NLP?

- Why is it important to learn the art of state calibration?

- What does the term unconscious mean in NLP?



- What did George Miller mean by "the magic number 7 plus or minus 2?"
How is that number important in terms of communication?

- How do we access a state in another person? What are some of the mechanisms that we can use to do this?

- Describe the circle (Sphere) of excellence pattern and how it operates. When would this be a useful pattern?

- What is the swish pattern? How does it work?

- What does the swish pattern do for us or another?

- What does it mean to anchor in NLP? How does this process of anchoring work?

- What are the key variables in being able to anchor with precision and effectiveness?

- What does the following language mean in NLP:
firing an anchor, setting an anchor, making an anchor redundant in all systems?



- What are the four perceptual positions in NLP? Why are these important?

- How does a person move between the perceptual positions? What's the critical variable that facilitates this?

- What do the words, associate and dissociate mean in NLP?
What simpler words has Neuro-Semantics offered in their stead?

- What is the SCORE model? Who developed it and what is its value? What do the letters stand for?

- What is the Movie Rewind pattern? What are some of the other names for this pattern in NLP?

- What are some of the central mechanisms that explain how the Movie Rewind pattern works?

- What does it mean to collapse anchors? How does this pattern work?

- What is the visual squash pattern and how does it work?



APPENDICES



Sensory Acuity



V.I.B.E.S.

Some of the things you can notice about people's responses

Voice	Inclination (of the spine, general posture and gesture)	Breathing	Eyes	Skin
• Speed • Volume • Pitch • Tone • Timbre • Modulation • Type of words used	• Slumped or straight • Leaning forwards, upright or back • Range and speed of gestures • Symmetrical / Asymmetrical	• Rate • Depth • Location in body	• Movements • Pupil dilation • Redness • Watering • Direction	• Colour • Muscle tone • Size of areas (eg Lips) • Shiny / dull • Goose-pimples



Representational Systems Test

Click [HERE](#) for online version – automated version

This test has been reproduced with the permission of Don Power and Sylvia Fernandez © Power+ Executive Evolution. 2004 NS-NLP. Special Recognition for material contained in this manual goes to Dr. John Grinder, Dr Milton Erickson MD, and Dr Michael Hall, Dr Everett James, David Gordon.

**For each of the following statements, please place a number next to every phrase.
Use the following system to indicate your preferences:**

4 = Closest to describing you

3 = Next best description

2 = Third best

1 = Least descriptive of you

1. I make important decisions based on:

gut level feelings
which way sounds the best
what looks best to me
precise review and study of the issues

**2. During an argument,
I am most likely to be influenced by:**

the other person's tone of voice
whether or not I can see the other person's point of view
the logic of the other person's argument
whether or not I am in touch with the other person's true feelings

3. I most easily communicate what is going on with me by:

the way I dress and look
the feelings I share
the words I choose
my tone of voice

4. It is easiest for me to:

find the ideal volume and tuning on a stereo system
select the most intellectually relevant point in a discussion
select the most comfortable furniture
select rich, attractive colour combinations

5. I am or have:

very attuned to the sounds of my surroundings
very adept at making sense of new facts and data
very sensitive to the way articles of clothing feel on my body
a strong response to colours and to the way a room looks





Now copy the numbers from your answers straight into these columns (top to bottom):

Question 1	Question 2	Question 3	Question 4	Question 5
K	A	V	A	A
A	V	K	Ad	Ad
V	Ad	Ad	K	K
Ad	K	A	V	V

Add the numbers next to each letter from the previous box into the box below.

E.G. If for question 1 you had (4 for K), (2 for A), (3 for V) and (1 for Ad), you would mark a 3 next to Visual box, 2 next Auditory and so on in the box below.

	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5	Totals
V Visual (Pictures)						
A Auditory (Sounds)						
K Kinaesthetic (Feeling)						
Ad Auditory Digital (Lists & Systems)						

Notes

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Now that you have completed the representational systems test, answer the following:

What is your preference?

How were the results different from your expectation?



The Meta-Model Explained

The Meta model is really a map of the structure of unsanity (Korbzybski). Unsanity is the direct result of the deletions, distortions and generalisations through which people filter their experience. By deleting, distorting and generalising reality, we create "unsanity" in ourselves and in other people. The Meta-model when properly applied is a powerful tool for removing "unsanity" and for helping to achieve super sanity.

History

The Meta Model, NLP's first formal model, was published in 1975 by Richard Bandler and John Grinder in their ground breaking book, *The Structure of Magic*, Vol. 1. It extended features of general semantics (Korzybski) and transformational grammar (Chomsky), and developed via modelling the successful therapeutic language interventions of psychiatrists Fritz Perls and Milton Erickson, and family therapist Virginia Satir.

The Meta Model formalised these developments into a richly defined set of linguistic patterns that can either facilitate change or create obstacles in a person's mental maps of himself and the world.

Expanding & Revising Mental Maps

"The meta model represents, as far as we (Bostic and Grinder) have been able to determine, the first complete syntactically based language model for an express purpose ever created. The thirteen (or so - it depends on how you count them) verbal patterns that constitute the meta model are a highly effective verbal model for use in the specific context of therapeutic change".

"They are designed for the express purpose of challenging the limitations in the mental maps carried by clients who seek professional assistance in changing themselves through the processes of therapy. Under the impact of the systematic use of the meta model patterns, clients... expand and/or revise the mental maps that contain the traps, flaws and limitations that prevent them from shifting to more effective and congruent behaviour." -- Bostic and Grinder, *Whispering In the Wind*, 2001, p.148.

Different individuals have different numbers and kinds of Meta Model violations in their thinking and speech. The absence of Meta Model violations does not indicate that a person does not have any problems in life. But the presence of Meta Model violations clearly indicates at least one limiting factor in thinking - language which, by no other factor than its structure, deletes, distorts and generalises thinking.





Deletion, Distortion and Generalisation

As described by Bandler and Grinder, "Deletion is a process by which we selectively pay attention to certain dimensions of our experience and exclude others. Take, for example, the ability that people have to filter out or exclude all other sound in a room full of people talking in order to listen to one particular person's voice... Deletion reduces the world to proportions which we feel capable of handling. The reduction may be useful in some contexts and yet be the source of pain in others.

"Distortion is the process which allows us to make shifts in our experience of sensory data. Fantasy, for example, allows us to prepare for experiences which we may have before they occur... It is the process which has made possible all the artistic creations which we as humans have produced... Similarly, all the great novels, all the revolutionary discoveries of the sciences involve the ability to distort and misrepresent present reality.

"Generalisation is the process by which elements or pieces of a person's model become detached from their original experience and come to represent the entire category of which the experience is an example. Our ability to generalise is essential to coping with the world... The same process of generalisation may lead a human being to establish a rule such as, 'Don't express any feelings.'"

The function, then, of the Meta Model is to help us identify problematic deletions, distortions and generalisations in our internal thinking patterns and our linguistic interactions with each other, and to propose ways of transforming them or revising their use in certain contexts.



The Meta-Model

Gathering information – recovering deletions

Vague Verbs

Verbs are generally unspecified, some more than others. For example: to be caressed is more specific than to be touched.

AIM: To recover the deleted information either for one's own benefit, to avoid projection and hallucination regarding the content or to expand the possible limits of the speakers model of the world.

Examples:

"She hurt me."	"How specifically did she hurt you?"
"He is really hard on me."	"How specifically is he really hard on you?"
"I wish they would demonstrate some concern for me."	"How would you like them to demonstrate concern?"
"I can cope."	"How specifically are you coping?"

Practice Activity:

THEY SAY	META MODEL QUESTION?
"She is so angry with me."	
"They aren't helping me."	
"You don't care."	
"You can trust me."	
"This is upsetting me."	

Other examples you hear in your life or use yourself?

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Lack of referential index

Pseudo-nouns

In any sentence the person or thing doing or receiving the action of the verb is called the "referential index".

AIM: To recover the deleted information either for one's own benefit, to avoid projection and hallucination regarding the content or to expand the possible limits of the speaker's model of the world.

Examples:

"They don't listen to me."	"Who specifically does not listen to you?"
"I can't deal with it."	"What specifically is it that you can't deal with?"
"He won't love me."	"Who won't love you?"
"I've had enough of them."	"Who have you had enough of?"
"The people are a real problem."	"Which people are a real problem?"

Practice Activity:

THEY SAY	META MODEL QUESTION?
"They aren't helping me."	
"Men do not care."	
"People are so insensitive."	
"You can trust him."	
"The situation is really upsetting."	

Other examples you hear in your life or use yourself?

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Comparative Deletions

Unjustified comparisons

A JUDGEMENT or COMPARISON is made without reference to the source of the comparison. BETTER, BEST, TOO, MORE, WORST, LEAST, MOST.

AIM: To restore the deletion and/or to identify the source of the judgement or comparison.

Examples:

"This product is the best on the market."	"According to who?"
"These people are least likely to get a job."	"Least likely than what other people?"
"This is the worst situation I have been in."	"Worse than what other situation?"

Practice Activity:

THEY SAY	META MODEL QUESTION?
"This is better than my last course."	
"You're worse at supporting me."	
"This is the most I have paid for a coffee."	
"This is just too much."	

Other examples you hear in your life or use yourself?



Identification of Process

AIM: To give back the process and the ability to change things.
Anger, and all feelings are processes, happening only at a specific time and in specific contexts.

Examples:

"I am having trouble with my relationship."	"In what specific way are you having trouble with your relationship?"
"Our communication isn't working."	"What is it exactly about our communication that isn't working?"
"I am full of anger."	"What is causing you to feel angry at the moment?"

Practice Activity:

THEY SAY	META MODEL QUESTION?
"My life is one big confusion."	
"They are such a pain."	
"Work is getting to me."	
"Life is a drag."	
"I'm tired of having to be so responsible."	
"I have a problem."	

Other examples you hear in your life or use yourself?

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Expanding Limits

Exploring Generalisations

Universal Quantifiers

Exaggerations The person takes a single or several experiences, or an experience in one context, and generalises it to all contexts and/or over time.

KEY WORDS: NEVER, ALWAYS, ALL THE TIME, EVERYBODY, NOBODY, NO ONE.

The reply is to repeat the quantifier as a question, or to question in such a way that the question provokes the speaker to find an exception in his or her own argument.

AIM: To regain specificity.

Examples:

"He never listens to me".	"He NEVER listens to you?"
"Nobody cares about me".	"Absolutely NOBODY?"
"Everybody hates me?"	"Everybody?"

Practice Activity

THEY SAY	META MODEL QUESTION?
"You never clean up."	
"You always leave a mess."	
"People are always so insensitive."	
"He is so dumb all of the time."	
"Everybody complains."	

Other examples you hear in your life or use yourself?

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Modal Operators

Modal operator is a linguistic term for "modes of operation" or ways of action (thinking, feeling or behaving). Thus modal operators that people use express linguistically their perception of either having CHOICE or having NO CHOICE in their actions.

Modal operators are an overt expression of the perceived negative consequences underlying a specific course of action, or the negative consequences of inaction. These perceived consequences are often unconscious and cause personal limitation or stress.

There are two types of modal operators:

Model Operators Of Necessity

With modal operators of necessity, the underlying belief is one of negative consequences if one either:

- A. Does not take a certain action (I must do X, I have no option but to do X, I should do X, If I do not do X something bad will happen.
- B. Does take a certain action (same as above however the opposite result. I mustn't do X, If I DO do something - something bad will happen.)

This suggests that there is NO CHOICE – however a modal operator of necessity can be used to motivate a person.

Modal Operators Of Possibility

With modal operators of possibility the underlying belief is one of HAVING CHOICE in what one does, but because of the INACTION implies fear of loss or negative consequences and therefore causes fence sitting and inaction.

- A. If I do not take a certain action (I can't do X, I couldn't do X, It's impossible for me to do X). If I DID something, something "bad" could happen or I could lose something.
- B. If I do take a certain course of action (I could do X, I can do X, it's possible for me to X etc). If I DID CHOOSE to do a certain thing something "bad" could happen or I would lose out on what I have.

By questioning the modal operator the validity of the expectation and its origin are assessed by the speaker.

The general principle is to turn modal operators of necessity into those of possibility to restore personal power and choice and to convert modal operators of possibility into those of necessity to get people to take action.





Modal Operators Of Necessity

KEY WORDS: MUST, HAVE TO, SHOULD, OUGHT, NO OPTION BUT/OTHER THAN, NO CHOICE OTHER THAN, IT'S ALL I CAN DO

AIM: To regain possibility, choice, outcomes and personal power.

RESPONSE: "What would or will happen if you did or didn't?" "What stops you from doing or not doing "X"?"

Examples:

"I must never say those kinds of things."	"What would happen if you did?"
"I ought to be more understanding when he's like that".	"What do you think would happen if you weren't?"
"I have to believe in it."	"What would happen if you didn't?"
"I shouldn't do that."	"What stops you from doing that?"

These are primarily useful for "I" statements and not "you" or "they" or "them" statements. If expressed as "you" or "they" or "them" statements, there is a projection of personal modal operators, which may be challenged in the same way.

Practice Activity

THEY SAY	META MODEL QUESTION?
"I must do these exercises."	
"I should be better."	
"I should care more."	
"I ought to be more sensitive to his needs."	
"I mustn't think that way."	

Other examples you hear in your life or use yourself?





Modal Operators Of Possibility

KEY WORDS: COULD, CAN, CAN'T, POSSIBLE, IMPOSSIBLE

RESPONSE: "What would or will happen if you did or didn't?"
"What stops you from doing/not doing "X"?"

AIM: To recover causes, reasons and consequences.

Examples:

"I could finish my homework."	"What will happen if you do not?"
"I could care for others more."	"What would happen if you don't?"
"I can't do that."	"What would happen if you could?"
"I could do that".	"What stops you?"

- These are primarily useful for "I" statements and not "you" or "they" or "them" statements. If expressed as "you" or "they" or "them" statements, there is a projection of personal modal operators, which may be challenged in the same way as appropriate.
- They are applicable to the situation where people have choice BUT are not taking action.

Practice Activity

THEY SAY	META MODEL QUESTION?
"I could do these exercises."	
"I can't be better."	
"It's not possible for me to love Anymore."	
"It's impossible for me to be more Sensitive."	
"I might try to do better."	

Other examples you hear in your life or use yourself?





Lost Performatives

Group Beliefs

A belief that has been generalised, and taken from OTHERS. Often take the form of; Value judgements, superstitions, old wives' tales, or religious and scientific dogmas.

AIM: Get them to check the validity of acquired beliefs against own experiences and freedom from unconscious limiting beliefs.

General Examples: 'Boys will be boys' 'No pain no gain'

Response: "Who says?" Or find a counter example.

Examples:

"Big boys don't cry."	"Who says? . Did you see Nelson Mandela crying at his inauguration?"
"Love your enemies."	"Who says."

Practice Activity

THEY SAY	META MODEL QUESTION?
"It's not good to be a tall poppy."	
"Watch your back."	
"It's a hard world."	
"Money doesn't grow on trees."	
"You have to work hard to get there."	

Other examples you hear in your life or use yourself?

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Cause and Effect

If & Then Rules

Have you ever felt like a victim of circumstances or of other people? It is simply because you linked up a cause in the environment and believed that that cause was linked to your state (effect).

For example, if you say to me "You make me mad," you are indicating that that you believe something I did (cause) forced you to go into the state of anger (effect).

i.e. You had no choice; you were a victim of my behaviour.

The question is, could you have responded differently to my behaviour?

By saying "You make me mad," you are telling your nervous system that you have no choice: my behaviour automatically forces you to be in a state of "mad".

The fact is that statements like "you make me mad" are a major distortion. What actually happened is this:

I did something, which you filtered (interpreted) in such a way based on your understanding of the world to cause you to represent in pictures or internal dialogue that created a state called "mad." In other words, you had an IF and THEN RULE: "If you do X, then I will get mad!" (In therapy often called victim stories).

The cause of a thought or feeling is attributed to something OUTSIDE of self.

AIM: Recover personal choice.

General Examples: "He/she/they makes me "to think/feel X." "He/she/they cause me to think/feel Y.

Response: "How does what X do cause you to Y?"

Examples:

"Their laughter makes me mad."	"How does the act of their laughing cause you to be mad?"
"She upsets me."	"What specifically does she do that you feel upset about?"
"I feel bad for making her angry."	"What did you do that you believe made her angry?"

Other examples you hear in your life or use yourself?





Mind Reading

Removing Distortions

Assumptions about others

This is when the speaker indicates that the speaker knows what is in the mind (or what the feelings) of another, without explaining their evidence. They assume that everyone else thinks and feels and reacts the way they do. In psychology this is called PROJECTION.

AIM: To recover the basis of the information to judge if real or unreal.

Examples:

"I know what's good for him."	"How do you know what's good for him?"
"I can tell she doesn't like me."	"How can you tell she doesn't like you?"
"He should know better."	"How should he know better?"

Practice Activity

THEY SAY	GROUNDING MODEL QUESTION?
"She's mad at me."	
"They don't like me."	
"I know what you are thinking."	
"My teacher thinks I'm dumb."	
"They don't care about me."	

Other examples you hear in your life or use yourself?

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Presuppositions

Presuppositions cause a temporary suspension of belief because linguistically they presuppose that what follows the phrase is fact. They can turn guesses into evidence and fantasy into fact. The phrase is presupposed to be true.

Example:

"As we'll be working together on the next project, I think it's important that we communicate what's needed to ensure success."	"How do you know we'll be working together?"
	"How do you know that it will be the next project?"
	"That it's important to communicate?"
	"Communication is needed to ensure success?"
Pete: "George, do you think that it's important to understand each other's operations?"	That George and Pete do not understand each other's operation.
	That understanding the operation is important.

Other examples you hear in your life or use yourself?

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Nominalisation

A nominalisation is when a verb (that describes a process) that is transformed into a pseudo- noun.

"Teaching and discipline, applied with respect and firmness, are essentials in the process of education."	A perfectly grammatical sentence that has a nominalisation (in italics) in nearly every second word. If a noun can not be seen, heard, touched, smelled or tasted it is a nominalisation.
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Nominalisations delete so much information there is almost nothing left.

"The IT Department has made numerous blunders."	"What blunders?"
	"How have they blundered exactly?"

By turning processes into things nominalisations may be the single most misleading of language patterns in transformational grammar.

Other common nominalisations include:

- Leadership
- Communication
- Failure

Other examples you hear in your life or use yourself?

History Of NLP



Pre-NLP

History

William James (1890)

Pavlov (1920s)

1933	1950	1956	1960	1972	1974	1975	1976	1978	1979
Korzybski	Watzlawick	Miller	Bateso	Bandler &	Meta-	Structure of		Sub modalities	
General	Linguistics	Pribram	Frames	Grinder	Model	Magic			
Semantics		Gallanter							
"Neuro-Linguistic"		Cognitive	Reframing	1) Perls' Gestalt				Society of NLP	
"Neuro-Semantic"			Meta	2) Satir's Family Systems					
		Logical	Levels	3) Erickson's Hypnosis					
Design Engineering		Movement				Patterns I & II			
		Chomsky				Representation Systems			
		Transformational				Eye Access.			
		Grammar					Strategy Mode		
								NLP enriched TOTE	
1980	'82	'85	'88	'90	'94				
NLP, Vol		Sleight of Mouth		Time-Lines				Meta-States	
Dilts, et al.									
	Meta-								
	Programs								
	Leslie								
	Cameron-								
	Bandler								





The History of the NLP models

1975

1. "The meta-model of language in therapy" — the meta-model. 12 distinctions indicating ill-formed structure and 12 questions to elicit a more well-formed and fuller linguistic representation.
2. Representational systems model. They took the "model" of "the five senses" and asked the curious question — could it be that we represent information using these and that predicates indicate and sort out these five systems?
3. Eye accessing cue model; Listening to people use the representational systems and watching people move their eyes, they asked, "is there a pattern here?" What if there were correspondences between lateral eye accessing movements and use of the representational systems?

1976

4. The Milton model. Using these facets, Bandler and Grinder modelled the hypnotic patterns of Erickson and affectionately labelled the model, "the Milton model."

1977

5. Strategy model: using the TOTE model and enriching it with Rep. Systems, a richer model emerged.

Miller, Gallanter, Pribram TOTE model. They didn't create this model, they enhanced an already existing model.

1978

6. Meta-programs model. Are there patterns in information processing, sorting, and attending?
7. Sub modalities or pragmagraphics (the original term) model. The distinctions and features of the representational systems. Can we systematically order and structure these features and then use them for something? In revisiting this model, Bob Bodenhamer and Michael Hall ended up re-modelling the "sub-modalities" and created a new model about the features of the VAK (the structure of excellence, 1999). This then led to 6 new sub-models. We now know that these distinctions occur at a meta-level rather than at a "sub" level, and that the model works "symbolically and semantically" rather than merely representationally. That is, a given distinction of a representational system works according to the meanings that a person attributes to it.

1978

8. Time-lines is a pattern in how people sort out and make distinctions within the concept of "time". Inheriting the temporal model (past, present, future), and based on the work by Edward Hall (no relation), NLP did not invent or create this model, but adapted and extended it (as with the strategy model). We now know that this model works at a meta- level and as a meta-state about idea of "time."



1980 To The Present

9. Specific models for specific outcomes. After NLP came up with the basic models— models that now define specific domains of the field, various people applied them and came up with smaller models, that is, specific models for specific outcomes. Some transpire and occur in a moment of time, others occur over a much longer period of time, from an hour to a day, to years.

1994

10. The meta-states model. Using the idea of logical levels found in Korzybski and Bateson, meta-states emerged from finding the strict linear nature of the NLP enriched TOTE model ineffective and inadequate for following the strategy of complex states like resilience, proactivity, self-esteem, etc. Upon extending and enriching the strategy model with meta-levels, meta-states emerged as a model by bringing in system ideas from cybernetics, meta-cognition, reflexivity, etc.

1998

11. The frame games model. Originally an attempt to "simplify" meta-states and to put the meta-stating processes into a more user-friendly language. In that process we happened upon the template of thinking about our states and embedded states-upon- states as Games driven by frames. This has led to seeing thinking not only as "representation" but as "referencing," and the levels of referencing as higher-level frames.

2002

12. The matrix model was developed from the work in frame games. The matrix model was immediately put to use as a template to gather and sort out information and then as a diagnostic tool for a person's frames, then later (2003) the matrix business plan. The Meta-Coach Training System [MTCS] (Hall and Duval).

2003

13. The axis of change model (Hall and Duval)

2004

14. The self-actualisation quadrant model and matrix.

2005

15. The meta-performance model
16. The axis of leadership
17. The genius series



Exposing The Old NLP Myth

I first read the following article by "Buzz" Johnson in 1994 when it was published in Anchor Point. Having worked in communications as a trainer and therapist I knew that the old statement that 93% of communication is non-verbal was wrong. I knew that from watching and trying to understand movies on planes when I didn't buy the headphones. Watching faces wasn't enough. When the movie was in a foreign language, I'd get more of a sense of when the actors were angry, upset, in love, etc. But that was about it.

This article confirms the fact that most information which we receive from each other in our communications is not non-verbal information and not conveyed by the non-verbal channels of tone, facial expressions, or body "language." No. It is rather our meta- representational system of language that allows us to convey most of the information in our lives. Try to "say" (send the informational content) that "Supper will be ready at 5:45 p.m." with just some tones, facial expressions, or body gestures! This highlights the crucial role that the higher linguistic systems play in our lives. We need words to convey higher level as beliefs, concepts, understandings, ideas, plans, meanings, etc. So, while primary states are valuable and important, meta-states are much more so. They truly govern our experiences inasmuch as they set the conceptual and semantic frames that we live in. Enjoy.

- L. Michael Hall

The 7%, 38%, 55% myth

Dr. C. E. "Buzz" Johnson

In the remote sense that anyone in the NLP field needs their memories refreshed concerning the numbers in the above title, let me briefly give my recollection from numerous sessions. The total message one receives in any face to face communication is divided into three components. The words themselves, the tonality used in accompanying the other two.

The numbers indicate the relative weight or importance assigned to each of these three areas with body language receiving the 55% figure, tonality the 38%, and the actual words themselves being tagged with a paltry 7%. This strangely skewed distribution has bothered me ever since my introduction into this marvellous arena called NLP.

Out of the Mist, the first reason for my puzzlement was that none of my NLP instructors could tell me where those figures came from. Please do not interpret this to mean that I had been cursed with unknown and unknowing fly-by-night mentors.

They are all very well-known and active in the NLP community. They are also, in my opinion, excellent teachers. However, when asked where I might find further information about the research that produced those numbers, I was vaguely referred to a variety of well-known universities. I later drew a blank at each of these institutions.

Secondly, if these percentages are really valid it would mean that the learning of foreign languages could be greatly abbreviated.

After all, if the words only account for 7% of the meaning of communication, we should all be able to go to any country in the world, and simply by listening to the tone and carefully observing the body language, be able to accurately interpret 93% of their communications! And I'll bet you always my thought that learning Chinese or Russian would be a real stretch.





In fact, from these percentages, it appears that you needn't even bother. You may be better off without being encumbered by all the intricacies of any language. People like Leo Buscaglia are looking forward to the time when words will no longer be necessary as he states in his book *Living, Loving & Learning*. Since a word such as "love" has as many definitions as it has definers, he feels it will be a happy day when the world of word hang-ups is replaced by "vibrations."

Counting on what?

I wonder how many of you have a 93% rate of accuracy when it comes to interpreting and understanding even your most intimate friends and family members. And that's with people speaking the same official language with its 7% impact!

It is not only the NLP community that is espousing and apparently believing the 7-38-55 myth. I've heard therapists and counsellors who were unfamiliar with NLP allude to those same numbers. There also seems to be a widespread belief among the general population that words are relatively unimportant. I'm sure most of us have heard people mid-read with statements such as, "She didn't really mean what she said, she probably meant XXX instead." Or, "He may have said that, but he didn't really mean it." Or, "It's not what you say, but how you say it."

In NLP change work, note how carefully we reword statements in order to reframe a client's personal perceptions. And by very skilfully using just the right hypnotic language patterns, we are able to rapidly enhance desired shifts in our clients' understandings and attitudes and beliefs. Would we need to be this meticulous and conscientious if we were really dealing with only 7% of a person's awareness and comprehension?

I was finally able to track down the source of this myth thanks to a professional speaker who makes his living giving sales seminars and workshops. And yes, the 7-38-55 was an important part of his presentations. He didn't know how to spell the name of the individual responsible for the research that originated those numbers or which university was involved, but he gave me a valuable starting point by offering me a couple of different possible pronunciations. I think you'll be interested in what I found.

The Study

Albert Mehrabrian, Ph. Of UCLA was the originator of the 7-38-55 theory. He speaks of it in two books, *Silent Messages* published in 1971, and *nonverbal communications* published in 1972. In these two books, he refers to research projects, which were published in various professional journals. I will get to the journals in more detail later, but first let's look at some of his statements from one of the books.

From Chapter 3 of *Silent Messages* we find that the numbers 7-38-55 expressed as percentages have to do only with what he calls the resolution of inconsistent messages, or to put it in NLP terms, incongruencies. He also states that there are very few things that can be communicated non-verbally. He initially was investigating liking/ disliking which he later generalized into feelings. In speaking with him by phone in March 1994, he stated that his findings and inferences were not meant to be applied to normal communications. They were of very limited application.

Let me paraphrase some of his thoughts from page 134 toward the end of that book. Clearly, it is not always possible to substitute actions for words and therefore, what are the limitations of actions as instruments of communication? If you've ever played charades, you know that words and language are by far the most effective way of expressing complex and abstract ideas. The ideas contained in *Silent Messages* and most other books for that matter, couldn't be done with actions. A very important thing to remember about the differences between words and actions is that actions only permit the expression of a limited set of things; namely, primary feelings and attitudes.



The Details

Now let's examine in more detail the specifics of a couple of his experiments from which some people have made some rather sweeping and inaccurate generalisations. From the Journal of Consulting Psychology, 1967, Vol. 31. No. 3, pg. 248-252 is a report entitled 'Inference of Attitudes from Nonverbal Communication in Two Channels.' This study was designed to investigate the decoding of inconsistent and consistent communications of attitude in facial and vocal channels. The experimental team found that the facial component received approximately 3/2 the weight received by the vocal component.

You can readily see that this roughly corresponds to the 38% and 55% figures mentioned earlier.

You may be wondering how this study was conducted. There was only one word used. That word was "maybe," selected for its apparent neutrality. Three female speakers were tape recorded saying that word while varying their tone of voice so as to communicate three different attitudes (i.e., like, neutral, and dislike) towards an imagined addressee.

Then the tapes were listened to by 17 female subjects with instructions to imagine that the speaker is saying this word to another person and judged by the tones what the speaker's attitude is towards that imaginary addressee. So, there was no direct feedback by anyone who was being addressed. It was a number of third-party listeners who were asked to mind-read, guess, interpret, imagine, etc., how the speaker felt towards someone who wasn't even there and in fact, didn't even exist. There was no way to see or hear the reactions of this phantom individual, about whom someone was going to make several long-lasting and powerful speculations.

Next, black and white photographs were taken of three female models as they attempted to use facial expressions to communicate like, neutrality, and dislike towards another person. Then photos were shown to the same 17 subjects with the instructions that they would be shown the pictures and at the same time hear a recording of the word "maybe" spoken in different tones of voice. "You are to imagine that the person you see and hear(A) is looking at and talking to another person (B)." For each presentation they were to indicate on a rating scale what they thought A's attitude was toward B. Again, third-party mind-reading with no direct contact with the person addressed, B, because that person was non-existent. The conclusions from this experiment were that the facial components were stronger than the vocal by the ratio of 3/2 as referred to earlier.

An interesting comment that came out of the discussion section indicated that the effect of redundancy (i.e., consistent attitude communication in two or more channels) is to intensify the attitude communicated in any one of the component channels. Perhaps this is something that could be more profitably pursued instead of the denigration of words. Or as you can see from this particular study, word, not words. And that word was "maybe." It seems to play words under quite a handicap not much different from playing charades.

Two Studies Combined

They integrated this study with another one to come up with the .07, .38, and .55 coefficients. This second study was reported in the Journal of personality and Social Psychology, 1967, Vol. 6, No. 1, pg. 109-114 entitled, 'Decoding of Inconsistent Communications.' Here they dealt with inconsistent communication of attitude in two components; tone of voice and nine different words. Three words were selected that seemed to indicate a positive attitude, "honey," "thanks," and "dear." Three were neutral, "maybe," "really," and "oh," and three were negative, "don't," "brute," and "terrible."

Two female speakers were employed to read each of the nine words with each of the three tones; positive, neutral, or disliking of an imaginary addressee. These were recorded on tape, which was then listened to by 30 University of California undergraduates.





They were instructed to imagine that each word was being said by one person to another and to judge what the speaker's attitude was towards the imaginary recipient. One-third were told to ignore the information conveyed by the meaning of the words and to pay attention only to the tone. Another third were told to ignore the tone and pay attitude only to the meaning of the words. The last third were told to utilise both the tone and the content.

The findings were that the independent effects of tone, overall, were stronger than the independent effects of content. I should think so! After all, the words allowed were very limited while the tones allowed were unlimited as long as certain feelings were being demonstrated. But, after all, Mehrabian's main interest is in non-verbal types of communication. However, in fairness, it was mentioned in the discussion that the methodology used failed to solve the problem for which it was intended. An alternative methodology could have employed written communication for assessing the independent effects of content and electronically filtered speech (with the content rendered incomprehensible) for assessing the independent effects of tone. I don't know if an alternative experiment like that was ever carried out.

After commenting on some of the methodological problems, they do go on to say that the results indicate that judgments of attitude from inconsistent messages involving single words spoken with intonation are primarily based on the attitude carried in the tonal component. The use of single words is a long way away from normal communications, don't you think? In fact, they admit that their findings can only be safely extended to situations in which no additional information about the communicator-addressee relationship is available. This seems to relegate it to the realm of tightly controlled laboratory-pure experimentation only.

I would invite all of your readers to examine not only Mehrabian's books, but also his articles in the professional journals, which go into more detail concerning his experiments. If enough of us carefully analyse the available data, perhaps we can reinterpret the results in a more useful, meaningful, and workable way than we have in the past.

If we continue to disseminate erroneous information such as the 7-38-55 myth, I feel we are doing a grave disservice not only to the NLP community, but to the public in general. We could do a great service by helping the public realise that the words they use on themselves as well as on others are extremely important in determining the effectiveness and longevity of relationships, the strength of personal self-esteem, and a whole host of other psychological phenomena.





Words and language are probably the primary motivation factors for human beings, and they can be enhanced by proper congruent tonality and body language. They can also be somewhat diminished by incongruencies which then often show up as confusion and bewilderment in relationship situations. For example, think how often some battered women have desperately believed the words of their batterers despite overwhelming incongruent behaviour. "He said he was really going to change this time."

Think of your own personal experiences in close relationships that have gone sour. Haven't you also hoped and waited for change that would transform incongruent communication signals into congruent ones? Especially before NLP training? Haven't most of us, at some time, hopelessly clung to our own inaccurate interpretation of another's actions hoping for a miracle that would once again make everything whole and comfortable just like we thought it used to be? And what was the total effect of the spoken word at those times? Did the words really have only a 7% influence on our hopes and desires? Not likely. Given the emotional impact of prior experience and beliefs, our memories are not about to logically reduce the words of a loved one, or former loved one, to such an insignificant role instantaneously.

Such impersonal and coldly analytical reactions are probably destined to remain in the safety aloof confines of the experimental laboratory with its pretend situations and imaginary interactions. Perhaps we could benefit from a re-assessment of old acquired beliefs in the glaring light of real-life relationship reactions and perceptions.

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Dr. C. E. "Buzz" Johnson, retired Optometrist, has been through Master Practitioner and Trainer's Training. He has been researching the power of words in a variety of different disciplines, medicine, education, addictions, relationships, psycho-neuro-immunology, hypnosis, psychotherapy, etc.

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Meta-States®

The Upper States



Definition

A state about another state as in joyful about learning, playful about being serious, curious about anger, calm about fear. The thoughts-and-feelings about other thoughts- and-feelings as mind reflects back onto itself and its products.

Kinds of states

- 1) **Primary states:** are primary emotions like fear, anger, joy, relaxed, tense, pleasure, pain, etc. and involve thoughts directed outward to the things "out there."
- 2) **Meta-states:** are higher level structures like fear of fear, anger at fear, shame about being embarrassed, esteem of self, etc. In these states, our self-reflexivity relates (not to the world), but to ourselves, to our thoughts, feelings, or to some abstract conceptual state.
- 3) **Gestalt states:** are emergent properties from layering or laminating mind repeatedly with other states. It gives rise to a new neuro-semantic system, an emergent state that's "more than the sum of the parts" such as courage, self-efficacy, resilience, and seeing opportunities.

Meta-state factors

Frames: As a model, Meta-States describes our higher frames-of-references. We set these up and use them to create stable structures (i.e., beliefs, values, understandings, etc.). We develop these frames, which we can keep with us.

Reflexivity: We never just think. As soon as we think or feel we then experience thoughts and feelings about that first thought, then other thoughts-and-feelings about that thought, and so on. Our self-reflective consciousness works as an "infinite regress" to recursively iterate.

Layering: In meta-states we layer states onto states to create higher levels of awareness. In layering thinking-and-feeling, we put one state in a higher or Meta (above, beyond) position to the second. This creates a "logical type" or "logical level."

Psycho-Logics: A special kind of internal logic arises from layering of states. When we transcend from one state (say, anger or joy) to another state (say, calmness or respect) we set the second state as a frame over the first and include it inside it. This gives us "calm anger," respectful joy, joyful learning, etc. It makes the first state a member of the class of the second.

Non-Linear: It's not logical in a linear or external way, yet it is psycho-logical. Internally when we put a state like anger or fear inside another state (calmness, respect, gentleness, courage, etc.), we change the internal logic of our nervous system and person. This is what we mean when we talk about "logical levels." When we put one state in a "logical" relationship to another state so that one is at a higher level than the higher one is about the other. This about-relationship establishes the "logic."

Self-Organising: There are no such "things" as logical levels. They do not exist "out there." But only in the mind as how we represent categories and levels. With this logical typing or levelling, the effect of each level is to organise and control the information on the level below it. In logical levels each level is progressively more psychologically encompassing and impactful.

Coalescing: By repetition and habituation, higher frames or states coalesce into the lower states. The higher thoughts-and-feelings soak down into them to qualify or texture the lower state.



Definition

Performing (neurology) great meanings (semantics) and creating more robust meanings for our performances.

Neuro-semantic factors

Emotions: When something means something to us we feel it in our bodies. The meanings show up as "emotions." The meanings take the form of values, ideas, beliefs, understandings, paradigms, mental models, frames, etc.

Meaning-Making: Neuro-Semantics is a model of how we make meaning through evaluating experiences, events, words, etc. It's a model of how we then live in the World or Matrix of Meaning that we construct and inherit.

Matrix as Frames of Meaning: Neuro-Semantics describes the frames of reference we use as we move through life and the frames of meaning that we construct. It creates the Matrix of Frames in which we live and from which we operate.

Semantic Reactions: The reactions that occur which indicate our semantic structures.

Generative Neuro-Semantics: Building up new gestalt states, which offer new experiences, which are more than the sum of the parts.

Systemic: The meta-state structure of Neuro-Semantics involves a different kind of thinking as it shifts from linear to non-linear thinking. Systemic thinking involves reflexivity, recursiveness, and spiral thinking. It means following feedback and feed forward loops around the loops of the fluid Matrix Frames.

Neuro-semantic models

The first model of Neuro-Semantics is the **Meta-States model** that maps our reflexivity, our self-reflexive consciousness, and which describes our layering of states upon states to create our matrix of frames and higher levels of mind and perception.

The **Mind-Lines model** came next as a model for conversational reframing to transform meaning.

The **Frame Games model** detects, diagnoses, and transforms the inner game of our frames so that we can take our outer games of our performances to new levels of expertise.

The **Matrix model** provides a systemic and unifying model of all the patterns and processes in NLP and NS, offering 3 process matrices from Cognitive psychology and five content matrices from Developmental psychology as a diagnostic and modelling tool.

The **Axes of Change model** maps the process of change and transformation using 4 meta- programs as axes for the dance of change.

The **Neuro-Semantic Self-Actualisation model** includes the **Self-Actualisation Quadrants model**, which enables us to diagnose the relationship between meaning and performance and to use the quadrants to recognise that we all perform meaning and hence experience neuro-semantic states.

The **Matrix of Self-Actualisation model** offers a practical way to coach self-actualisation.



Program Influences



Standing on the Shoulders of Giants

L. Michael Hall, Ph.D.

www.neurosemantics.com

Dr Hall is executive director of the International Society of Neuro-Semantics (ISNS) having co-founded it with his business partner, Dr Bob Bodenhamer in 1996. Prior to finding NLP in 1987 and studying with NLP cofounder Richard Bandler, Michael was a licensed psychotherapist in the state of Colorado with graduate degrees in Business, Literature, and Clinical Counselling. He did his doctoral studies in Cognitive behavioural Psychology and included NLP in his dissertation at Union Institute University in Cincinnati, Ohio.

Upon the discovery of Meta-States in 1994 during a modelling project on resilience, Meta-States won recognition as "the most significant contribution to NLP in 1995" by the International NLP Trainers Association. From there Michael began developing pattern after pattern using meta-states. That, in turn, led him and associates to apply meta-states to facets of NLP itself and finding all kinds of new rich treasures. It was translated to

time-lines, "sub-modalities," the sleight of mouth patterns, meta-programs and more. From this came two dozen practical training applications in sales, persuasion, defusing hotheads, leadership, coaching, relationships, wealth creation, etc.

Today Dr. Hall is involved as a Meta-Analyst or Conversation Coach and an entrepreneur in several businesses (real estate, publishing, etc.). He lives part of the year in the Colorado Rocky Mountains and trains internationally the rest of the time. He is a prolific writer and researcher with more than 30 books to his name.

Bobby g. Bodenhamer, D. Min.

www.neurosemantics.com

Dr Bodenhamer first trained for the ministry, earned a doctorate in Ministry, and served several churches as pastor. He began NLP training in 1990, studying with Dr. Tad James and receiving Master Practitioner and Trainer Certifications. Since then, he has taught and certified NLP trainings at Gastona College.

Beginning in 1996, Dr Bodenhamer began studying the Meta-States model and then teamed up with Michael to begin co-authoring several books. Since then he has turned out many works as he and Michael have applied the NLP and Meta-States Models to various facets of human experience.

In 1996 also, Dr Bodenhamer with Michael co-founded the Society of Neuro-Semantics. This has taken his work to a new level, taken him into International Trainings, and set in motion many Institutes of Neuro-Semantics around the world.

Neuro-Linguistic Programming From What is NLP: [\(Click here to visit link\)](#)

NLP stands for Neuro-Linguistic Programming, a name that encompasses the three most influential components involved in producing human experience: neurology, language and programming. The neurological system regulates how our bodies function, language determines how we interface and communicate with other people and our programming determines the kinds of models of the world we create. Neuro-Linguistic Programming describes the fundamental dynamics between mind (neuro) and language (linguistic) and how their interplay affects our body and behaviour (programming).



Neuro-Semantics

From Neuro Semantics: [\(Click here to visit link\)](#)

Neurosemantics or Neuro-Semantics is a model that describes how we humans get meaning (semantics) incorporated into our body (neurology) so that we feel meanings and do so in terms of our emotions and states.

Neurosemantics is an inter-disciplinary field, drawing from Cognitive Behavioural Psychology, General Semantics, Neuro-linguistic Programming and Systems Thinking. Neuro-Semantics explores the structure of meaning and how those meanings become embodied within us. Neuro-Semantics approaches the mind-body-emotion system in several ways. From the mental dimension, it explores how language works inside of us, how we attribute meaning, create meaning by words, associations, framing, metaphors, etc. From the neurological dimension, it explores how our body works with ideas to "realize" or "actualize" them and how what we do influences what we believe.

The Institute for Neurosemantics is one of the many organisations that build on Neuro linguistic Programming. Its developers include Michael Hall and Bobby G. Bodenhamer.

Nondual Traditions

From Nondualism: [\(Click here to visit link\)](#)

Nondualism, also called non-duality, is a term and concept used to define various strands of thought which treat two major concepts joined as one.

Historically the term is linked to the Advaita Vedanta-tradition, which states that there is no difference between Brahman and Ātman. It is also found in other Asian religious traditions, but with a variety of meanings and uses.

In western cultures the term is also used in modern spirituality and New Age for a "grand tradition" which sees "a primordial, natural awareness without subject or object" as the essence of a variety of religious traditions.

The term is also used to refer to interconnectedness, such as the rejection of Cartesian dualism.

General Semantics

From General Semantics: [\(Click here to visit link\)](#)

General semantics is a program begun in the 1920s that seeks to regulate the evaluative operations performed in the human brain. After partial launches under the names "human engineering" and "humanology," Polish-American originator Alfred Korzybski (1879–1950) fully launched the program as "general semantics" in 1933 with the publication of *Science and Sanity: An Introduction to Non-Aristotelian Systems and General Semantics*.

General semantics should not be confused with generalized semantics (a branch of linguistics). Misunderstandings traceable to the discipline's name have greatly complicated the program's history and development.

The sourcebook for general semantics, *Science and Sanity*, presents general semantics as both a theoretical and a practical system whose adoption can reliably alter human behaviour in the direction of greater sanity. Its author asserted that general semantics training could eventually unify people and nations. In the 1947 preface to the third edition of *Science and Sanity*, Korzybski wrote, "We need not blind ourselves with the old dogma that 'human nature cannot be changed,' for we find that it can be changed."

Many recognized specialists in the knowledge areas where Korzybski claimed to have anchored general semantics—biology, epistemology, mathematics, neurology, physics, psychiatry, etc.—supported his work in his lifetime, including Cassius J. Keyser, C. B. Bridges, W. E. Ritter, P. W. Bridgman, G. E. Coghill, William Alanson White, Clarence B. Farrar, David Fairchild, and Erich Kähler. Starting around 1940, university English professor S.I. Hayakawa (1906–1992), speech professor Wendell Johnson, speech professor Irving J. Lee, and others assembled elements of general semantics into a package suitable for incorporation into mainstream communications curricula.

The Institute of General Semantics, which Korzybski and co-workers founded in 1938, continues today.



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